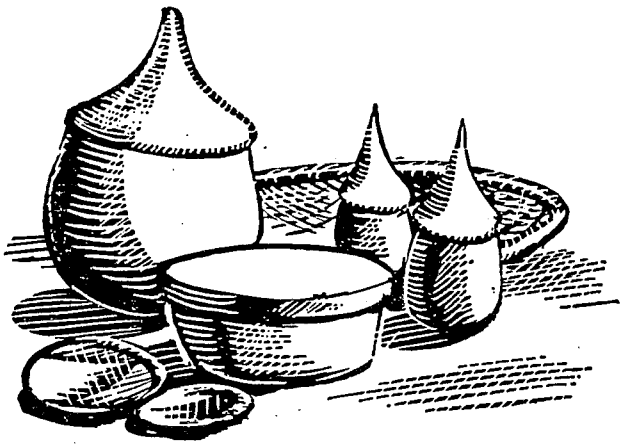
DICTIONARY

Kinyarwanda - English
English - Kinyarwanda



by
Betty Ellen Cox, Myra Adamson
and
Muriel Teusink

DICTIONARY

KINYARWANDA - ENGLISH

ENGLISH - KINYARWANDA

Prepared by Myra Adamson, Betty Ellen Cox,
and Muriel H. Teusink

The purpose of this book is to assist the person learning Kinyarwanda. It contains the vocabulary used in the Cox Grammar and also that in the Gospel of Mark (1957 edition), plus other commonly used words. In the Kinyarwanda-English section, the numbers in parentheses following the words indicate the number of the lesson in the Cox Grammar in which the word was introduced.

A few abbreviations are: tr. = transitive; int. = intransitive; inv. = invariable; n. = noun; sing. = singular; pl. = plural.

A few notes on the orthography used:

1) imp- is used rather than imh- (as in impamba, impumyi, etc.)
2) Since pf and f are sometimes used interchangeably, in looking for a word with this sound, try under both spellings.
3) The letter r has been used throughout, rather than l, except in the case of a few words of foreign origin.
4) You will note markings above some of the vowels, e.g. ā, ē, ī, ō. This mark usually indicates a high, lengthened tone, though in a few cases it is a low lengthened tone. Many more low ones could have been indicated. No short tones are indicated. You will need to have a Munyarwanda help you with pronunciation, since Kinyarwanda is a tonal language. These markings are not usually used in writing or printing the language, but are here to help you learn to pronounce the words correctly. Most long markings are not included in the English-Kinyarwanda section.

The authors are aware there will be imperfections and lacks, but hope that in spite of them this book will be of some use to those beginning their study of Kinyarwanda.

A

urw-ābya (inz-) - small covered clay pot

kw-āduka (tse) - to appear suddenly

inz-āduka (inz-) - something strange, foreign, new

ak-āga (no pl.) - misfortune, danger

umw-āga (no pl.) - harshness, severity
umunyamwāga - harsh person, cruel

icy-āgo (iby-)(111) - trouble

ubw-āguke (no pl.) - width

aha (118) - here

icy-āha (iby-)(14) - sin

ukw-āha (utw-)(32) - armpit

ahandi (no pl.)(43) - elsewhere

ahāri (43) - perhaps

aho (119) - there, where, since, instead of, rather than

ahūbwo (39) - but rather, on the contrary, however

kw-āhukana (nye) - to leave mate (temporarily) (usually said of women)

kw-āka (tse)(82) - to shine, burn, (of a fire)

kw-āka (tse) - to take away from, reclaim

umw-āka (imy-)(38) - year; (pl.)-crops

akaramata - forever

kw-ākīra (iriye)(95) - to accept, welcome, receive

umw-āku (no pl.) - bad fate, bad luck

iny-ama (see: i-nyama)

kw-āmamara (ye) - to spread everywhere, become known (int.)

kw-āmamaza (je) - to spread everywhere (tr.), make known, publish

iny-amaswa (see: i-nyamaswa)

kw-āmbara (ye)(36) - to wear, dress, put on (clothing)

kw-āmbaza (je) - to pray, cry to God for help

umw-āmbi (imy-) - arrow, match

kw-āmbika (tse) - to dress (tr.), put clothes on someone

am-ambu, ibiri - on the contrary, however

icy-āmbu (iby-) - port

kw-āmbuka (tse) - to cross a body of water, or land

kw-āmbura (ye) - to take clothes off

umw-āmbuzi (ab-) - thief, robber

umw-āmi (ab-)(2) - king, Lord

icy-āmi - kingly, royal

ubw-āmi (no pl.)(48) - kingdom

urw-āmo (no pl.) - noise (of voices), clamor

umw-āna (ab-)(2) - child, son, daughter

ubw-āna (no pl.)(28) - childhood

iny-āna (see: i-nyana)

icy-āna (iby-) - colt, young of animal

in-anasi (in-)(61) - pineapple

umw-ānda (imy-)(107) - dirt (as on floor)

kw-āndarika (tse) ibintu - to be careless with things

kw-āndika (tse)(34) - to write

urw-āndiko (inz-)(25) - letter (missile)

umw-ānditsi (ab-) - secretary, scribe

umw-āndu (imy-) - inheritance

kw-ānga (nze)(36) - to refuse, hate, dislike

kw-āngirira (ye) - to resist, refuse to

kw-āngiza (je)- to damage, damage crop, etc. before it is mature, to waste

urw-ango (inz-) - hatred

umw-ango (imy-)(23)(Sw.) - door

ak-ānguhe, gusesa - to be mature (person), experienced

kw-ānika (tse)(59) - to put out in the sun

iny-anja (see: i-nyanja)

kw-ānura (ye)(59) - to bring in from sun

umw-ānya (imy-)(88) - time, space

ak-ānya (no pl.) - a brief moment

iny-anya (see: i-nyanya)

ubw-anyuma (no pl.) - later

umw-ānzi (ab-)(102) - enemy

umw-ānzuro (imy-) - final word, decision, conclusion

inz-ara (see: i-nzara)

urw-āra (inz-)(24) - fingernail, claw, toenail

ak-āra (no pl.) - place where soil is thin

am-āra masa - empty-handed, in vain

Umw-árabu (ab-) - Arab

ari - whether, he is, she is, it is

umw-āri (ab-) - young woman

icy-āri (iby-) - nest

kw-ārika (tse) - to make a nest

ariko - but, however

umw-ārimu (ab-) - professor, teacher

umw-āro (imy-) - lakeshore, ford

icy-āro (iby-) - village, country (rural)

kw-āruka (tse) - to grow up

kw-āsa (ashije)(65) - to cut firewood

kw-āsama (mye) - to open the mouth

ashwi - no (emphatic)
ashwi da - no!

ubw-āto (am-)(27) - boat

kw-ātsa (akije)(63) - to blow the fire

ubw-ātsi (no pl.)(69) - grass, pasture, possession
gukūra ubwâtsi - to congratulate, (as a graduate), e.g. tugukūriye ubwatsi

icy-ātsi (iby-)(69) - grass
ibyatsi bibi - weeds

icy-áyi (no pl.)(61) -tea

B

ku-ba (baye)(12) - to be, become, live, exist
kuba maso - to be on guard, alert
kuba mu mazi abira - to be in great difficulty

i-baba (ama-) - wing

ku-babara (ye)(75) - to suffer, be sad, hurt, be sore

ubu-babare (no pl.) - physical suffering (or, mental)

ku-babarira (ye)(48) - to forgive
umbabarire (46) - excuse me, I'm sorry

umu-babaro (imi-)(104) - suffering, pain, sorrow, sadness, grief (mental, not physical)

ku-babaza (je)(79) - to hurt (tr.), cause pain, sorrow

im-babazi (im-)(15) - forgiveness, pardon, mercy, pity

iki-babi (ibi-)(69) - leaf

ku-baduka (tse) - to get up quickly (from seat or bed)

ku-bāga (ze)(63) - to butcher, operate on, cause to suffer severely

im-baga (im-) - crowd

ku-bagara (ye) - to weed

i-bāgiro (ama-) - butcher shop, butchering place

aka-bago (utu-) - comma, period

ku-baho (bayeho) - to live, exist

uru-bāho (im-)(23) - board, slate

ku-baka (see: k-ūbaka)

umu-baji (aba-) - carpenter

ku-bāmba (mbye) - to crucify, stretch out (as hide to dry)

iki-bambazi (ibi-) - wall (usually exterior)

bambe (46) - excuse me (misspoke myself)

ku-bāmbūra (ye) - to remove from cross, remove dried hide from pegs

ku-bāna (nye) - to live with, together

ru-bānda (no pl.) - people, a crowd
rubanda rwa giseseka - the ordinary people

aka-bānde (utu-)(56) - valley

i-banga (ama-) - secret

ku-bāngikanya (nije) - to place near, put in group together

ku-bānguka (tse)(47) - to hurry

ku-bānza (njije)(31) - to do first, begin by

ubanza - it seems that..., it's possible that..., I think..., perhaps...

uru-bānza (imanza) - trial, judgment, condemnation, affair

ku-banziriza (je) - to precede

ku-bara (ze)(38) - to count

i-bara (ama-) - color

im-baraga (im-)(46) - strength, power

im-baragasa (im-)(77) - flea

aka-barankuru (utu-) - news magazine, paper

umu-bare (imi-)(122) - number

i-barura (no pl.) - statistics, census

i-baruwa (ama-)(Sw.) - letter

ku-bāsha (shije) - to have power, be able

ubu-bāsha (no pl.) - power, strength, authority

im-bata (im-) - slave

aka-bāti (utu-) - closet, cupboard

ku-batiza (je) - to baptize

umu-batizo (no pl.) - baptism

iki-baya (ibi-) - plain (near river, lake)

ibya-baye - what happened

ku-baza (jije)(44) - to ask (question)

ku-bāza (je)(65) - to plane, carve wood

iki-bazo (ibi-) - question

im-beba (im-)(38) - mouse, rat

im-bēhe (im-) - bowl (made of wood)

im-beho (im-) - cold (atmosphere)

aka-bemba (utu-)(85) - peanut, ground nut

umu-bēmbe (aba-) - leper

ibi-bēmbe (no sing.) - leprosy

bene - like (esp. before pronoun; ben'ibi)

ku-bēngerana (nye) - to shine, gleam

im-bere (118) - inside, in front of , before
mu mbere - private room, place for honored guest

imi-bēreho (no sing.) - actions, conduct, life, well-being, lifestyle

ku-berereka (tse) - to move aside to permit passage

i-bēsani (ama-) - basin

ku-bēshya (shye)(58) - to lie, deceive, tell a lie to

ku-bēshyabēshya (shye)(113) - to amuse a child, fool, deceive lightly

-bi (adj.)(8) - bad, dirty, ugly

ku-biba (bye)(117) - to plant, sow (small seeds)

umu-bibyi (aba-) - planter, sower

ku-bīha (-shye) - to be bitter, sour, taste bad

ku-bīka (tse)(29) - to put away, store

ku-bika (tse) - to crow

ku-bimba (mbye) ifuro - to froth at the mouth

iki-bīndi (ibi-) - clay water pot

uru-bingo (im-) - reed, swamp of reeds

ku-bira (ze)(63) - to boil (int.)

-biri (37) - two
guca ukubiri na- to be different from

umu-biri (imi-)(76) - body, flesh

Umu-birigi (Aba-) - Belgian

Ubu-birigi - Belgium

ku-birindura (ye) - to roll along (tr.)

iki-biriti (ibi-) - box of matches

i-biro (i-) - dresser, desk, office

ku-bisa (shije) - to step aside (to allow passage)

-bisi (8) - raw, green, unripe, wet, fresh

i-bisi (i-) - bus

ku-biza (jije)(63) - to boil (tr.)

bo (48) - they, them

wa-bo (3) - their (wabo, babo, etc.)

ku-bobēra (ye) - to moisten

im-boga (im-)(63) - vegetable, greens, also, uruboga

im-bogo (im-) - buffalo

ku-boha (shye)(78) - to tie, bind, weave, knit

im-bohe (im-) - prisoner

ku-bohekanya (nye) - to braid, twist

ku-bohōra (ye)(78) - to untie

uku-boko (ama-)(32) - arm, might, front leg of animal

i-bombo (ama-) - candy

bona (inv.) - even if

ku-bona (nye)(25) - to see, find, receive, get

ku-boneka (tse) - to appear, be visible

ku-boneza (je) - to make clean, pure; to make pass through

im-boni (im-) - pupil of eye
gutera imboni - glance at

ku-bora (ze)(80) - to rot, spoil

ku-borõga (ze) - to howl, wail, yell (pain, sorrow, etc.)

uru-bozo - kwica urubozo - to make die slowly

umu-bu (imi-) - mosquito

bucya - the night before

iki-buga (ibi-) - courtyard, playground

im-bugita (im-)(63) - knife

bugufi (inv.) - near, near-by

ku-buguza (je) - to play "igisoro" (cow game)

buhoro (25) - slowly, slightly, gently

buhoro buhoro (25) - little by little, gently, carefully, slowly, so-so

bukeye (8, 119) - the next day, afterwards

ku-bũmba (mbye)(65) - to make bricks, mold clay, to head up (as, cabbage)

i-bũmba (no pl.) - clay

ku-bũmbira (ye) - to unite, to put together

i-bumoso (119) - on the left

im-bundo (im-) - infinitive

ku-bunguka (tse) - to return from wandering

ku-bũnza (nje) umutima - to be worried, perplexed, anxious

ku-bura (ze)(88) - to lack, not find, lose

uru-bura (no pl.)(114) - hail

ku-bũrana (nye) - to plead, defend oneself

umunya-buranga (abanya-) - handsome, beautiful person

buri (41) - every, each

ku-bũrira (ye) - to warn

burũndu - absolutely final, totally

burya - then (remembered), in reality, after all, such as he (it) is

i-buryo (119) - on the right

ku busa (103) - in vain, for nothing

im-buto (im-)(12) - seed, plant, fruit

i-buye (ama-)(18) - stone, pebble

ku-buyēra (ye) - to wander about, be a vagabond

ku-buyereza (je) - to cause to wander about, cause to be a vagabond

ku-buza (jije)(68) - to prevent, stop (tr.), prohibit, forbid

im-bwa (im-)(7) - dog

bwangu (inv.) - quickly

ku-bwīra (ye)(66) - to tell

ku-bwīriza (je) - to preach, to incite to do something, or act in a certain manner

bwite - fully, truly, own (e.g. his own)

ku-byāra (ye)(89) - to give birth (to)

umu-byēyi (aba-)(17) - parent

ku-byibuha (shye)(112) - to be fat, stout

ku-byiga (ze) - to push, lean against

ku-byīmba (mbye) - to swell

iki-byīmba (ibi-)(113) - boil, abcess

umu-byīmba (imi-) - thickness, corpse

ku-byina (nye) - to dance (girls)

im-byiro (im-)(107) - soot, dirt (on body, clothes)

uru-byiruko (no pl.) - youth, young people

imi-byizi, iminsi ya - weekdays

byongeye kandi - furthermore, moreover, and what's more

ku-byūka (tse)(115) - to get up, rise up (from lying position)

ku-byūtsa (kije) - to lift up, help someone get up

C

gu-ca (ciye)(65, 84) - to cut (as tree), sever, tear (tr.), pass along road, pick (as corn)
byanciyeho - it escaped me, I negected to do it

gu-ca iryēra - to see someone briefly

in-cābiti (in-)(65) - axe

gu-cāgagura (ye)(63) - to chop up

gu-cāgata (se) - to be half-filled

umu-cāmanza (aba-) - judge

igi-cāmūnsi (ibi-) - near sunset time

gu-cāna (nye)(51) - to light, kindle, start a fire

ama-cāndwe - saliva, spit

umu-cānga (imi-)(65) - sand, gravel

umu-cānshuro (aba-) - mercenary, hired person

gu-capa - to print (as at press)

gu-capisha - to have printed

umu-ce (imi-) - small rug, mat

igi-ce (ibi-)(62) - piece, part, half, chapter, division

bu-cece - silently

gu-ceceka (tse) - to be quiet, silent, stop talking

gu-cẽngera (ye) - to penetrate

gu-cẽngeza (je) - to make penetrate, soak in

umu-ceri (no pl.) - rice

gu-cĩka (tse)(84) - to escape, break (int.), to tear (int.)
gucika intege - to become discouraged,weak

gu-cĩkura (ye) - to save from being wiped out (as, family name)

gu-cĩkwa (tswe) - to make an error, miscalculate

ama-cinya - dysentery

gu-cĩra (ye) umugani - to tell a fable, proverb

igi-cĩro (ibi-)(107) - price, value, worth

gu-cĩrwaho (weho) iteka - to be condemned

i-co (no pl.)(19) - dirt, filthiness

umu-co (imi-) - custom, quality, virtue

igi-co (ibi-) - ambush

gu-cõgoza (je) - to weaken, discourage

wa-cu (3) - our (wacu, bacu, etc.)

igi-cu (ibi-) - cloud

igi-cũcu (ibi-)(76, 115) - shade, shadow, foolish person

gu-cucuma (mye)(75) - to mash

gu-cugusa (shije) - to shake hard (tr.)

gu-cugutu (se) - to shake hard (tr.)

i-cukiro (ama-)(19) - manure heap

igi-cuku (no pl.) - midnight

gu-cukura (ye)(123) - to dig a hole

igi-cuma (ibi-) - gourd

gu-cumba (mbye) - to forcibly twist

i-cũmbi (ama-)(104) - guest room, dormitory, temporary lodging place

gu-cũmbika (tse)(104) - to get lodging, spend night away from home

gu-cũmbikira (ye) - to give lodging to

gu-cũmbukũra (ye) - to leave a lodging place

i-cumi (37) - ten

i-cumu (ama-)(19) - spear

gu-cumura (ye) - to sin

igi-cumuro (ibi-) - sin

uru-cundo (in-) - swing (like children play in)

i-cunga (ama)(91) - orange

in-cũngu (or, in-shungu)(in-) - ransom

gu-cũngura (ye)(57) - to redeem, pay ransom

umu-cũnguzi (aba-) - redeemer

i-cupa (ama-) - bottle

gu-cura (ze) urugoma - to fool around, to have a party

ibi-curãne (no sing.)(26) - cold in head, runny nose

gu-curãnga (nze) - to play an instrument (harp, piano)

igi-curi (no pl.) - epilepsy

aga-curi (no pl.) - cliff

gu-curika (tse) - to turn upside down

gu-curūza (je) - to trade (make profit)

umu-curūzi (aba-) - trader, merchant

in-cuti (in-)(43) - friend
kurangwaho ubucuti - to be friendly

ubu-cuti (no pl.) - friendship

gu-cyāha (shye) - to rebuke, reprimand

cyāne (inv.)(2) - very, much, exceedingly

cyāne cyāne - especially, mostly

cyāngwa (55) - or

i-cyēnda (37) - nine

i-cyi (5e cl., no pl.) - dry season (June-September)

umu-cyo (imi-)(5) - light

gu-cyōcyōra (ye) - to jest, poke fun at

gu-cyūra (ye) - to send back, lead home (cows)
gucyura umugore - to marry woman who has left husband, bring back one's wife who had left

gu-cyūrira (ye) umuntu - to taunt, constantly remind one of his faults

gu-cyuya (ye) - to fade

D

in-da (in-)(105) - louse

in-da (in-)(104) - stomach, pregnancy

uru-daca (no pl.) - long, interminable

ama-dahano (no sing.) - perfumed ointment (not often used)

in-dahemuka - faithful one

ku-dahemuka - to be faithful

daimoni (aba-) - demon

in-dakemwa (in-) - perfect

i-dakika (ama-)(62) - minute

ku-damarara (ye) - to have luxury

ama-darubindi - glasses (spectacles)

in-dasāgo (in-) - vaccination, scar from cut

iki-dasesa (ibi-) - woven grass mat, door mat, solar energy panel

dāta (bā dāta)(73) - my, our father

dātabuja (ba) - my, our master, employer (male)

dātabukwe (ba-) - my, our father-in-law
mābukwe - my, our mother-in-law
nyokobukwe - your mother-in-law
nyirabukwe - his, her, their mother-in-law
sōbukwe - your father-in-law
sēbukwe - his, her, their father-in-law

dāta wacu (wanyu, wabo) - paternal uncle

de - exceedingly white

ku-dedemānga (nze) - to babble, speak indistinctly

in-dege (in-) - airplane

in-dēmbe (in-) - a dying person

i-denariyo (ama-) - denarius (Roman coin)

umu-dēndēzo (no pl.) - liberty, freedom

ubu-deshyi (no pl.) - idleness, laziness

umu-digaferi (imi-) - loquat

in-dimu (in-)(91) - lemon, orange

ku-dīndiza (-je) - to hinder progress

in-diri (in-) - interior, den

in-dirimbo (in-)(31) - song, hymn

i-dirishya (ama-)(77) - window

in-dobo (in-)(63) - pail, bucket

ku-doda (ze)(83) - to sew

uru-dodo (in-) - thread

in-dogoba (in-) - donkey

umu-domo (imi-) - jug

aka-domo (utu-) - something very tiny, punctuation mark

dore - look, here is (are) . . .

in-dorerwamo (in-) - mirror, glasses (eye)

ku-dudubiza (je) - to well up, spring up (water, blood)

imi-dugararo (no sing.) - noise, confusion, disorder (hinders work)

umu-dugudu (imi-) - city, town

i-duka (ama-) - store, shop

i-dukuru (ama-) - store, shop

in-dūru (in-) - cry of alarm

in-dwāra (in-)(17) - illness, sickness

in-dyanisha murizo - scorpion

in-dyankwi (in-)(65) - axe

E

w-e (3) - his, her (we, be, ye, etc.)

ebyiri (37) - two (with 3rd & 6th cl.)

kw-ēgamira (ye) - to lean against (ref. to person)

kw-ēgeka (tse) - to lean against

kw-ēgēra (reye)(106) - to draw near, approach

kw-ēgereza (je) - to bring near, cause to approach

urw-ēgo (inz-) - ladder

kw-ēguka (tse) - to straighten up

kw-ēgukira (ye) - to turn toward (e.g. to God), turn one's desires toward

kw-ēgurira (ye) - to give completely to
kwīyēgurira Imana - to give oneself to God, to live for God

kw-ēgurirwa Imana - to be holy

ejo (29) - tomorrow, yesterday
ejo bundi - day after tomorrow, day before yesterday

mw-embi (61) - both of you
tw-embi - both of us

kw-ēmera (ye)(36) - to agree to, accept, consent, admit, be willing

kw-enda (nze) - to take, accept, be about to

umw-ēnda (imy-)(5) - clothing, garment, cloth

umw-ēnda (imy-)(5) - debt

icy-ēnda - nine

am-ēndeze (no pl.) - harbinger, precursor,

incipience

mw-ēne (bēne)(101) - son of (first cl.)
mwēne se (nyina) - brother, sister

umw-ēne (ab-) gihugu - citizen, national

kw-ēnga (nze) - to make beer

umw-ēnge (imy-) - hole (in cloth, pot, object), eye of needle

ubw-ēnge (no pl.)(27) - wisdom, intelligence

enye (37) - four (with 3rd & 6th cl.)

kw-ēra (ze)(112) - to bear (fruit), ripen, be white, pure

umw-ēre (no pl.) - white, innocent

kw-ēreka (tse)(35) - to show

kw-ērekana (nye) - to show (tr.)

kw-ērekera (ye) - to turn toward, to be about
e.g. mvuga ibyerekeye. . . I'm talking about. . .

ibw-ērekeza - the back end of a boat

icy-ērekezo (iby-) - direction

kw-ērerana (nye) - to be very white

urw-ērerane - dazzling whiteness

umw-ēro (imy-) - maturity, harvest

kw-erura (ye) - to make plain, emphasize

kw-esa (esheje) umunyana - to succeed in part, but fail in part

kw-esa (she) - to throw down

ese - word used to ask question

eshanu (37) - five (with 3rd & 6th cl.)

eshatu (37) - three (with 3rd & 6th cl.)

esheshatu (37) - six (with 3rd & 6th cl.)

umw-ēte (no pl.)(82) - zeal, interest, enthusiasm
kugira umwete - to be zealous, earnest

kw-ēza (jeje)(112) - to make white, pure

am-ēza (no pl.)(19) - table

ukw-ēzi (am-)(32) - month, moon
ukwēzi kwa mbere - January, etc.
(for Rwanda names of months, see Eng.)

ukw-ēzwa (no pl.)(112) - holiness, purity of heart

F

i-faranga (ama-)(18) - franc, money

igi-faransa (no pl.) - French language

gu-fasha (shije)(22) - to help

gu-fata (she)(38) - to take hold of, grasp, seize, catch, treat (someone-manner)
e.g. amufata neza - he's good (kind) to him

gu-fatanya (nije) - to cooperate, have fellowship

i-fēza (ama-) - money, silver

i-fi (ama-)(11) - fish

gu-finda (nze) - to cast lots

-fite (no past, no inf.)(2) - have, has

gu-fobora (ye) - to speak plainly, clearly

gu-fora (ye) - to aim at, guess

gu-fotora (ye) - to take a picture (with camera)

i-fu (i-)(11) - flour, powder

ama-fu - cool at end of day, or at daybreak, coolness

gu-fudika (tse) - to err, make a mistake

umu-fuka (imi-)(88) - sack, pocket, purse, bag

umu-fundi (aba-)(56) - mason, skilled workman

gu-fūnga (nze)(Sw.) - to close, shut

gu-fūngāna (nye)(112) - to be narrow

igi-fungo (ibi-) - button

gu-fūngūra (ye)(Sw.) - to open

gu-fūngura (ye) - to eat, have a meal

i-fūnguro (ama-) - a meal

uru-fūngūzo (im-)(24) - key, bottle opener

im-fūngwa (im-) - prisoner

i-fūni (ama-) - worn out hoe

gu-funyanga (nze) - to knead (bread), to kick in womb (baby)

uru-fūnzo (im-) - green papyrus, swamp

i-fūra (or, ifūru)(i-)(63) - stove

im-fura (im-) or impfura (104) - first-born, nobleman, person of good manners

i-furo (no pl.) - froth, foam

im-furuka (im-) - corner (of room, house)

i-futi (ama-) - mistake

G

akā-ga (no pl.) - (see: ak-āga)

ku-gaba (bye) - to give (to an inferior), put forth (as branches)

umu-gabane (imi-) - part, (esp. part received)

ku-gabanuka (tse) - to diminish (int.)

ku-gabanya (nije) - to divide

ku-gabiza (je) - to turn someone over to police, etc.

in-gabo (in-) - army, soldiers

umu-gabo (aba-)(1) - man (married), husband, witness (male or female)

ku-gaburira (ye) - to feed, distribute food

ku-gaga (ze) - to be spoiled (of cooked food)

ku-gagaza (je) - to make stiff, stiffen

ku-gambana (nye) - to betray

umu-gāmbi (imi-) - plan, project

ku-gambirira (riye) - to decide, determine, plan, plan for

-gamije (no infinitive, no other form) - to have for a purpose
e.g. Agamije iki? - What is his purpose, aim?

in-gamiya (in-) - camel

ku-gana (nnye) - to go forward

umu-gana (imi-) - herd (of pigs only)

in-ganda (in-) - factory

umu-ganda (imi-) - group service

iki-gānde (ibi-) - disobedient person

in-gando (in-) - temporary shelter, hut

umu-ganga (aba-)(52) - doctor

ubu-ganga (no pl.) - fever, malaria

umu-gani (imi-)(71) - proverb, parable
guca umugani - to tell proverb, parable

ku-gānīra (riye)(94) - to visit, converse with

iki-gānīro (ibi-) - conversation

in-gano (in-)(63) - wheat

ingano, kutagira - to be measureless

ku-ganya (nye) - to moan, groan, wail, grieve

ama-ganya (no sing.) - complaints, worries, anxiety

ku-ganyira (ye) - to complain, fret

ku-ganza (je) - to rout, conquer, utterly defeat

iki-ganza (ibi-)(94) - hand

uru-gāra (in-) - brim, edge of cup

ku-garagara (ye) - to be visible, evident

ku mu-garagaro - openly, publicly

ku-garagaza (je) - to make visible, evident

umu-garagu (aba-)(124) - male servant

in-garagu (in-) - young single person (usually male)

ku-garama (mye) - to be flat, lie flat, be lazy

in-garane (in-) - compost pit

i-gāre (ama-) - bicycle, pram

-gari (8) - wide, broad

ubu-gari (no pl.) - width

ku-garuka (tse)(29) - to return, come back

in-garuka (in-) - results, repercussions, consequences

uru-garyi (no pl.) - short dry season, December and January

ku-gashya (shije) - to row

in-gashyi (in-) - paddle, oar

in-gata (in-) - grass pad for carrying load on head

iki-gata (ibi-) - wheel

umu-gati (imi-)(4)(Sw.) - bread

na gato - not at all

haba na gato - not at all

ku-gaya (ye)(84) - to scorn, despise

umu-gayo (imi-) - blame

in-gemu (in-) - sum paid to witchdoctor

ku-gena (nnye) - to plan for, decide

ku-genda (giye)(1) - to go, walk (no name of place follows), leave

ku-gendagenda (nze) - to go for a walk

ku-gendana (nye) - to go with, accompany

uru-gendo (in-)(71) - journey

ku-genera (ye) - to destine for (e.g. a certain use)

ubu-genere - plan, purpose, destiny (destination)

ku-genga (nze) - to govern, command, supervise

in-gengabihe (in-) - schedule

ku-gengarara (ye) - to head up (grain)

umu-gengararo (imi-) - head of grain (before filled out)

umu-geni (aba-) - bride

ka-geni, bene ako - like that way (manner) of doing

ibi-geni, bene ibyo - like that way (manner) of doing

ku-genza (je) - to treat, behave towards, spy on

ku-genzereza (je) - to find a chance to "get" somebody

imi-gēnzereze - how one lives, habitual way of acting

mu-genzi (ba-) - companion, friend, mate (in pair of things)

umu-genzi (aba-) - traveller

in-genzi (in-) - important, valuable
e.g. ikintu cy'ingenzi - an important thing

umu-genzo (imi-) - habit, practice, custom

ku-gēnzūra (ye) - to oversee, spy on, to test (see: 1 Tes. 2:4)

ku-gera (ze)(31, 96) - to arrive, measure, weigh, reach a certain point of time

ku-gerageza (je)(102) - to try, test, tempt, attempt

ku-gereka (tse) - to place on top of something else

umu-gereka (imi-) - supplementary

ku-gereranya (nije) - to compare, estimate

iki-gero (ibi-) - age
ikigero cyose - all ages

uru-gero (in-) - example, measure

ku-gesa (she)(99) - to harvest millet

in-gese (in-) - rust

in-geso (in-)(71) - trait, habit, characteristic

ku-geza (jeje) - to end with, until, reach, cause to arrive
kugeza aho (99) - until (with verb)
uhereye. . .kugeza. . . = from. . .to. . .

umu-gezi (imi-) - stream

i-gi (ama-)(18) - egg

umu-gi (imi-) - insect egg (esp. flea)

umu-gi (imi-) - city

uru-gi (see: ur-ūgi)

gihe ki? - when? at what time?

ku-gimba (mbye) - to be dull

ku-gingimira (ye) - to stutter, stammer

ku-gingimiranya (nije) - to hesitate, be fearful

ubu-gingo (no pl.)(27) - life

ku-gira (ze)(29) - to have, do, make

ku-gīra (riye) inama - to counsel, advise
kw-īgīra inama - to counsel together

ku-gira ngo (50) - so that, in order that, to suppose that, think

bi-girankana - intentionally, on purpose (usually something bad)

imi-girire - manner of doing, working, acting

iki-girwamana (ibi-) - idol

umu-gisha (imi-)(6) - blessing

in-gisha (in-) - charm, fetish

iki-gize cya nkana - intentionally

ubu-gizi bwa nabi - evil acts

uru-go (in-)(23) - kraal, enclosure, home, homestead

ku-goboka (tse) - to go to the help of someone, aid (unexpectedly)

in-goboka (in-) - unexpected help

in-gobyi (in-) - hammock, stretcher, placenta, skin used to tie baby on back

in-gofero (in-)(39) - hat

umu-gogo (imi-)(115) - log, foot-bridge, small bridge

ku-goma (mye) - to openly rebel, revolt, disobey

in-goma (in-)(12) - drum, reign

ka-goma (3rd cl.) - eagle

ku-gõmba (mbye)(93) - must, must have, to lack, need

in-gõmbwa (in-) - something essential, necessary

umu-gome (aba-) - rebel

ubu-gome (no pl.) - revolt, rebellion

uru-gomo (in-), gucura - to play with others, fool around, have a party

umu-gõngo (imi-) - back (of person, animal) kuba mu mugongo - to have period (female)

ku-gõra (ye) - to be difficult, troublesome

ku-gorama (mye) - to be crooked

in-gõrane (in-) - problem, difficulties

umu-gore (aba-)(1) - woman (married), wife

iki-gõri (ibi-)(15) - corn, maize

ku-goroba (bye) - to become evening

umu-goroba (imi-)(29) - evening (2:00-6:00), usually: ni mugoroba

i-gorofa (ama-) - story (of house)

ku-gorora (ye) - to make straight

in-gororano (in-) - recompense, reward

ku-gororera (reye) - to recompense, reward

ku-gororoka (tse) - to be straight, righteous

ama-gõrwa (no sing.)(43) - troubles, difficulties

ku-gõrwa (we)(112) - to be unfortunate

ku-gota (se) - to surround, hem in, encircle

in-goyi (in-) - bonds

umu-gozi (imi-)(6) - string, rope, cord

ku-gubwa nēza (guwe)(85) - to be rich, fortunate, have pleasant experience

-gufi (8) - short, low, shallow

bu-gufi - near
bugufi bwa. . . - near something

i-gufwa (ama-)(113) - bone

ku-guma (mye)(33) - to stay, remain

uru-guma (in-)(88) - wound

i-gunira (ama-) - sack, burlap

ku-gura (ze)(25) - to buy

ku-gurana (nye) - to borrow, exchange (actual article to be replaced)

i-guriro (ama-) - market place

ku-gurisha (shije)(25) - to sell

ku-guriza (je) - to borrow, lend (article to be replaced)

uku-guru (ama-)(32) - leg

in-gurube (in-)(52) - pig

ku-guruka (tse) - to fly

in-gurumira (in-) y'umuriro - fever

ku-gusha (shije) - to cause to fall

ku-guza (jije) - to lend, borrow (esp. money)

ama-guzanyo (no sing.) - loan

iki-guzi (ibi-) - price

in-gwa (in-) - chalk, lime

ku-gwa (guye)(48) - to fall

ku-gwa mu kantu - to be dumbfounded, nonplussed, discouraged, troubled

ku-gwa agacuho - to be exhausted (from work)

ku-gwa gitumo - to surprise, grab unexpectedly

umu-gwanēza (aba-) - kind, gentle person

ubu-gwanēza (no pl.) - kindness, gentleness

in-gwe (in-)(76) - leopard

iki-gwi (ibi-) - stead, place

ku-gwira (riye) - to multiply (int.)

ku-gwira (riye) isari - to faint from hunger

ku-gwiza (jije) - to multiply (tr.)

H

gu-ha (haye)(57) - to give to

gu-haba (bye) - to wander about without hope of finding the way, be lost

gu-habuka (tse) - to find the way after being lost

gu-hābwa (hawe)(85) - to be given, receive

hāfi (47) - near, nearby

gu-hāga (ze)(117) - to eat a lot, be satisfied

gu-hagarara (ze)(68) - to stand, stop (int.), wait

gu-hagararira (ye) - to represent, be in place of another temporarily

gu-hagarika (tse)(68) - to stop (tr.) as car, person

gu-hagarika umutima - to be very troubled, frightened, anxious

ubu-hagarike (no pl.) - height

hagati (118) - in the middle, midst

-hagije (no pres. form) - to be sufficient, enough
e.g. birahagije - it's enough

uru-hago (imp-) - bladder, small woven sack

gu-haguruka (tse)(68) - to stand up

gu-hagurutsa (kije) - to cause one to stand

gu-haha (shye) - to buy (esp. food), go to buy, look for food

gu-hakana (nye) - to deny, refuse

hākuno (118) - on this side of (body of water, valley)

hākurya (118) - on other side of (water or valley)

gu-hama (mye) - to remain, stay

gu-hamagara (ye)(66) - to call

gu-hāmba (mbye) - to bury

gu-hāmbira (riye) - to tie up, wrap

gu-hāmbuka (tse) - to be loosed, untied

i-hāmbwa - burial

mu ru-hame (no pl.) - publicly, in a meeting

gu-hamiriza (je) - to witness to, to dance the war (intore) dance

hamwe (119) - together, at one place

hamwe na hamwe - here and there, at some places

gu-hamya (mije) - to witness, affirm, testify

gi-hamya - proof, evidence

ubu-hamya (no pl.) - witness (words), testimony

impamyabushobozi (im-) - diploma

gu-hana (nnye)(57) - to punish, scold

gu-hāna (nye) - to abandon

gu-hāna (nye)(57) - to give to each other

umu-hana (imi-)(92) - locality, neighborhood

gu-hanagura (ye)(106) - to dust, rub, polish, wipe off

umu-hānda (imi-) - road

uru-hānde (impānde)(119) - side
iruhānde ya - beside

ama-hāne (no sing.) - quarrel, dispute, sauciness

gu-hānga (nze) - to introduce something
guhānga umuntu - to possess, enter into

gu-hānga (nze) - invent, create, begin

umu-hānga (aba-) - skilled person

igi-hānga (ibi-) - head (of something dead)

ama-hānga (sing. ishyānga) - foreign country, nation, peoples

uru-hānga (imp-) - forehead

ubu-hānga (no pl.) - skill

gu-hangana (nye) - to withstand, face someone

gu-hangana amāso - to stare at each other

igi-hāngange (ibi-) - giant

gu-hangāra (ye) - to dare (to do something bad), to harm
e.g. bumva ko nta cyabahangara - they feel that nothing can hurt them

gu-hangayika (tse) - to be anxious, worried

umu-hango (imi-) - custom, ceremony, ritual

i-hāngu - amanywa y'ihāngu - sunny time of day

gu-hānguka (tse) - to pass away, to end dry season

gu-hangwaho (zweho) - to be possessed by

gu-hanika (tse) - to be superior
e.g. ishuri rihanitse - higher school
amafaranga ahanitse - a great deal of money

umu-hānjuzi (aba-) - trader, merchant

hano (12) - here, this place

igi-hano (ibi-)(93) - punishment

gu-hanuka (tse) - to fall from above

gu-hanūra (ye)(106) - to warn, advise (gently), counsel, scold, prophesy, foretell

umu-hanūzi (aba-) - prophet, seer

hanyuma (61) - afterwards
hanyuma ya - inferior to

hānze (14) - outside (of a house)

gu-hara (ze) - to give up something loved

gu-haranira (ye) - to strive for

uru-hare (no pl.) - place, part, participation
kugira uruhare - to have a part in

hari (12) - there is, are
hariho - there exist(s)
hāriho - once upon a time there was

harīya (12) - over there

haruguru (118) - higher up, up there

gu-harura (ye) - to scrape, scratch, dig just top of soil

hāsi (33) - on the ground, floor, bottom

gu-hāta (se)(63) - to peel with knife

gu-hāta (se) - to force, compel

umu-hati (no pl.) - zeal, earnestness, courage

hatinze - with delay, late, later on

hato, hatoya - later on (same day)

hato na hato - again and again, repeatedly

gu-haza (gije) - to satisfy, be sufficient, enough

igi-haza (ibi-) pumpkin, marrow

he? (12) - where? (in questions only)
hehe? - where?

-he? (97) - which? (in questions only)

igi-he (ibi-)(43) - time, at the time when

gu-heba (bye)(88) - to fail to find, not find

umu-heha (imi-) - water pipe, hollow straw

gu-heheta (se) - to lust strongly

hejuru (118) - on the top, on high, above

gu-heka (tse) - to carry on one's back, on a stretcher, give a ride

gu-hekenya (nye) - to chew

igi-heko (ibi-) - charm, fetish

gu-hēmba (mbye)(43) - to pay (for work done)

i-hēmbe (ama-)(45) - horn (of animal)

imi-hēmberwe - salaries

igi-hēmbo (ibi-) - wage, salary

igi-hēmbwe (ibi-) - quarter (of year), trimester

umu-hemu (aba-) - dishonest person (doesn't do what's agreed upon)

ubu-hemu - dishonesty

gu-hemuka (tse) - to be unfaithful, to fail someone, be dishonest

gu-hemura (ye) - to treat very badly, kill

gu-hēnda (nze)(50) - to deceive, extort, overcharge

gu-hēndahenda (nze) - to beg earnestly, try to persuade, to quiet, calm someone

ibi-hēndo (no sing.) - deceitfulness

gu-hēnduka (tse) - to be a bargain, cheap

i-hene (ihene)(11) - goat

ama-henehene - goat's milk

hēnga (or, hīnga) - let, come on, very well, just a minute

umu-hengeri (no pl.) - purple (not used much)

umu-hēngeri (imi-) - storm on water

imu-hēngeri - in the middle (or depth) of lake

ama-henure - very short dress
e.g. umwēnda w'amahenure

hēpfo (118) - lower down, below

gu-hēra (reye) - to start with (from), to give to

gu-hera (ze) - to come to an end, be last, disappear

aga-hera (udu-) - little finger

gu-hērako (hēreyeko) - to immediately. . .

gu-herekeza (je) - to escort, accompany

im-perekeza (im-) - friend of bridegroom (best man)

gu-hererana (nye) - to be beside, near (of places)

gu-hērerekanya (nije) - to transmit from one to another

ubu-heri (no pl.) - itch, scabies

gu-heruka (tse) - to be last, come last, have done recently
e.g. sindaheruka kukubona - I haven't seen you recently

gu-herutsa (kije) - to have or make come last

umu-heto (imi-) - bow (as with arrows)

gu-hēza (jeje) - to send away, refuse permission to enter

mu muhēzo - entrance forbidden
e.g. Nta nama zibera mu muhēzo. - No committees are private (excluding anyone).

gu-hīga (ze)(115) - to hunt for game

gu-hīhibikana (nye) - to follow earnestly after

gu-himba (mbye) - invent, write (poem, story)

gu-himbaza (je)(124) - to praise

gu-hina (nnye) - to sum up, give resumé, fold arms, bend knees

aga-hinda (no pl.)(26) - sorrow, grief

gu-hinda (nze) - to thunder
guhinda umushitsi - to shake, tremble

gu-hindaga (ze) - to thunder

Umu-hindi (Aba-) - Hindu, Indian

umu-hindo (no pl.) - rainy season (Sept-Nov)

gu-hinduka (tse) - to change, become, be changed

gu-hindukira (ye)(98) - to turn around (int.)

gu-hindukiza (je)(98) - to turn around (tr.)

gu-hindura (ye) - to change (tr.)

gu-hīnga (nze)(1) - to cultivate, hoe, dig

gu-hīnguka (tse) - to arrive

gu-hīngutsa (kije) - to place, cause to appear (as in court)

umu-hini (imi-) - hoe handle

uru-hīnja (impīnja)(24) - infant (up to one month)

hīno (118) - on this side (of certain place)

gu-hinyuka (tse) - to displease, disappoint, be unfaithful

gu-hinyura (ye) - to scorn, criticize (in a bad way)

umu-hīnzi (aba-) - gardener, cultivator

imu-hira (no pl.)(11) - at home

gu-hirika (tse) - to turn upside down, push away

gu-hīrwa (riwe) - to be fortunate, blessed

ama-hīrwe - good fortune, blessing

hīrya (118) - beyond (a certain place)

hīrya no hīno - hither and yon, to and fro

gu-hisha (she)(103) - to hide (tr.)

gu-hīsha (shije)(92) - to ripen, burn (tr.)

gu-hishura (ye) - to reveal

umu-hisi (aba-) - passer-by

gu-hita (se) - to pass by (a certain place)

gu-hitamo (semo) - to choose

gu-hitwa (swe) - to have diarrhea

hōbe - greetings, hello

gu-hobera (ye) - to embrace (arm across the back)

gu-hoberana (nye) - to embrace each other

umu-hoberano (imi-) - hug

hogi - (or, nimuhogi)(usually followed by tugende) - come on, let's go

umu-hogo (imi-) - throat

i-hoho (no pl.) - excellence, superbness

gu-homa (mye) - to plaster

gu-homba (mbye) - to suffer loss (esp. financial)

igi-hombo (ibi-) - deficit, loss

gu-hōmboka (tse) - to speak without thinking

gu-hondagura (ye) - to knock down, smash

umu-hondo (no pl.) - yellow

gu-honga (nze) - to change expression (due to bad news), to wilt

gu-honoka (tse) - to survive (a calamity)

gu-hora (ze)(112) - to always, continually, to cool (int.), be quiet

gu-hōra (ye) - to avenge

gu-horera (reye) - to make sound like approaching rain

ama-horo (no sing.)(19) - peace (often used in greetings)

i-horo (ama-) - rent, pay for trip (as in boat), fare

gu-horota (se) - to be thin

hōse (41) - everywhere

gu-hosha (sheje) - to stop, prevent (esp. of something strong, as battle, argument, etc.)

hoshi! - be off with you!

gu-hotora (ye) - to twist cords, wring the neck

gu-hōza (jeje) - to receive fare, rent

igi-hu (ibi-) - fog, haze

igi-hu (ibi-) - eggshell

uru-hu (impu)(24) - skin, hide

gu-hubuka (tse) - to fall from above, to crowd

gu-huga (ze) - to forget for the moment, be busy

gu-hugīrwa (we) - to be busy, occupied

igi-hugu (ibi-)(13) - country, region

ama-hugu - pillage, robbing

gu-huguka (tse) - to be intelligent, skilled, capable

gu-hugura (ye) - to arouse, inform, urge to correct one's ways

i-huguriro (ama-) - workshop, place of counsel

gu-huguza (je) - to seize property of another

gu-huha (shye) - to blow (as wind)

gu-huhwa (shywe) - to be light (weight)

gu-huma (mye) - to be blind

gu-humagurika (tse) - to be totally blind

gu-humana (nye) - to be defiled (by breaking taboo), have skin disease (supposedly caused by breaking taboo)

gu-humanuka (tse) - to become clean

gu-humanura (ye) - to make ceremonially clean (as after breaking taboo)

gu-humanya (nije) - to make unclean, defile

aga-hūmbagiza (udu-) - million

aga-humbi (udu-) one hundred thousand

igi-humbi (ibi-) - thousand

uru-hūmbu (no pl.) - mold, mildew

gu-humeka (tse)(122) - to breathe

gu-humiriza (je) - to close the eyes

gu-humuka (tse) - to regain sight

gu-hūmura (ye) - to smell, good or bad

gu-humura (ye) - to restore sight

gu-hūmura (ye) - to be comforted, be quiet

gu-humuriza (je) - to comfort, console, encourage

gu-humuza (je) - to flavor, make (taste, smell) good

gu-hūmuza (je) - to be concluded, ended (as meeting)

igi-huna (ibi-) - a kind of bananas

ga-hunda (no pl.) - program, system, organization, orderliness, list

i-hundo (ama-) - head of grain (esp. Kaffir corn)

gu-hunga (nze)(98) - to flee

umu-hūngu (aba-)(1) - boy, son

gu-hungura (ye) - to shell (as corn)

gu-hungura (ye) - to marry brother's widow

gu-hunika (tse) - to store crops in granary

gu-hunikira (ye) - to nod (sleepy)

igi-hūnyira (ibi-) - owl

gu-hunza (je) amaso - to turn away one's eyes

gu-hūra (ye) - to meet

ubu-hura (no pl.) - little insects that supposedly make honey

i-hūriro (ama-) - meeting place, similarity
ihūriro ryo kunagūra - workshop

igi-huru (ibi-) - thick bush, scrub

gu-hurura (ye) - to go out against (as soldiers), run out with crowd

ama-hurunguru - goat manure

uru-hushya (impushya)(108) - permission, time off, vacation, rest
gusaba uruhushya - to ask for time off

Umu-hutu (aba-) - one of ethnic groups among Banyarwanda

i-hwa (ama-)(111) - thorn

igi-hwayihwayi (ibi-) - thing that is voluminous but light in weight

gu-hwema (mye) - to cease, grow weary, rest, relax

I

i (11) - to, at, from

kw-ība (bye)(58) - to steal, steal from

kw-ībagirwa (we)(36) - to forget

kw-ībāna (nye) - to live alone

kw-ībanda (nze) ku - to concentrate on, give oneself wholly to
also: kwībanda kurya. . . to be very fond of a food

kw-ibiza (je) - to put in water and take out (only of part of body, person)

icy-ībo (iby-)(97) - small, flat basket (no lid)

ubw-ībone (no pl.) - pride

kw-ibuka (tse)(36) - to remember, recall

n-ībura - at least

by-ībura - at least

kw-iburanya (nije) - to question, reason about

kw-ibutsa (kije) - to remind

kw-ibwira (ye) - to think

kw-īca (ishe)(50) - to kill

umw-īcanyi (ab-)(101) - murderer

kw-īcara (ye)(96) - to sit down

kw-īcira (ye) - to kill for

icy-iciro (iby-) - group, section (as, group assigned to certain task, but not a permanent group), session

kw-īcisha (shije) - to cause to kill

kw-icuma (mye) - to go ahead, move on a bit further

kw-icunda (nze) - to swing (as child)

icyakora - however

kw-īfasha (shije) - to help oneself

kw-īfata (she) - to behave

imy-īfatire (no sing.) - behavior, conduct

umw-īfato (imy-) - behavior, conduct

kw-īfubika (tse) - to cover oneself with, wrap around oneself

kw-īfuza (je)(117) - to covet, long for, desire

kw-īga (ze)(35) - to learn, study

kw-īgana (nye) - to imitate

kw-īganyira (ye) - to worry, be anxious

kw-īgaragura (ye) - to thrash around (as sick person does)

kw-īgendera (ye) - to go by oneself

ubw-īgenge (no pl.) - independence

kw-īgera (ze) - to have ever (e.g. sinīgeze mbona. . . - I've never seen), to reach (esp. time)

kw-īgerezaho (jeho) - to be presumptuous, daring

imy-īgire (no sing.) - manner of study

kw-īgisha (shije)(35) - to teach

umw-īgisha (ab-)(2) - teacher

imy-īgishirize (no sing.) - manner of teaching

iny-īgisho (iny-) - doctrines, teachings

icy-īgisho (iby-) - lesson, teachings

umw-īgishwa (ab-)(2) - pupil, student

kw-īgomwa (mwe) - to give up, sacrifice, fast

kw-īhana (nnye)(35) - to repent, confess

kw-īhandagaza - to be (or make oneself) apparent, obvious

kw-īhangana (nye)(91) - to be patient, endure

kw-īhangiriza (je) - to warn, threaten (as, warn not to tell)

umw-īhariko (imy) - personal property

kw-īharira (ye) - to be special, for a special purpose
e.g igitabo cyīhariye - aspecial book, not like others

kw-īheba (bye) - to despair

kw-īherera (reye) - to be alone

kw-īhorera (reye) - to be silent, leave someone alone (i.e. not bother)

kw-īhugura (ye) - to find out, learn, be informed

kw-īhuta (se) - to hurry

urw-ījiji (no pl.) - haze

kw-ījima (mye) - to be dark, get dark, appear sad

umw-ījima (no pl.)(5) - darkness, liver

kw-ījujuta (se) - to murmur (discontent)

kw-īkanyiza (je) - to be selfish, stingy

iki? (22) - what?

iki - this

kw-īkira (ye) - to get into boat

kw-īkorera (ye) - to carry on head

kw-īkubita (se) imbere - to fall down before (in respect)

kw-īkubura (ye) - to withdraw quickly

kw-īkunda (nze) - to love oneself

kw-īma (mye) - to withhold, refuse to give

by-īmazeyo - finally, once and for all, completely

imbere (see: im-bere)

icy-imbo (iby-) - stead, place
e.g. mu cyimbo cye - in his place

kw-īmuka (tse) - to move (as, dwelling)
bīmukiyemo - they moved to
bīmutsemo - they moved from

urw-īna (inz-) - big hole in ground (esp. underground oven for making bananas ripen)

kw-īnangira (ye) umutima - to harden one's heart

kw-īnezeza (jeje) - to please oneself, enjoy oneself

kw-īnginga (nze)(59) - to beseech, plead with

kw-īnjira (ye)(38) - to enter

ino (62) - here, in this vicinity

-īnshi (8) - much, many
ubw-īnshi - quantity

kw-īnuba (bye) - to complain

kw-īnyagambura (ye) - to move (int.)

iry-īnyo (amēnyo)(18) - tooth

kw-īra (je) - to get late (in day), get dark
e.g. burīje - it's getting late, dark

inz-ira (inz-)(17) - path, way

ubw-īra (no pl.) - haste
kugira ubwīra - to be in a hurry

kw-īrabura (ye) - to be black

ubw-irakabiri - eclipse, darkness in daytime

ubw-īrase - pride

kw-īrata (se) - to boast, be proud

kw-īregura (ye) - to defend oneself (against accusation)

kw-īrenga (nze) - to strongly affirm (with a certain arm gesture)

kw-īrengagiza (je) - to neglect, overlook, procrastinate

ah-īrengeye - a high place

kw-īrenza (nje) - to throw behind one's back

kw-īrimbisha (shije) - to wash and comb oneself

kw-īrinda (nze) - to keep, guard yourself from, be careful

kw-īringira (ye) - to trust, rely on, hope, expect

icy-īringiro (iby-) - hope. expectation

ubw-īringiro (no pl.) - hope, trust, confidence

umw-īrondoro (imy-) - description (e.g. personal information)

kw-īroha (shye) - to rush upon, push

ubw-īru (no pl.) - secret (stronger word than ibanga), mystery

kw-īruka (tse)(72) - to run

kw-īrukana (nye) - to chase away, run after

kw-īrukanka (nze) - to run very fast

kw-īsegura (ye) - to lie on pillow, to apologize (before accusation)

kw-īshima (mye)(103) - to be happy, glad, rejoice, be satisfied

iby-īshimo - joy, gladness

ubw-īshingizi (no pl.) - backing, support
kuba afite ubwīshingizi - to be bonded

kw-īshisha (she) - to fear, mistrust

kw-īshyura (ye)(124) - to repay, make restitution, pay debt

umw-īshywa (ab-) - nephew, niece (child of a man's sister)

kw-īsomera (ye) - to read for oneself

imy-īsozi (no sing.) - tears

kw-īsukura (ye) - to cleanse, purify oneself

kw-īsuzuma (mye) - to examine oneself

kw-īta (itaye)(83) - to pay attention to, care for (usually: kwīta ku. . ., or kwītaho)

kw-īta (se)(83) - to name, call (only in sense of "to name")

kw-ītaba (bye)(75) - to answer (when called)

kw-ītanga (nze) - to give oneself, self-surrender

kw-ītarura (ye) - to separate oneself, distance oneself

ubw-īteganirize (no pl.) - pension

icy-ītegererezo (iby-) - example, model

kw-ītegereza (je) - to look at intently

kw-ītema (mye)(69) - to cut oneself (as finger) - nitemye urutoke

umw-ītero (imy-) - cloth women wear over shoulder

kw-ītonda (nze)(67) - to be careful, cautious

kw-ītondera (ye) - to keep, obey (law, command), pay attention to, be careful about

kw-ītonganya (nije) - to fuss, complain (as baby)

kw-ītotomba (mbye) - to complain

kw-ītoza (-jeje) - to exercise, practice, inculcate

kw-ītsamura (ye) - to sneeze

ak-ītso (utw-) - period (punctutation), comma

kw-ītuga, amafaranga yo - bribe

kw-ītura (ye) umuntu inēza - to return a kindness
or, kwītura. . . inābi - to return an evil

kw-ītwararika (tse) - to be concerned about

umw-ītwarariko (imy-) - responsibility, concern

urw-ītwazo (inz-) - excuse

kw-īvovota (se) - to complain, murmur

kw-īyaka (tse) - to deprive oneself of

kw-īyama (mye) - to rebuke, warn

kw-īyandarika (tse) - to be careless in personal appearance

kw-īyereka (tse) - to show oneself, exercise, do gym

kw-īyiriza (je) ubusa - to go all day without food, fast

kw-īyizi (no past) - to know oneself

kw-īyorosa (she) - to cover oneself in bed

kw-īyoza (-geje) amenyo - to brush teeth

ubw-īyubahe (no pl.) - dignity, self-respect

kw-īyubaka (tse) - to build oneself

kw-īyuhagira (ye) - to bathe oneself

kw-īyumvira (riye) - to think about (without speaking), be in deep thought

kw-īyunga (nze) - to unite (tr.) (implies previous separation)

-īza (8) - good, beautiful, pretty, nice, satisfactory, in good order

ubw-īza (85) - glory, beauty

kw-īzanira (ye) - to bring for oneself

kw-īzera (ye)(32, 35) - to trust, believe, faith, belief

imy-īzerere (no sing.) - beliefs, doctrines

kw-īzihiza (je) - to celebrate, cause to rejoice

J

umu-ja (aba-)(124) - female servant

ku-jabika (tse) - to put in water (and then take out, as fingers)

i-jambo (amagambo)(18) - word

i-jana (amagana)(38) - hundred

in-jangwe (in-)(26) - cat (tame or wild)

ku-jarajara (ye) - to go from place to place

ku-jegajega (ze) - to shake (int.), move

in-jiji (in-) - ignorant person

uru-jijo (no pl.) - mystery
e.g. kutubera urujijo -to be a mystery to us

ku-jijūka (tse) - to be informed, knowledgeable, come out of ignorance

ubu-jijūke (no pl.) - knowledge, intelligence, skill

ku-jijura (ye) - to instruct, remove ignorance

ku-jijwa (jwe) - to not know, be ignorant of

umu-jinya (no pl.) - grudge, long-lasting anger

i-jīsho (amāso)(18) - eye
kuba māso - to be on guard
mu māso hāwe (33) - your face

i-joro (ama-)(39) - night

i-josi (ama-) - neck

ku-jugunya (nye)(22) - to throw away,

empty out, discard

ku-jūjubya (bije) - to attack, conquer, pester

iki-jumba (ibi-)(13) - sweet potato

ama-june (no sing.) - deep sorrow

umu-jura (aba-)(39) - thief

ku-jurira (ye) - to appeal to higher court

i-juru (ama-)(85) - sky, heaven

i-jwi (ama-)(59) - voice
ijwi rirenga - a loud voice
gucīsha mu majwi - to take a vote

ku-jya (giye)(6) - to go, walk (place stated); to always, continually

ama-jyambere - progress, development

ku-jyana (nye)(50) - to take, go with

umu-jyanama (aba-) - steward, advisor, member of council, or committee

uru-jya n'uruza - goings and comings

mu ma-jyā ruguru - north

jyenyine - I alone

mu ma-jyēpfo - south

jyewe (48) - I, me

umu-jyi (imi-)(92) - city, large town

aka-jyiko (utu-)(63) - teaspoon

K

in-ka (in-)(7) - cow

mu-ka (ba-) - wife of

igi-ka (ibi-) - section, part

kabiri (37) - twice, two

gu-kabya (bije) - to exaggerate, be too much
bikabije - extremely

gu-kama (mye) - to milk, dry up, stop bleeding

i-kāmba (ama-) - crown

gu-kāmbakamba (mbye) - to crawl (baby)

umu-kambwe (aba-) - father (old); old man

gu-kāmura (ye) - to wring out, squeeze (as, lemons)

Umu-kanada (Aba-) - Canadian

kanāka - so and so

gu-kāndagira (ye) - to tread on

umu-kāndara (imi-) - belt

kāndi (17) - and, and also, as well, furthermore, moreover

gu-kānga (nze) - to startle, frighten

gu-kangara (ye) - to warn, threaten

in-kangara (in-) - basket made with strips of bamboo

gu-kāngarana (nye) - to be seized with terror

gu-kangisha (shije) - to threaten, intimidate by

ibi-kangisho (no sing.) - threatenings, threats

gu-kanguka (tse)(89) - to awaken (int.)

gu-kangura (ye)(89) - to awaken (tr.)

umu-kangurambaga (aba-) - animator, promoter, one who stirs up enthusiasm

gu-kankamira (ye) - to scold loudly

umu-kannyi (aba-) - tanner (one who tans hides)

i-kanya (ama-)(63) - fork, rake

i-kanzu (ama-) - robe, dress

i-kara (ama-) - hot coal, charcoal

gu-karaba (bye)(42) - to wash one's hands

uru-karakara (in-) - unburned bricks

i-karamu (ama-)(55) - pencil

gu-karanga (nze)(63) - to fry, broil

kare (51) - early, on time

gu-kata (-se) - to cut

gu-kātaza (je) - to hurry

aga-kāto (udu-) - comma

i-kāwa (61) - coffee (tree, or drink)

gu-kayuka (tse) - to lose flavor

-ke, -keya (8) - few

gu-keba (bye)(65) - to cut in pieces (meat, vegetable, cloth)

gu-kebaguza (je) - to look all around

umu-kebe (imi-) - small tin box with lid

ubu-kebe (no pl.) - property

umu-kēcuru (aba-) - old woman

gu-kēka (tse)(82) - to suspect, suppose, think

in-keke (in-) - urgent need, worry, anxiety

ama-kemwa (no sing.) - reproach, fault, blame

gu-kena (nnye)(91) - to be needy, poor

in-kende (in-)(101) - monkey (small gray)

umu-kene (aba-)(21) - poor man, pauper

ubu-kene (no pl.)(28) - poverty, need

gu-kēnga (nze) - to suspicion, mistrust

ama-kēnga (no sing.) - suspicions, suspects

umu-keno (imi-) - poverty (stronger than ubukene)

kenshi (61) - often

umu-kenyero (imi-) - long skirt

gu-kenyeza (je) - to tie something around waist, put on belt

kēra (72) - long ago, far in the future

in-kēre (or, inkēri) (in-)(89) - berries

gu-kerensa (sheje) - to waste

gu-kērereza (je) - to make someone (something) late

gu-kērerwa (we) - to be late

i-kereta (no pl.) - sour, bitey, sharp

keretse - except

uru-kero (in-)(65) - saw

gu-kēsha (sheje) - to have, thanks to. . . e.g. Yesu niwe dukēsha imigisha yose. - It's thanks to Jesus that we have all blessings.

bu-kēye (28, 119) - the next day, afterwards

bwa-kēye (from gu-ca)(28) - it has dawned

-ki? (116) - what kind of?

ubu-ki (no pl.) - honey

mu ru-kiga - in the country

gu-kīkira (ye) - to take on one's lap

gu-kīkiza (je) - to surround

uru-kīko (in-) - tribunal, court
abanyarukīko - judges

ama-kimbirane (no sing.) - argument, disagreement, provocation

gu-kina (nye)(91) - to play
gu-kinana (nye) - to play with

gu-kīnda (nze) - to rape

umu-kīndo (imi-) - palm tree

gu-kinga (nze)(117) - to shut, lock (door)

igi-kīngi (ibi-) - door post

gu-kingiriza (je) - to prevent from seeing, hide (tr.) from sight

uru-kingo (in-) - vaccination

gu-kingura (ye)(117) - to open, unlock

umu-kino (imi-) - game

igi-kino (ibi-) - game

gu-kira (ze)(88) - to get well, heal (int.), be rich

gu-kiranirwa (niwe) - to be wicked

gu-kiranuka (tse) - to be righteous, be in agreement

umu-kiranutsi (aba-) - righteous person

umu-kire (aba-)(21) - rich person

ubu-kire - riches, wealth

ama-kiriro (no sing.) - source of salvation, thing that saves, heals

gu-kiza (jije)(33) - to save, heal, rescue, cure

umu-kiza (aba-)(3) - savior

aga-kiza (no pl.)(26) - salvation

gu-kizwa (jijwe)(46) - to be saved, healed, cured

ko - why?

ko (45) - that (to introduce a dependent clause)

umu-koba (imi-) - whip (as of leather, rubber)

umu-kōbwa (aba-)(1) - girl, daughter

koko - that's true, that's a fact, indeed

in-koko (in-)(21) - chicken
mu nkoko - at cock crowing (about 4:00 a.m.)

in-kōko (in-) - flat basket

gu-koma (mye) - to prevent, protect, hinder, speak, clap

gu-komanga (nze) - to knock

igi-komangoma (ibi-) - prince, one related to king

gu-komatanya (nije) - to group things together

in-kombe (in-) - bank, shore of lake, river

igi-kombe (ibi-)(61) - tin container, cup

gu-komera (ye)(64) - to be hard, difficult, sturdy, strong, important
komera - excuse me (when causing or seeing physical harm or near accident)

gu-komereka (tse) - to be wounded, hurt, injured

gu-komeza (je) - to continue, carry on, to keep, make strong

gu-komoka (tse) - to descend from, be born of

in-komoko (in-) - origin, inception

gu-komora (ye) - to get one's origin from

umu-kōndo (imi-) - navel, a little metal pot with side opening, handle of cup, pail, etc.

gu-kōngeza (je) - to light, set afire

in-kongoro (in-) - milk pot

in-kōngoro - vulture

igi-koni (ibi-)(67) - kitchen

in-koni (in-)(80) - walking stick

gu-kōnja (nje)(64) - to be cold, damp

in-kono (in-) - clay cooking pot

gu-kora (ze)(1) - to work, do, repair; touch (with -ho, or ku)
e.g. ntukoreho - don't touch
gukora umugati (75) - to make bread
gukora mu ntoki - to shake hands
gukorwa n'isoni (93) - to be ashamed
(m)urakoze - thank you

gu-korana (nye) - to work together, meet together

i-koraniro (ama-) - meeting, get-together

gu-koranya (nije) - to gather together (tr.)

gu-korera (ye) - to work for

imi-korere - manner of working, acting

gu-koresha (sheje) - to use, cause to work

umu-koresha (aba-) - tax collector (umukoresha w'ikoro)

ubu-korikori - skill, craftsmanship

i-koro (ama-) - tax

gu-korogoshera (ye) - to dig into side of (as, side of hill)

in-koronga (in-) - turaco (bird)

gu-korora (ye)(96) - to cough

in-korora (in-)(96) - cough

umu-kororombya (imi-) - rainbow

ibi-koroti (or, ibikoroto) - change, coins

igi-korwa (ibi-) - action, deed

i-kosa (ama-) - mistake, error

in-kōta (in-) - sword

i-kōti (ama-) - coat, cloak, jacket

in-kovu (in-) - scar

gu-koza (jeje) - to cause to touch, touch with

umu-kozi (aba-)(3) - workman, employee

ku (5) - to, at, on, from (the side or outside of a thing)

gu-kuba (bye) - to multiply

ama-kuba (no sing.)(43) - troubles, misfortune

in-kuba (in-)(114) - thunder

kubēra (102) - because of (from kuba)

gu-kubita (se)(58) - to hit, beat, strike

mu-kubitarukoko (mi-) - index finger

gu-kubura (ye)(33) - to sweep

umu-kubuzo (imi-) - broom

kubwa (102) - because of, for the sake of, as for, in. . . (my) opinion

gu-kuka (tse) - to finish drinking (of animals)

gu-kūka (tse) - to return, come out of water, to leave a place

gu-kuka (tse) - to shake

gu-kuka (tse) umutima - to be terrified
ndakutse - I give up!

in-kuka (in-) - beach, shore

kuki? (109) - why?

kuko (27) - because

umu-kumbi (imi-) - flock of sheep

gu-kūmbura (ye)(114) - to be lonesome for, miss

uru-kūmbuzi (no pl.) - lonesomeness

in-kumi (in-)(52) - young lady (unmarried)

umu-kumirizi (aba-) - guard (by door of important person)

kumwe (119) - together (with particular reference to proximity)

igi-kumwe (ibi-) - thumb

gu-kūnda (nze)(17) - to love, like
gu-kūndana (nye) - to love each other
gukūnda urumamo - to pretend to love

gu-kūndira (ye) - to allow, like for

uru-kūndo (no pl.)(23) - love

gu-kūndwakaza (je) - to prefer one spouse over others, to take loving care of (Eph 5:29)

in-kūnga (in-) - support
gutera inkūnga - to encourage, support

gu-kungahaza (je) - to enrich, satisfy, fill

umu-kūngu (aba-) - rich person (in produce)

ubu-kūngu (no pl.) - riches (esp. produce)

umu-kūngugu (imi-) - dust

gu-kūnguta (se) - to shake (as rug)

gu-kunkumura (ye) - to shake (tr.)

gu-kura (ze)(79) - to grow (up)

gu-kūra (ye)(79) - to take away, subtract
gukūra ubwatsi - to thank for gift

kure (47) - far, far away

kuri (48) - at, to

igi-kuri (ibi-) - dwarf

gu-kurikira (ye)(55) - to follow

-kuru (8) - senior, important, old, great
mu-kuru (ba)(74) - older brother (of male), sister (of female), important person

in-kuru (in-)(75) - news

ama-kuru (no sing.)(75) - news

gu-kurubana (nye) - to drag along

igi-kurudumu (ibi-) - hoop

gu-kurura (ye)(106) - to pull

ibyo-kurya (no sing.) - food

i-kuta (ama-) - 1/10 of a franc (coin used formerly)

uru-kuta (in-) - wall

gu-kuyakuya (ye) - to protect, care for lovingly

kwa (52) - to, at the home of

gu-kwa (koye) - to pay dowry

in-kwāno (in-) - dowry

in-kwāre (in-) - partridge, quail

uru-kwāvu (in-)(76) - rabbit

umu-kwe (aba-) - bridegroom

ubu-kwe (no pl.)(123) - marriage, wedding

umu-kwēge (imi-) - wire

igi-kwerere (ibi-) - man of middle age, robust

imi-kwerere (no sing.) - middle age (30-50)

ubu-kwerere (no pl.) - middle age (30-50)

gu-kweta (se) - to put on sandals, shoes

in-kweto (in-)(92) - sandal, shoe

gu-kwetura (ye) - to take off sandals, shoes

uru-kwi (in-)(23) - firewood

gu-kwīra (riye) - to be enough, suffice, spread (int.)

-kwīriye (no inf.)(93) - must, ought, should, be worthy

M

mabuja (ba-) - my, our employer, boss (female)

maganabiri (38) - two hundred (same form for other hundreds)

makumyabiri (38) - twenty

malariya (52) - malaria

māma (ba māma)(73) - my, our mother
māma wācu (wānyu, wābo) - maternal aunt

uru-mamo, gukunda - to pretend to love

i-māna (i-)(7) - God

ku-manika (tse) - to hang up, place above

ku-manuka (tse)(56) - to go down hill, descend

ku-manura (ye) - to lower, cause to go down hill

ku-mānyagura (ye) - to break into bits

ku-mara (ze)(62) - to finish, end, use up, spend (time), stay (time)

(umu-)marayika (aba-)(116) - angel (Sw.)

i-māri (no pl.) - possession (money), treasury

aka-maro (no pl.) - value, use, profit

mārume - my maternal uncle

māsēnge - my paternal aunt

maze (119) - and then

mbēga! - used as an exclamation; how!

mbere na mbere - in the beginning

mbere (119) - before, prior to, first

mbese (3) - used to introduce question

-mbi (61) - both (bōmbi, twēmbi, etc.)

uru-me (no pl.)(or, ikime) - dew

ku-mena (nnye)(22) - to break, spill (tr.),

empty out, penetrate, traverse

i-mena (no pl.) - principal, important (abagabo b'imena)

ubu-mene - crack

ku-meneka (tse) - to break, spill (int.)

ku-menya (nye)(45) - to know, know how

ku-menyekana (nye) - to be known, become known

ku-menyera (reye) - to be accustomed to

iki-menyetso (ibi-)(111) - sign

ubu-menyi (no pl.) - knowledge

ku-mera (ze)(64, 108) - to be in a certain state, be like, germinate
e.g. Ameze ate? - How is he?

ka-mere (no pl.) - nature, character

imi-mērere (no sing.) - characteristics, attitude(s)

ama-mesa (no sing.) - palm oil

ku-mesa (she)(42) - to wash clothes

umu-meshi (aba-) - launderer

i-mēza (or, amēza)(19) - table

ku-minina (or, ku-mimina)(nye) - to strain, filter

ku-mira (ze) - to swallow

i-modoka (ama-) - car

ibu-moso (119) - at the left

mu (5) - in, into, out of, from (inside)

muka (baka) - wife of

iki-muga (ibi-) - cripple, infirm person, invalid

u-munani (37) - eight

mũnsi (77) - beneath, under (followed by ya if it has an object)

murabeho - goodbye (not to meet soon)

muraho? - hello (used when not seeing each other often)

murakoze (2) - thank you

muraramuke(ho) - goodnight

muri (48) - in

ku-murika (tse) - to shine, enlighten, to present or show, to master things one is responsible for

mwaramutseho - good morning (to someone you see regularly)

-mwe (37) - one
-mwe (111) - with plural prefix: some
e.g bamwe - some people

mwe, mwēbwe (48) - you (pl.)

ama-mwe - singular (grammar)

mwenyine (120) - you alone, you yourselves

ku-mwenyura (ye) - to smile

mwiriweho - good afternoon, good evening

N

na (4) - and, with, also, by

na hato - not in the least, not at all

nābi (44) - badly, poorly
ubugizi bwa nābi - evil acts

ku-nagana (nnye) - to hang (int.)

ku-nagūra (ye) - to sharpen

naho (104) - although, whereas, even if

nāka (102) - so-and-so

nako (46) - excuse me (I misspoke myself)

i-nāma (i-)(97) - advice, council, counsel, committee

namba - not at all

ku-nambaho (yeho) - to be faithful till death

ku-nangirwa (we) - to be hard (heart), be hard to untie

mu-nāni - eight

umu-nāni (imi-) - parcel of ground father gives son
kugira umunāni - to inherit

ku-nanirwa (we)(122) - to be tired, unable to do something (having tried)

aka-nānwa (utu-) - chin

umu-nara (imi-) - tower

nde? (96) - who?

ndetse - in fact, even, indeed, moreover

-ndi (43)(as, uwūndi, ibindi, etc.) - other, another, more

ndwi (-rindwi)(37) - seven

-ne (37) - four

ku-nebwa (bwe)(82) - to be lazy

ubu-nebwe (no pl.) - laziness

umu-neke (imi-)(15) - ripe banana

ku-nesha (sheje)(46) - to triumph, conquer

nēza (4) - nicely, well (adv.), satisfactory

ku-nēzereza (je)(103) - to please, make happy

umu-nēzēro (pl. rare)(5) - joy, happiness

ku-nēzērwa (rewe)(64) - to be happy (over something you've been told but haven't seen)

ku-nēzēza (nējeje)(103) - to please

mu ru-ngabangabo - facing a decision, in a dilemna
guhera (ze) mu rungabangabo - to be puzzled, perplexed

-ngahe? (39) - how many?

ngaho - let, come on, very well

ku-ngana (nye) - to be equal (size, number, age, force)

ngo (114) - so that, in order that, says

ngwino (28) - come here

ni (2) - is, are (cannot be followed by word of place)

ni - if

nība (111) - if

ku-niga (ze) - to choke, tie neck of sack

ibi-nika (no sing.) - big kettle

niko - and so, therefore

ni mūnsi - afternoon

ni mutyo - come on!, let's go!

n'ingoga (25) - quickly

-nini (8) - big, large, thick

-njye (3) - my

nka (101) - just as, like (before nouns,

pronouns)

nkana - deliberately, intentionally

umu-nkanyari (imi-) - wrinkle (in clothes, paper, face)

nk'uko - just as, like (before verbs)

no (69) - and (connecting infinitives)

i-no (ama-) - toe

I-noeli (or, Inoweli or Inoheli) - Christmas

ku-nogora (ye) - to gouge out eye, fingernail

nōnaha (46) - right away, immediately

nōne (29) - today, and, and now, and so, therefore

nōneho - and, and now, and so, therefore

umu-nota (imi-)(62) - minute

i-nota (or, inoti) (ama-) - money bill

ku-noza (geje) - to complete, finish

umū-nsi (imī-)(5) - day
imīnsi yose - always, every day

nta (104) - no, none, no one

ntabwo - never

umu-ntu (aba-)(3) - person, people

iki-ntu (ibi-)(13) - thing
umunyabintu - steward (responsible for another's belongings)

ubu-ntu (no pl.)(27) - grace

uku-ntu (no pl.) - how, method, means

aha-ntu (aha-)(33) - place

nūbwo (104) - although, even though

ku-nuka (tse) - to smell very bad

nuko (119) - therefore, then, and so

nuko nuko - thank you

i-numa (i-) - dove, pigeon

nusu - half
nusu kiro - 1/2 kilo (from Sw.)

umu-nwa (imi-)(26) - mouth, lip
mu kanwa - inside the mouth

ku-nya (neye) - to defecate

iki-nyabupfura (no pl.) - politeness

umu-nyabyaha (aba-)(46) - sinner

ku-nyaga (ze) - to take by force

i-nyama (i-)(11) - meat, flesh

umu-nyamaboko (aba-) - strong man

nyamara (39) - but, yet, nevertheless

i-nyamāswa (i-)(14) - wild animal

iki-nyamateka (ibi-) - journal, newspaper, magazine

umu-nyamurava (aba-) - faithful person

nyamwinshi (invariable) - majority
e.g. amajwi nyamwinshi - a majority vote

umu-nyana, kwesa - to succeed in one part but fail in another

i-nyana (i-) - calf

iki-nyandaro (ibi-) - unwed mother

i-nyanja (i-)(99) - lake, ocean, sea

i-nyānya (i-)(61) - tomato

umu-nyarwanda (aba-) - person of Rwanda

ku-nyeganyega (ze)(113) - to shake, tremble (earth, etc.)(int.)

i-nyenyēri (i-) - star

umu-nyeshuri (aba-) - student, pupil

umu-nyēzāmu (aba-) - watchman

nyina (73)(ba nyina) - his, her, their mother

-nyine (120) - only, alone, self

nyira - owner of, master of

nyirabukwe - mother-in-law

nyirakuru - his, her, their grandmother

nyirakuruza - his, her, their great grand-mother

nyiranaka - so-and-so (woman)

uru-nyo (i-) - worm, maggot

ku-nyōbwa (nyōwe) - to be drunk (liquid) (not, intoxicated)
(passive of kunywa - to drink)

iki-nyōbwa (ibi-)(85) - peanut

nyogokuru - grandmother

nyogokuruza - great grandmother

nyoko (73)(ba nyoko) - your mother

iki-nyoma (ibi-) - lie, falsehood

i-nyoni (i-)(95) - small bird

umu-nyororo (imi-) - chain, prison

i-nyōta (no pl.)(45) - thirst
kugira inyōta - to be thirsty

-nyu (3) - your (you pl.)(wanyu, etc.)

umu-nyu (4) - salt, or, see: um-unyu

i-nyuguti (i-) - letter (of alphabet)

ku-nyuguza (je) - to rinse (clothes, dishes)

nyuma (61) - after

(i-)nyuma (i-)(118) - behind, outside, after

i-nyundo (i-)(65) - hammer

i-nyungu -(see: iny-ungu)

ku-nyūnyuka (tse) - to be withered, thin (esp. arm, leg, but also of person who has been sick)

ku-nyura (ze) - to pass along, go through

umu-nyururu (imi-) - chain

ku-nywa (nyoye)(51) - to drink

ama-nywa - daytime
ku manywa - noon

umu-nzenze (imi-) - wild olive

i-nzika (i-)(124) - grudge, bitterness, desire to revenge

-nzinya (8) - tiny, minute (with 7th cl.)

i-nzira (or, inz-ira)(i-)(17) - path, way

i-nzoga (or, inz-oga)(i-)(85) - beer

i-nzozi (see: in-zozi)

O

ubw-ōba (no pl.)(29) - fear

umw-ōbo (imy-) - hole, pit

icy-ōbo (iby-)(14) - hole, pit

urw-ōbo (inz-) - hole, pit

k-ōga (ze)(42) - to wash one's feet, swim

inz-oga (inz-)(85) - beer

k-ōgeza (je) - to spread, publish, make known, declare

k-ōgosha (she) - to cut hair, beard, wool

k-ohereza (je)(39) - to send (thing, or person without message)

inz-oka (inz-) - snake, worm

ubw-ōko (am-)(116) - tribe, type, kind

k-ōmoka (tse) - to leave the shore (in boat)

k-ōmokera (ye) - to arrive (by boat)

k-ōmongana (nye) - to wander, stray

k-ōmora (ye) - to treat wounds

k-ōmoza (je) - to cause to treat wounds

iby-ōndo (no sing.)(101) - mud

k-ongera (ye)(44) - to repeat, do again, add more

k-ōnka (nse) - to nurse (int.)

k -ōnōna (nnye)(94) - to damage, spoil

k-ōnōnekara (ye) - to be damaged, spoiled

k-ōnsa (ōnkeje) - to nurse (tr.)

icy-orezo (iby-) - epidemic

k-ōroha (she) - to be soft, easy

k-ōroherwa (we)(73) - to be better, improved (physically)

k-ōrora (ye) - to raise animals

k-ōroroka (tse) - to multiply (int.), increase (animals)

-ōse (41) - all, every

k-ōshya (ōheje) - to tempt, influence badly

am-ōshya (no sing.) - temptations

k-ōshyoshya (heje) - to want to see someone in order to seize or harm him

k-ōta (se) - to warm oneself by fire

k-ōtsa (keje) - to roast in fire, bake

umw-ōtsi (imy-)(5) - smoke

oya (3) - no

ubw-ōya (am-)(28) - hair of body or animals

iry-ōya (am-) - feather

k-ōza (ōgeje)(42) - to wash (except clothes, vegetables, hands)

P

umu-padiri (aba-) - priest (Catholic)

umu-pagani (aba-) - pagan, heathen

im-pagarara (no pl.) - anguish, terror, danger

uru-pahu (im-) - spoon (large)

im-paka (im-) - argument, dispute

gu-pakira (ye) - to pack, load

gu-pakurura (ye) - to unload

im-pāmba (im-)(72) - food for journey

im-pamo (no pl.) - really, truly (e.g. icyabaye impamo - what really happened)

im-pāmvu (im-) reason, because of
ku mpāmvu za - because of

ku mpāmvu z'uko - due to
gutōra impāmvu - to make excuses

im-pamyabushobozi (im-) - diploma

umu-panga (imi-)(77) - machete

im-pānga (im-) - twins

im-pāno (im-) - gift

i-pantalo - pants

im-panuka (im-) - accident

i-papayi (ama-) - papaya

uru-papuro (im-)(55) - paper, page

i-pasi (ama-) - iron (for clothes)
gutera ipasi - to iron clothes

I-pasika - Easter

umu-pastori (aba-)(120) - pastor

pe - absolutely, extremely

im-pera (usually used in pl.) - end (used only with words of time: days, months, etc. e.g. ku mpera z'icyumweru - at the end of the week)

gu-perereza (je) - to oversee (as, workers)

im-perūka (im-)(61) - last of anything

im-pēshyi (no pl.) - month of June, just beginning dry season (with wind)

igi-pesi (ibi-) - button

gu-pfa (pfuye)(48) - to die

gu-pfa (pfūye) ku - to just . . . , simply. . .
e.g yapfūye kuza atazi impāmvu - He just came, not knowing why

gu-pfākara (ye) - to become a widow(er)

umu-pfākazi (aba-) - widow(er)

igi-pfāmatwi (ibi-)(77) - deaf person

m-pfane - nta mpfane - no hard feelings

uru-pfu (no pl.)(48) - death

ubu-pfu (no pl.) - folly

im-pfūbyi (im-) - orphan

gu-pfuka (tse) - to cover, wrap

umu-pfuka (imi-) - sack, bag, pocket, purse

gu-pfukama (mye) - to kneel

umu-pfumu (aba-) - witch doctor

gu-pfumuka (tse) - to get a hole (as bucket, etc.)

gu-pfumura (ye) - to make a hole in (as in wall, pot, etc.)

gu-pfūndika (tse) - to tie, make knot

gu-pfūndikanya (nije) - to tie knots

gu-pfundikira (ye) - to put lid on container

igi-pfundikizo (ibi-) - lid, stopper, cork

i-pfūndo (ama-) - knot

gu-pfūndura (ye) - to untie

igi-pfūnsi (ibi-) - fist, blow with fist

gu-pfunya (nye) - to wrap up

gu-pfurika (tse) - to hide

gu-pfūsha (shije) ubusa - to waste, use up for nothing

im-pigi (im-) - charm made with beads

i-pikipiki (ama-) - motorcycle

gu-pima (mye)(96) - to measure, weigh, examine

im-pinga (im-) - mountain top, peak

umu-pīra (imi-)(88) - rubber, ball, tire, sweater

i-piripiri (no pl.)(63) - pepper

im-piya (im-) - money (rarely used)

im-pongano (im-) - gift, bribe, amends, penalty, reparation

im-pongo (im-) - small antelope

umu-porisi (aba-) - police agent

im-pugūke (im-) - technique, technical knowledge or skill

im-puha (im-) - rumors, false reports

im-puhwe (im-) - pity

im-pumyi (im-)(45) - blind person

im-pūndu (im-) - shout of joy, acclamation guha (or, gutanga) impūndu - to congratulate (esp. on birth of baby, return from journey, etc.: e.g. tuguhāye impūndu)

im-pūngenge (im-) - anxiety, prudence e.g. kugira impūngenge mu magambo - be prudent in what one says

im-punzi (im-)(98) - refugee

gu-pyinagiza (je) - to oppress

R

ku-raba (bye) - to faint, wilt, dry up (plant)

umu-raba (imi-) - wave

ku-rabagirana (nye) - to shine (in sense of reflect light)

ku-rabukwa (tswe) - to catch glimpse of, suddenly see, set eyes on

uru-rabyo (indabyo)(68) - flower

umu-rabyo (imi-)(114) - lightning

ku-raga (ze) - to leave as inheritance
ku-ragwa (zwe) - to inherit

iki-ragi (ibi-) - dumb person (can't talk), mute

ku-ragira (ye) - to herd animals, to shepherd, to pasture (tr.)

iki-rago (ibi-)(15) - grass mat (for sleeping)

ku-rahira (ye) - to vow, swear

iki-rahuri (ibi-) - glass

ku-rakara (ye)(75) - to be angry

ubu-rakari (no pl.)(80) - anger

ibi-ramambu (no sing.) - on the contrary, however

ku-ramba (mbye) - to live long, last long

ku-rambarara (ye) - to lie down, stretch out

umu-rambararo (imi-) - diameter, length

ku-rambika (tse) - to put down, put on, spread out

umu-rambo (imi-) - corpse

ku-rambura (ye) - to stretch out (tr.) (as arm), to be long, extended
e.g. amagambo arambuye - lengthy message

mu-ramu (ba-) - brother-in-law (of woman), sister-in-law (of man)

ku-ramuka (tse) - to happen (implies not the usual)
e.g. aramutse amutumye - it happened that he sent him

ku-ramukanya (nije) - to exchange greetings

ku-ramukwa (tswe) - to have labor pains, come to time to deliver

ku-ramutsa (kije) - to greet (personally)

ku-ramya (mye) - to worship, adore, honor

ku-rāndata (se) - to lead by the hand

aka-rānde (no pl.) - tradition, hereditary trait, continuation

ku-randura (ye) - to pull out, uproot

ku-ranga (nze) - to make known, publish, announce
e.g. imigirire ye imuranga - his actions show what he is

ubu-ranga (no pl.) - physical beauty

ku-rangamira (ye) - to stare at, seek after

ku-rangara (ye) - to not pay attention, to be distracted

ku-rangārana (nye) - to neglect someone, ignore

ubu-rāngazi (no pl.) - negligence

iki-rāngirire (ibi-) - famous person

ku-rangiza (je)(56) - to finish (tr.)

ku-rangurura (ye) - to call at distance, shout, raise one's voice

ku-rāra (ye)(62) - to spend the night

ku-rarama (mye) - to look up, raise one's eyes

ku-raranganyamo amaso - to look about on all sides (searching)

i-rari (ama-) - lust, strong desire

ku-rārika (tse) - to invite, send to inform, hire

ku-rarikira (ye) - to strongly desire, covet

umu-rāririzi (aba-) - night watchman

iki-raro (ibi-)(115) - bridge

ku-raruka (tse) - to leave home, be a vagabond

ku-rasa (she) - to shoot with arrow, or gun, to rise (of sun)

ama-rāshi - perfume

ama-raso (no sing.)(19) - blood

ku-rata (se) - to praise

iki-rato (ibi-)(92) - shoe

umu-rava (no pl.) - faithfulness
e.g. gukorana umurava - be faithful in work

umunya-mu-rava - faithful person

iki-rayi (ibi-)(61) - white potato

umu-rayiki (aba-)(from laique) - layman

ku-reba (bye)(50) - to look, see (as go to see), look at

ku-rebareba (bye)(113) - to look everywhere

ubu-rebure (no pl.) - length

ku-rega (ze)(99) - to accuse (of)

ku-rēga (ze) - to stretch tight (tr.)

iki-rego (ibi-) - accusation, charge

reka - let, come on, very well, wait!
e.g. reka ukubwīre - wait, let me tell you

ku-reka (tse)(58, 68) - to stop (int.), leave off, refrain from, cease, forsake, allow
buretse! - stop!, just a minute!

ku-rekeraho (yeho)(68) - to stop (int.)

ku-rekura (ye) - to release

ku-rema (mye)(101) - to create

iki-rema (ibi-) - crippled person, invalid

ku-remba (mbye)(72) - to be very ill, about to die

i-rēmbo (ama-) - gate, entrance to kraal

ku-rēmbuza (je) - to signal to come

ku-rembya (beje) - to push one to the end of endurance, cause to suffer greatly

ku-remera (reye)(84) - to be heavy
ku-remerwa (rewe) - to be heavy laden

iki-remu (ibi-) - patch

ku-rēnga (nze) - to go past, surpass, set (sun), pass beyond, disappear behind
ijwi rirēnga - a loud voice
birēnze urugero - beyond measure, beyond reason

ama-rēnga (no sing.) - sign language, figurative speech (guca amarēnga)

ku-rēnganura (ye) - to give justice to one who has been treated unjustly

ku-rēnganya (nije)(109) - to treat unjustly, unfairly, persecute

ubu-rēnganzira (no pl.) - priority, rights

umu-renge (imi-) - village
(i.e. hill with numerous homes)

iki-renge (ibi-)(13) - foot

ku-rēngera (ye) - to try to save from danger

ku-rengererezaho (jeho) - to direct remarks toward (covertly)

ku-rēngerwa (we) - to be submerged

ku-rengurana (nye) - to ridicule

ku-rera (ze) - to train, rear child

-re-re (8) - long, tall, high
e.g. muremure, ndende, kirekire

iki-rēre (no pl.) - air, sky, area, space
akarēre - region, territory

ma-rere - ring finger

rēro (119) - then, so

ku-reshya (hereje) - to influence, woo

ku-reshya (sheje) - to be equal (length, height, importance)

ke-retse - except

-ri (12) - is, are

uku-ri (no pl.)(32) - truth
by'ukuri, mu by'ukuri - truly, really

i-riba (ama-) - well (n.)

ku-ribata (se) - to trample on

ku-rībwa (riwe)(85) - to be eaten

ku-riduka (tse) - to fall in ruins

ku-riganya (nije) - to cheat, trick, lie

ubu-riganya (no pl.) - trickery, deceit

ku-rigita (se) - to disappear into ground, be unfindable

bu-rīje (28) - it's late, getting dark

umu-rima (imi-)(6) - garden, field

ku-rimba (mbye) - to dress beautifully, wear ornaments

ku-rimbuka (tse) - to perish, be destroyed, be lost (eternally)

ku-rimbura (ye) - to destroy

uru-rimi (indimi)(24) - tongue, language

umu-rimo (imi-)(26) - work, task

rimwe (119) - once

rimwe na rimwe (93) - now and then, sometimes

ku-rinda (nze)(93) - ought, should, to wait for, watch, guard, protect

ku-rindira (riye) - to wait for, expect

umu-ringa (imi-) - brass

ku-ringanira (ye) - to be equal, even, flat

ku-ringaniza (je) - to make even, flat, equal, put in order

ubu-rīngīti - cover, blanket

ku-rira (ze)(50) - to weep, cry

ama-rira (no sing.)(106) - weeping, tears

umu-riri (imi-) - noise (of crowd)

ubu-riri (ama-)(27) - bed

ku-ririmba (mbye)(31) - to sing
indirimbo (31) - song, hymn

umu-riro (no pl.)(4) - fire

ku-rīsha (shije) - to pasture (int.), to eat with (instrument)

umu-rizo (imi-)(45) - tail

iki-ro (ibi-) - kilogram

uru-ro (no pl.)(79) - millet (one grain, one plant)

ubu-ro (no pl.)(79) - millet (collective noun)

ku-roba (bye) - to fish

ku-robanura (ye) - to choose, set aside, ordain

umu-robyi (aba-) - fisherman

ku-roga (ze) - to bewitch

ku-rogoya (ye) - to interrupt

ki-rogoya (bi-) - interrupter, agent with evil intent

ku-roha (shye) - to throw (into water)

ku-rohama (mye) - to drown (int.)

ubu-rohame - shipwreck, loss

ku-rohora (ye) - to pull out of water, fire

ku-rokoka (tse) - to be saved, delivered

ku-rokora (ye) - to save (from danger,death)

ku-rombereza (je) - to go on further

ku-rondereza (je) - to be economical, frugal

ku-rondogora (ye) - to chat for a long time

ubu-rondogozi - just words, verbiage

ku-rondora (ye) - to exhaust, describe, relate in detail

iki-rondwe (ibi-)(105) - tick

ku-ronga (nze)(42) - to wash vegetable

umu-rongo (imi-) - line, row, verse

ubu-rongo (no pl.) - mud, clay

ku-rongora (ye) - to marry a bride

ku-rōngōra (ye) - to lead

ku-ronka (nze) - to receive (only in sense of something special, surprise, or undeserved)

ku-rorera (reye) - to stop (int.)

iki-rorero (ibi-) - town

ku-roreza (je) - to taste

ibi-rori (no sing.) - celebration, fête

ku-rōta (se) - to dream

ubu-rozi (no pl.) - poison, witchcraft

ku-rubira (ye) - to become angry, violent

ku-ruha (shye)(108) - to be tired

i-ruhāande (119) - beside, on the side of

ku-ruhuka (tse)(108) - to rest

ku-ruka (tse)(96) - to vomit

ku-rumbuka (tse) - to be abundant (crop), produce much fruit

ku-rumbura (ye) - to open (as flower)

iki-rumirahabiri (ibi-) - snake that bites at both ends (can't distinguish head and tail)

mu-rumuna (barumuna)(74) - younger brother (of male), younger sister (of female)

ku-runda (nze) - to pile together, heap

ku-rundarunda (nze) - to pile carefully, to finish

bu-rūndu - absolutely final

iki-runga (ibi-) - volcano, high mountain

ku-rūnguruka (tse) - to lean over to look at

ubu-ruru - blue

ku-rusha (shije)(108) - to surpass

ku-rushaho (shijeho) - to do more, surpass e.g. kurushaho gukora - to work harder

ku-rushiriza (je) - to surpass, do more e.g. arushiriza kurwara - he's even sicker

ku-rushya (ruhije)(57) - to be difficult, to trouble, annoy

ku-ruta (se)(108) - to surpass (size, age, force) (in past, usually in the -ga tense; hence, -rutaga)

-ruzi (only this form) - to see, notice

umu-rwa (imi-) - city (royal) (rare)

iki-rwa (ibi-) - island

rwagakoco (no pl.)(67) - small trap

ku-rwana (nye)(94) - to fight (int.)

ku-rwanya (nije) - to fight (tr.)

ku-rwāra (ye)(64) - to be sick, ill
indwāra (17) - illness, disease

umu-rwāyi (aba-) - a sick person

ku-rwāza (je) - to care for the sick

rwōse (47) - completely, entirely, very much

ku-rya (rīye)(51) - to eat, pain, irritate
ibyo kurya - food

ku-rya (rīye) ruswa - to take bribe

ku-ryāma (mye)(75) - to lie down, go to bed

umu-ryango (imi-)(98) - family, clan

umu-ryāngo (imi-)(98) - doorway

ryāri? (41) - when?

ku-ryarya (rye) - to be a hypocrite, act hypocritically

ubu-ryarya (no pl.) - hypocrisy

ku-ryaryata (se) - to itch

i-ryīnyo (amēnyo)(18) - tooth

ibi-ryo (no sing.)(51) - food

ubu-ryo (no pl.)(28) - way, method, manner, right side, opportunity

ibu-ryo (119) - at the right

ku-ryōha (shye) - to be delicious, excellent

ku-ryōza (je) - to make pay the penalty

S

-sa (8)(adj.) - only, alone

gu-sa (66)(adv.) - only

gu-sa (saga)(121) - to be like, resemble physically (in past, usually in the -ga tense; hence, -saga)

ubu-sa (no pl.)(103, 118) - in vain, for nothing, empty, naked
haba na busa - not at all

gu-saba (bye)(44) - to ask for, pray, beg

gu-sāba (bye) - to spread, envelop, penetrate (as, perfume, rain)

gu-sābāna (nye) na - to confide in

ubu-sābāne - close friendship, fellowship, partnership

i-sabato (ama-) - Sabbath (in Bible)

gu-sabiriza (je) - to beg

umu-sabirizi (aba-)(120) - beggar

i-sabune (ama-)(78) - soap

gu-saduka (tse) - to crack

i-safuriya (ama-) - cooking pot, pan

gu-sāga (ze) - to overflow, be more than, be a surplus

gu-sagamba (mbye) - to grow luxuriously

in-sāgu (in-) - balance (in account)

gu-sāguka (tse) - to be over and above, overflowing

i-sāha (or, isāa)(ama-)(62) - clock, watch, hour

i-sahane (ama-)(11) - plate, dish (3rd cl. sing. and 5th cl. pl.)

i-saho (ama-)(11) - sack, bag (3rd cl. sing. and 5th cl. pl.)

gu-sahura (ye) - to pillage, plunder

ama-saka (no sing.) - Kaffir corn (resembles sorghum)

gu-sakabaka (tse) - to shout, cry out

gu-sakara (ye)(65) - to roof, put on roof

i-sāke (ama-) - rooster, cock (3rd cl. sing. and 5th cl. pl.)

uru-saku (no pl.) - clamor, shouts, noise, row

gu-sakuza (je) - to shout, cry aloud, make a lot of noise

umu-samanzuki (imi-) - flycatcher (bird)

gu-sāmba (mbye) - to be at the point of death

gu-sāmbana (nye) - to commit adultery

ubu-sāmbanyi (no pl.) - adultery

umu-sāmbi (imi-) - crested crane

umu-sambi (imi-)(97) - small mat, rug

igi-sambo (ibi-)(39) - glutton, thief

i-sāmbu (ama-) - field, possession, property

gu-sambura (ye) - to take off roof, reveal publicly

gu-sāndara (ye) - to scatter (int.)(things)

gu-sāndaza (je) - to scatter (tr.)

i-sandugu (ama-, 3rd sing.)(44) - box

i-sanduka (ama-, 3rd sing.)(44) - box

gu-sanga (nze) - to find, encounter, come to (someone), go to find

gu-sanganira (ye) - to go to meet

ru-sānge - common, general, frequently used, known by all

gu-sangira (ye) - to eat together, share

umu-sāngwa (aba-) - wedding guest (related to father of groom)

i-sāno (no pl.) - resemblance, similarity, relationship
e.g. bafitanye isāno - they are related

umu-sānzu (no pl.) - voluntary aid, contribution, assessment

ubu-sanzwe - usually, ordinarily

gu-sara (ze) - to lose one's mind, be mad, crazy

umu-saraba (imi-)(94) - cross

umu-sāre (aba-) - sailor

i-sari (no pl.) - hunger

ama-saro (no sing.) - tiny beads
gutaka (tse) amasaro - to bead

gu-sarura (ye)(99) - to harvest

gu-sasa (shashe)(78) - to spread grass, make a bed, prepare a room

i-sasa (ama-)(65) - floor tile

igi-sate (ibi-) - piece of something broken

umu-satsi (imi-)(6) - hair (of human head)

gu-satura (ye)(65) - to cut lengthwise

gu-saya (ye) - to get stuck in mud

gu-sāza (shāje) - to grow old

mu-sāza (ba-)(74) - brother of girl

umu-sāza (aba-)(3) - old man

i-sazi (i-) - fly

se - word used in asking question

se (ba se)(73) - his, her, their father

ama-se (no sing.) - cow manure

igi-sebe (ibi-)(43) - sore, ulcer, wound

gu-sebwa (sewe)(85)- to be ground (passive of gu-sya)

gu-sebya (beje) - to speak evil of, mock, make fun of

gu-sega (ze) - to beg

umu-sego (imi-) - pillow, cushion

gu-seka (tse)(79) - to laugh (at)

umu-seke (no pl.) - dawn
e.g. umuseke ukebye - when it had dawned

igi-seke (ibi-)(97) - tall pointed basket

gu-sekura (ye) - to grind in mortar, to bump into

sēkuru (bā sēkuru) - his, her, their grandfather

sēkuruza (ba) - his, her, their great grandfather

gu-sembura (ye) - to leaven

umu-semburo (imi-) - yeast, leaven

gu-sēnda (nze) - to publicly send away one's wife

uru-sēnda (in-)(63) - pepper

gu-sēndera (reye) - to be filled to the brim

gu-senga (nze)(25) - to pray, worship

i-senga (ama-) - cave, den

umu-sengeneza (aba-) - niece, nephew (child of female's brother, or male's sister)

uru-sengero (in-)(or, i-sengero)(38) - church building, temple

i-sengesho (ama-)(or, i-shengesho) - prayer

gu-sēnya (shēnye)(65) - to gather firewood, to tear down, to demolish, ruin

gu-sēnyagurana (nye) - to fall into ruin

umu-sēnyi (imi-)(65) - sand

gu-serebeka (tse) - to slide

gu-sesa (sheshe) akanguhe - to be mature, experienced

igi-sēseka, rubanda rwa - the ordinary people

gu-sesekara (ye) - to overflow, spill, to arrive

i-seseme (no pl.) - nausea

gu-sesengura (ye) - to examine carefully

gu-sezera (ye) - to take leave of, depart, bid goodbye

gu-sezerana (nye) - to promise, bid each other goodbye

i-sezerano (ama-) - promise, testament

umu-sezi (aba-) - beggar

gu-shagara (ye) - to accompany, escort

umu-shahara (imi-) - salary, pay, wage

gu-shāka (tse)(19) - to want, seek, look for, desire

i-shaka (amasaka) - Kaffir corn

gu-shākana (nye) - to marry

gu-shākashaka (tse)(113) - to search for diligently

ubu-shāke - will

i-shami (ama-)(69) - branch

igi-shanga (ibi-) - marsh, swamp

gu-shanyuka (tse) - to tear (int.)

gu-shanyura (ye) - to tear (tr.)

i-shāti (ama-) - shirt

i-shavu (no pl.)(109) - sadness, irritation, anger (light)
kugira ishavu (109) - to be sad

gu-shavuza (je) - to make sad

i-shaza (ama-)(27) - pea

shebuja (ba) - his, her, their master,

employer (male)

i-shema (no pl.) - honor, majesty

i-shengero (ama-)(55) - crowd of followers

gu-shengura (ye) - overwhelm, weigh down, make sad

ama-shereka (no sing.) - breast milk

umu-shi (aba-) - foreigner (tribe in Zaïre)

gu-shidĩkanya (nije)(82) - to doubt

mu-shiki (ba)(74) - sister (of male)

gu-shima (mye)(17) - to praise, thank, be content with

gu-shima (mye) - to scratch
kwĩ-shima (mye) - to scratch oneself

gu-shimangira (ye) - to nail down, establish, reinforce, emphasize

iby-ĩ-shimo (no sing.) - joy, gladness

i-shimwe (no pl.) - joy, gladness, praise

gu-shinga (nze) - to drive stake, decide, vote, establish

imi-shinga (sing. rare) - projects, plans
gutegura imishinga - to make plans, prepare projects

in-shinga (in-) - sentence (gram.)

in-shĩngano (in-)- responsibility

uru-shĩnge (in-) - needle, injection

gu-shinguka (tse) - to come out (as stake driven in ground)

gu-shingura (ye) - to pull out stake, reverse a vote

gu-shĩnja (nje) - to blame

gu-shinyagura (ye) - to mock, ridicule

aga-shinyaguro (no pl.) - mockery, torment

gu-shira (ze)(72) - to end, wear out

umu-shishe (aba-) - fat, well nourished child

ubu-shĩshi - small food ants

gu-shishikara (ye) - to persevere, make an effort

gu-shishikaza (je) - to encourage, exhort

gu-shishimura (ye) - to tear, rip (tr.)

umu-shitsi (imi-)(or,umushyitsi) - trembling
guhinda umushitsi - to tremble

igi-shitsi (ibi-) - base of tree

gu-shobera (ye) - to be at the end (of oneself)
gu-shoberwa (we) - to be in despair, at wit's end, dumbfounded, perplexed

in-shoberamahanga (in-) - idiom (lit. what's too difficult for foreigners)

gu-shoboka (tse) - to be possible

gu-shobora (ye)(42) - to be able, can

ubu-shobozi (no pl.)(48) - power, ability

umu-shoferi (aba-) - driver

i-shoka (ama-)(65) - axe

gu-shõnga (nze) - to melt (as, sugar)

gu-shorera (ye) - to lead (esp. animals)

gu-shudika (tse) - to be friends with

igi-shuhe (ibi-) - duck

i-shuheri (3rd. cl., no pl.) - storm of wind

i-shūka (ama-) - sheet

gu-shuka (tse)(50) - to deceive, tempt

gu-shukashuka (tse)(113) - to tempt, entice, fool, deceive lightly

ibi-shuko (no sing.) - temptations

umu-shumba (aba-)(41) - herder, shepherd

umu-shumi (imi-) - belt, tie

in-shunda (in-) - fringe

uru-shūndura (in-) - fishing net

gu-shungera (ye) - to surround, encircle

in-shungu (in-) - ransom

gu-shungura (ye) - to sift, winnow

igi-shura (ibi-) - long garment worn over shoulders and down to ground (no longer used)

i-shūri (or, ishūli) (ama-)(18) - school
ishūri ribanza - primary school
ishūri ryīsumbuye - secondary school
ishūri rikuru - university
ishūri ry'ingoboka - para-primary, vocational

in-shuro (in-) - times, measure

gu-shushanya (nije) - to draw

igi-shushanyo (ibi-) - picture, image

i-shusho (ama-) - picture, shape, likeness

in-shuti (in-)(43) - friend

uru-shwīma (no pl.) - dropsy, water retention

-shya (adj.)(8) - new

gu-shya (hiye)(92) - to be cooked, ripe, to burn (int.), be burned

i-shya (ama-) - herd of cattle

i-shya n'ihīrwe - prosperity

i-shyaka (no pl.) - zeal, competion, enthusiasm for work

i-shyaka (ama-) - political party, organization (e.g. U.N.), section

i-shyamba (ama-)(69) - forest, jungle, bush

i-shyānga (amahānga) - nation

i-shyano (amahano) - accident, bad luck, extraordinary beauty
ni ishyano - that's terrible, too bad

ama-shyanyari (no sing.) - electricity

i-shyari (amahari)(83) - jealousy
-fite ishyari - to be jealous (momentarily)
kugira ishyari - to be jealous (as in characteristic, or in past)

ubu-shye (no pl.)(28) -burn

gu-shyenga (nze) - to joke, clown

ama-shyengo (no sing.) - jokes

uru-shyi (amashyi)(24) - palm of hand
inshyi - slaps
amashyi - hands outstretched

gu-shyigikira (ye) - to support, prop, put props under, second a motion

gu-shyika (tse) - to arrive at, attain

gu-shyikirana (nye) na - to confide in, have a good relationship with

umu-shyikirano (imi-) - relationship, fellowship

in-shyīmbo (in-) - club

igi-shyīmbo (ibi-)(33) - bean

gu-shyīngira (ye) - to give in marriage

gu-shyīngura (ye) - to put away

gu-shyira (ze)(23) - to put

gu-shyīra (riye) - to take to someone, hand to

ama-shyira (no sing.) - pus

umu-shyitsi (aba-)(62) - guest, visitor

ubu-shyo (ama-) - herd (esp. of cows)

gu-shyūha (shyushye)(92) - to be hot, get hot

ubu-shyūhe (no pl.) - heat

gu-shyunguta (se) - to whistle

uru-shyungute (in-) - whistle

gu-shyūshya (hije)(92) - to heat (tr.)

si (2) - is not, are not
si byo (108) - Isn't it?, Isn't that so?

i-si (i-)(95) - world, earth

gu-siba (bye)(62) - to erase, close up path

gu-sība (bye)(62) - to be absent, omit, abstain

igi-sida (ibi-)(or, agisida) - accident

gu-siga (ze)(116) - to leave, forsake

gu-sīga (ze)(116) - to rub, smear, anoint, paint

igi-siga (ibi-) - bird of prey

gu-siganuza (je) - to ask explanation

gu-sigara (ye)(104) - to be left, remain

igi-sigo (ibi-) - harmful ancestral spirit

uru-sīka (in-) - wall

igi-sīmba (ibi-)(14) - wild animal (esp. small that bites), insect

gu-simbuka (tse)(123) - to jump

gu-simbura (ye) - to replace (int.), follow someone in a position

i-sinagogi (ama-)(foreign) - synagogue

sinapi (foreign) - mustard seed

gu-sīnda (nze) - to be drunk

gu-singiza (je) - to honor, praise

gu-sīnzīra (riye)(41) - to sleep

umu-sirikare (aba-) - soldier

ubu-sitāni (no pl.) - garden

gu-sītara (ye) - to stumble

i-sitimu (ama-) - flashlight, torch

umu-sizi (aba-) - poet

so (ba so)(73) - your father

ubu-so (no pl.) - surface (e.g. of square, etc.)

gu-sobanukirwa (we) - to understand

gu-sobanura (ye)(120) - to explain, interpret, sort out, separate

gu-sobanuza (je) - to ask to explain

gu-sodoka (tse) - to loiter, dawdle

sogokuru (ba) - grandfather

sogokuruza (ba) - great grandfather, ancestor

gu-sogongera (ye) - to taste (a little bit)

gu-sohoka (tse)(95) - to go out

gu-sohora (ye) - to put out, cause to go out,

reach certain time, be fulfilled, take seeds out to plant

gu-sohoza (je) - to complete, accomplish, fulfill

umu-sohozabitambo (aba-) - priest

i-soko (ama-)(107) - market place

i-sōko (ama-)(107) - spring, fountain

gu-sokoza (je) - to comb hair

uru-sokozo (in-) - comb

gu-soma (mye)(22) - to read, kiss, sip

gu-somagura (ye) - to kiss repeatedly

umu-somari (imi-) - nail, pin

umu-someno (imi-) - saw

i-somo (ama-) - lesson

gu-songera (ye) - to second a motion, reinforce

i-soni (no pl.)(93) - shame, bashfulness
gukorwa n'isoni - to be ashamed

gu-sonza (shonje)(64) - to be hungry

umu-sore (aba-)(52) - young man (not married)

ubu-sore (no pl.)(28) - youth (age, not person)

umu-soresha (aba-) - tax collector

umu-soro (imi-) - tax

gu-soroma (mye)(89) - to pick, gather (garden produce)

gu-sosoroka (tse) - to slip out, stick out (as from pocket)

umu-sozi (imi-)(4) - hill, mountain
i musozi - on dry land, shore

umu-sōzo (imi-) - conclusion

gu-subira (ye)(29, 44) - to return, go back, do again, repeat

gu-subiza (je)(124) - to answer, reply, return something where it was

igi-subizo (ibi-) - answer, reply

gu-suhuza (je) - to visit, greet (at one's home, or at beginning of letter)

gu-suhuza (je) umutima - to sigh

i-suka (ama-, 3rd sing.)(11) - hoe

gu-suka (tse)(63) - to pour into

i-sukari (no pl.)(63) - sugar

i-suku (no pl.) - cleanliness

gu-sukura (ye) - to clean

umu-sumari (imi-)(65) - nail, pin

gu-sumba (mbye)(108) - to surpass (in height)

mu-sumbazose (mi-) - middle finger

umu-sumeno (imi-) - saw

gu-sumira (ye) - to seize, grab, trap

gu-sunika (tse) - to push

gu-sura (ye)(56) - to visit, go to visit

i-suri (no pl.) - erosion

umu-susu (no pl.) - apprehension, fear

aga-susuruko - hot part of day

gu-suzugura (ye) - to despise, scorn, disobey

gu-suzuma (mye)(96) - to examine, scrutinize

umu-swa (aba-) - a fool, stupid person, incapable, dumb

umu-swa (no pl.)(113) - white ants

ru-swa (no pl.) - bribe

gu-sya (seye)(63) - to grind

uru-syo (in-)(85) - stone for grinding

T

ama-ta (no sing.)(19) - milk

gu-ta (taye)(79) - to throw away, discard

gu-tabara (ye)(72) - to help willingly, come to the assistance of

i-tabaza (ama-)(67) - lamp, candle

ku-tābēra (reye) - to be just, impartial

in-tābēra (in-) - a just, fair person

i-tābi (no pl.) - tobacco
kunywa itabi - to smoke tobacco

igi-tabo (ibi-)(13) - book

gu-tabuka (tse) - to tear (int.)

gu-tābwa (tāwe)(85) - to be discarded

i-tafari (ama-)(65) - brick

gu-tāgaguza (je) - to waste possessions

gu-taha (shye)(56) - to go home, greet, to be next
e.g. icyumweru gitaha - next week
umwaka utaha - next year
uko umwaka utaha - annually, every year

gu-taka (tse) - to shout, cry out

gu-taka (tse) - to ornament, embroider

umu-taka (imi-) - umbrella

ubu-taka (69) - soil

igi-taka (ibi-)(69) - soil

in-tama (in-)(12) - sheep

in-tambara (in-)(97) - battle, strife

igi-tambaro (ibi-)(15) - cloth

gu-tāmbika (tse) to place crosswise, be crosswise, be flat, horizontal
umuseke utāmbitse - at dawn

ubu-tāmbike (no pl.) - length, horizontal position

igi-tāmbo (ibi-) - sacrifice

gu-tāmbuka (tse) - to step, advance

gu-tāmbutsa (kije) - to surpass in

in-tāmbwe (in-) - step

umu-tambyi (aba-) - priest

gu-tāna (nye) - to divorce (followed by na with object)

in-tananya (in-) - cord of the tongue

igi-tānda (ibi-) - bed, rack

-tāndatu (37) - six

gu-tāndukana (nye) - to separate (int.), be distinct, different, part with

gu-tāndukanya (nije) - to separate (tr.), distinguish between

gu-tānga (nze)(78) - to offer, pay, give (no recipient indicated)

gu-tānga (nze) - to do, arrive before another

in-tangamugabo (in-) - proof, evidence

gu-tāngāra (ye)(101) - to marvel, wonder at, be astonished

gu-tāngatanga (nze) - to encircle, surround

gu-tāngāza (je) - to surprise, astonish, cause to wonder; to announce

igi-tāngāza (ibi-)(41) - miracle, amazing thing

i-tangazo (ama-) - announcement

gu-tāngira (ye)(31) - to begin, start

gu-tāngīra (ye) - to hold, cut off one's path

imi-tāngire (no sing.) - giving (act of giving offering)

i-tāngiriro (ama-) - beginning

in-tāngiriro (in-) - beginning

umu-tāngizi (aba-) - beginner

in-tango (in-)(97) - large water pot

-tanu (37) - five

gu-tānyaguza (je) - to tear up

i-tara (ama-)(67) - lamp, lantern

uru-tara (in-) - bed like they used to have (poles and rope)

in-tāra (in-) - region, area

aka-taraboneka (no pl.) - excellence, superbness

-taraga (adj.) - safe and sound, in good health

ama-taratara (no sing.) - glasses(spectacles)

in-tare (in-) - lion

igi-tare (ibi-) - white, whitish

uru-tare (in-) - rocky place, large rock

ubu-tariganya (no pl.) - sincerity

i-tariki (ama-)(62) - date (of month)

ibi-taro (no sing.)(91) - hospital, dispensary

gu-tashya (tahirije)(120) - to greet, send greetings

gu-tashya (hije) - to gather firewood

gu-tata (se) - to spy

gu-tāta (se)(80) - to make trouble, fight with verbally

gu-tātana (nye) - to be dispersed, scattered (people, animals)

-tatu (37) - three

ubu-tāyu (no pl.) - wilderness, place with no trees or houses

in-taza (in-)(or, ama-taza) - rocks in water

-te? (108) - how? (manner)

ubu-te (no pl.) - laziness
kugira ubute - to be lazy

in-tebe (in-)(7) - chair, stool, bench

igi-tebo (ibi-)(97) - basket (deep, no lid)

gu-tega (ze) - to set trap, to wait for (also, kwitega)
gutega amashyi (24) - to hold out hands
gutega amatwi (121) - to listen well

gu-teganya (nije) - to prepare (in sense of plan) for

aga-teganyo (no pl.) - temporary, interim person e.g. umukozi w'agateganyo - a temporary workman

umu-tegarugori (aba-) - mother (wearing "crown") (The "crown" is a raphia band worn around the head indicating that the mother has given birth.)

in-tege (in-)(120) - strength, force
intege nke (120) - weakness

gu-tegeka (tse)(57) - to command, order, rule

imi-tegekere (no sing.) - administration, body of rules

i-tegeko (ama-) - law, command, rule

gu-tegereza (je)(66) - to wait (for)

umu-tegetsi (aba-) - director

umu-tego (imi-)(68) - trap, snare

in-tego (in-) - purpose, objective

gu-tegura (ye)(71) - to prepare

i-tegura (ama-)(65) - roof tile

in-tegūza (in-) - one who prepares the way

imi-tēja (sing. rare)(63) - green beans

gu-tēka (tse)(22) - to cook (tr.)(in water)

i-tēka (no pl.)(25) - always
iteka ryose - forever, eternally

gu-tēkerereza (je) - to recount to

gu-tēkereza (je)(71) - to think about

igi-tēkerezo (ibi-) - thought, story, narrative, idea, example, philosophy

in-tēko (in-) - group

gu-tema (mye)(69) - to cut (tree, grass)

gu-tēmba (mbye) - to flow (water)

gu-tēmbēra (reye)(95) - to go for a walk, move about, circulate, visit

i-tembura (ama-) - stamp

i-teme (ama-)(115) - small bridge

umu-temeri (imi-) - lid, cover

gu-tēra (ye)(107) - to plant, throw, cause to do
gutēra amahāne - to make trouble
gutēra (ijwi) hejuru (116) - to shout
gutērera - (ye) - to throw out

gu-tērana (nye) - to gather (int.), come together

i-tēraniro (ama-)(55) - meeting, get-together

gu-tēranya (nije) - to gather (tr.), add

in-tēre (in-) - unconscious, half-dead

gu-tereka (tse) - to place an object

igi-tereko (ibi-) - lampstand

gu-tērerana (nye) - to abandon

imi-tērere (no sing.) - nature (of something, someone), what it's like, attitudes

tereriyo (no prefix) - disobedient child

gu-terura (ye) - to carry, lift up

in-teruro (in-) - sentence (gram.), phrase

umu-tesi (aba-) - spoiled child

gu-teta (tse) - to joke, not take seriously, make light of, not experience difficulty

gu-tetesha (sheje) - to spoil (a child)

umu-tētsi (aba-) - cook

gu-tezuka (tse) - to reliquish, leave bit by bit, give up gradually

-ti (nti, uti, ati, etc.)(114) - says, saying (actually, like quotation marks)

umu-ti (imi-)(17) - medicine, any mixed preparation

igi-ti (ibi-)(13) - tree, stick

umu-tiba (imi-) - beehive (empty)

gu-tiga (ze) - to be dull (pencil, knife, etc.)

gu-tigisa (shije) - to shake (tr.)

umu-tima (imi-)(4) - heart

umu-timanāma (imi-) - conscience

aga-timba (udu) - mosquito netting

gu-tinda (nze)(71) - to be late, slow, tardy, delay
bidatinze - soon
bitinze - later, late, with delay

gu-tindaganya (nye) - to hesitate, be slow

ubu-tindi (no pl.) - misery, destitution, poverty

uru-tindo (in-)(115) - bridge of poles

gu-tinga (nze) - to commit homosexual acts

umu-tini (imi-) - fig tree

gu-tīnya (nye)(71) - to fear

gu-tīnyuka (tse)(117) - to dare, be fearless

gu-tira (ze) - to borrow (that which will itself be returned)

gu-tirimuka (tse) - to leave (secretly)

ubu-tītsa - without ceasing, continually

gu-tiza (je) - to lend (that which will be returned)

-to (-töya)(8) - small, little, thin, young
na gato - not at all
haba na gato - not at all

gu-toba (bye) - to disturb, trouble

umu-tobe (imi-) - unfermented banana juice

gu-tobora (ye) - to pierce, make a hole in

in-toboro (in-)(84) - hole (not in ground)

gu-toha (shye) - to be green, fresh (as, grass)

igi-toke (or, -ki)(ibi-)(15) - bunch of bananas, banana tree

uru-toke (or, -ki)(in-) - banana plantation

uru-toki (in-)(23) - finger
gukora mu ntoki - to shake hands

gu-tona (nnye) ku - to be a favorite with

igi-tõndo (ibi-)(31) - morning

in-tonga (in-)(97) - large basket

gu-tõngana (nye) - to quarrel

gu-tõnganya (nije)(106) - to scold, rebuke

umu-toni (aba-) - favorite (person)

ubu-toni (no pl.) - favoritism

gu-tonora (ye)(63) - to shell, husk, peel (with fingers)

gu-tõnyanga (nze) - to drip, fine rain

gu-tōra (ye)(84) - to pick up, choose, elect, find lost object

i-tōra (ama-) - election

gu-tõragura (ye) - to pick up here and there, choose out from among several

gu-tōranya (nije)(84) - to pick out, choose (from group)

in-tōre (in-) - a chosen thing, dancer (male)

i-tōrero (ama-)(38) - church (people)

in-tōrezo (in-) - axe

gu-tōteza (je) - to persecute

-toto (8)(adj.) - green, unripe

igi-totsi (ibi-) - something in eye

ibi-totsi - sleepiness

in-tozi (in-)(105) - pincher ants

gu-tsemba (mbye) - to destroy, exterminate

gu-tsīka (tse) - to stop, tie up boat

ama-tsiko (no sing.) - curiosity

aga-tsiko (udu-) - group (of people)

umu-tsima (imi-)(4) - bread (not like European)

igi-tsina (ibi-) - sex (male or female)
igitsina-gabo - male
igitsina-gore - female

gu-tsīnda (nze)(46) - to defeat, conquer, win, overcome, triumph over, be successful

gu-tsirita (se) - to rub hard (as to polish)

aga-tsītsino (udu-) - heel

gu-tsuka (tse) - to slide down hill on piece of banana trunk

gu-tsura (ye) - to move (tr.) a bit to one side, or down, to push for, strive for, cause to advance

gu-tubura (ye) - to increase, multiply (tr.)

uru-tugu (in-) - shoulder

gu-tuka (tse) - to slander, insult, revile

gu-tukura (ye) - to be red

gu-tuma (mye)(39) - to send (person with message); to cause, be the reason for

igi-tuma (ibi-) - reason
ni iki gituma? - why?
ni icyo gituma - that's why
bituma - that's why, which causes

umu-tūmba (imi-) - trunk of banana tree

i-tūmba - rainy season (Feb.-May)

in-tūmbi (in-) corpse of animal, corpse of criminal

gu-tumbika (tse) - to soak in water

gu-tumbīra (riye) - to look at intently

gu-tumburuka (tse) - to appear suddenly

gu-tumira (ye) - to invite

gi-tumo - kugwa gitumo - to strike (or happen) suddenly (unexpectedly)

ubu-tumwa (no pl.)(28) - message
Ubutumwa Bwiza - Gospel

gu-tūnga (nze)(112) - to possess, be rich

gu-tūngana (nye) - to be perfect

gu-tūnganya (nije) - to perfect, clean up

un-tūnge (46) - excuse me (when interrupting)

umu-tūngo (imi-) - possession (whether large or small)

gu-tūnguka (tse) - to appear suddenly

gu-tūngura (ye) - to come, happen

unexpectedly

ubu-tūnguru (or, igi-, or, uru-) - onion

umu-tūnzi (aba-)(21) - rich person (esp. in cattle)

ubu-tūnzi (no pl.)(105) - wealth, possessions, riches (esp. in cattle)

gu-tūra (ye) - to live, dwell, inhabit

gu-tūra (ye) - to put down load, offer gift, throw down
gutūra abana Imana - to dedicate children

igi-tūrage (ibi-)(92) - village, group of huts, neighborhood

umu-tūrage (aba-) - neighbor

gu-turama (mye) - to lie in wait to steal or harm

umu-tūranyi (aba-) - neighbor

gu-turika (tse) - to burst (int.)

imi-turire (no sing.) - community

ibi-tūrire - bribe

gu-tūrisha (shije) - to silence, make quiet

gu-turitsa (kije) - to burst (tr.)

i-tūro (ama-) - offering, gift to a superior

in-tūro (in-) - dwelling place

ubu-tūro (no pl.) - dwelling place

igi-tūro (ibi-) - tomb, ditch containing dead body

gu-turuka (tse) - to come from

Umu-tutsi (Aba-) - member of ethnic group of Banyarwanda

igi-tutsi (ibi-) - slander, insult

gu-tūza (je) - to be silent, quiet, peaceful

i-tūza (no pl.) - silence

igi-tuza (ibi-) - chest (of body)

Umu-twa (Aba-) - pygmy

gu-twama (mye) - to silence

gu-twāra (ye)(68) - to carry (a load), take away, rule

ama-twāra (no sing.) - attitude, conduct, importance

umu-twāre (aba-) - chief, heir

ubu-twāre (no pl.) - chieftainship, authority, inheritance

umu-twāro (imi-)(112) - burden, load

in-twāro (in-) - weapon(s)

umu-twe (imi-)(4) - head

twēbwe (48) - we, us

ugu-twi (ama-)(32) - ear

gu-twīka (tse)(122) - to set fire to, burn (tr.)

gu-twīta (te) - to be pregnant

gu-tya (82) - like this
gu-tyo (82) - like that

gu-tyāra (ye) - to be sharp

U

k-ūbaha (shye)(59) - to reverence, respect, honor

icy-ūbahiro (no pl.)(85) - esteem, respect, honor

k-ūbahuka (tse) - to not respect, disrespect, dare

k-ūbaka (tse)(36) - to build

imy-ūbakire (no sing.) - manner of building

iny-ūbako (iny-) - building

k-ūbama (mye) - to bend over, stoop down

ubanza - perhaps, it's possible that...; I think that...

umw-ūbatsi (ab-)(84) - builder

k-ūbika (tse) - to turn upside down

k-ūbikira (ye) - to lie in ambush

ubu (21) - now; (86) - this (8th cl.)
ubu nyine (119) - right now

ubūndi (119) - at another time, some other way, sometimes

ubungūbu (21) - right away, this instant

k-ūbura (ye) - to raise (head, eyes)

ubusa (103) - in vain

ubwo - seeing that, now that, when, then

k-ūgama (mye) - to take shelter from rain

ubw-ūgamo - shelter

ur-ugi (inzugi)(23) - door

k-ūhagira (ye) - to bathe (tr.)

umw-ūka (imy-) - breath, spirit, steam
Umwuka Wera - Holy Spirit
Mwuka Muziranenge - Holy Spirit

uko - how

k-ūma (mye)(107) - to dry (int.)

in-uma (in-) - dove, pigeon

icy-ūma (iby-)(14) - iron, metal, tool, knife, anything made of metal

icy-ūmba (iby-)(68) - room (in house)

umw-ūmbati (imy-) - manioc, cassava

ak-ūmiro (no pl.) - astonishing thing

k-ūmirwa (we) - to be astonished, astounded

k-ūmva (vise)(39) - to hear, understand, feel, taste, smell

k-ūmvira (ye)(121) - to obey

k-ūmviriza (je)(121) - to listen to (as eavesdrop)

icy-ūmwēru (iby-)(62) - week
ku cyūmwēru - Sunday
mu cyūmwēru gishize - last week
mu cyūmwēru gitaha - next week

k-ūnama (mye) - to stoop down, bow

iny-ūndo (iny-)(65) - hammer

k-ūnga (nze) - to join (tr.), to reconcile

k-ūnga ubumwe - to be united

k-ūngamo - to add (words)

umw-ūngeri (ab-)(41) - shepherd, pastor (sometimes)

umw-ūngu (imy-) - squash, pumpkin

iny-ūngu (iny-)(107) - profit, gain, increase

k-ūnguka (tse) - to gain, profit, increase

k-ūngura (ye) - to cause to gain

um-ūnyu (imy-*)(4) - salt
*The reason for a plural of umunyu is that long ago there used to be a marsh salt made from burning certain leaves found in the

marsh (before refined salt came into the country). There was also a coarse rock salt. So the plural could be used in referring to these various kinds of salt. See imyunyu in Zefaniya 2:9

uretse - excluding, except for

urw-uri (no pl.) - pasture

k-ūrira (ye) - to climb (as tree)

k-ururuka (tse) - to climb down (tree)

Ūwitēka - the Eternal One

icy-ūya (iby-) - perspiration, sweat
kubira ibyūya - to perspire heavily

icy-ūzi (iby-) - pool

ur-ūzi (inzūzi)(23) - river, stream

ubw-ūzu (no pl.) - great joy, fulness, zeal

umw-ūzukuru (ab-) - grandchild

k-ūzura (ye)(121) - to be full

k-ūzuza (ūjuje)(121) - to fill (tr.)

V

ku-va (vuye)(5, 55) - to come from, out of, to leak, bleed; shine, rise (sun)

kutā-va ku izima - to be firm, stubborn, obstinate, adamant

im-va (im-) - grave, tomb

umu-vāmahānga (aba-) - foreigner

ku-vana (nye) - to take from (a certain place)

umu-vāndimwe (aba-) - brother, sister, relative from same grandfather, of same generation; literally, one out of same womb

ku-vānga (nze)(63) - to stir, mix

i-vi (ama-)(77) - knee

vino (no pl. - foreign) - wine, ink

ku-voma (mye)(79) - to bring water

i-vu (no pl.) - ashes

vuba (25) - soon, recently, quickly

vubaha - soon, recently

im-vubu (im-) - hippopotamus

ku-vuga (ze)(3) - to say, speak, mean, sound (as drum)

ku-vugama (mye) - to row (boat)

ku-vugana (nye) - to speak with someone

umu-vugizi (aba-) - (legal) representative

ku-vugurura (ye) - to renew, revive, repair

ku-vuguruza (je) - to contradict

iki-vuguto (ibi-) - clabbered milk

ku-vūka (tse) - to be born

ka-vūkire (no pl.) - native, aboriginal, one born in country

ku-vuma (mye) - to curse

ku-vūmba (mbye) - to go about in search of a drink

im-vumba (im-) - sack (the old kind they carried on shoulder)

umu-vumu (imi-) - sycamore tree

ku-vuna (nnye)(122) - to break (tr.) (something slender), assist

ku-vunagura (ye) - to break (tr.) to bits

ku-vundereza (je) amacāndwe - to spit on

iki-vūnge (ibi-) cy'abantu - crowd

ubu-vungukira - left-over bits, crumbs

ku-vunika (tse)(122) - to break (int.), as bone

i-vunja (ama-)(18) - jigger

ku-vūnja (nje) - to change money

ubu-vunnyi (no pl.) - new site, assistance, aid

umu-vunnyi (aba-) - defender, one who helps

im-vura (no pl.)(11) - rain

ku-vura (ye)(52) - to treat, doctor, heal

i-vuriro (ama-)(91) - hospital, dispensary

ku-vuruga (ze) - to beat, whip (as milk, eggs, etc.)

im-vururu (im-) - riot, disorder, troubles

ama-vuta (no sing.)(19) - butter, oil, fat

ku-vutsa (kije) - to cause to lose, hinder from getting

i-vutu (no pl.) - intemperance

ku-vuza (gije) - to knock down with

ku-vuza (je or jije) - to take someone for treatment

ku-vuza (gije) - to play (an instrument), make resound

umu-vuzi (aba-) - doctor, one who treats illness

W

aka-wa (or, ikawa)(no pl.)(61) - coffee

we (48) - he, she, him, her, his, hers

wa-we (3) - your (sing.)(wawe, bawe, yawe, etc.)

wēnda (44) - perhaps

wenyine (120) - you alone, he alone, it alone

wowe (48) - you (sing.)

Y

ku-yabangira (ye) ingata - to run fast (esp. to escape being beaten)

ku-yaga (ze) - to melt (as, butter)(int.)
ku-yaza (gije) - to cause to melt

ku-yaga (ze) - to visit a bereaved person (traditionally with gift of beer)

umu-yaga (imi-)(21) - wind

iki-yaga (ibi-)(99) - lake, ocean

in-yāngamugayo (in-) - blameless person

yego, yee (3) - yes

yēnda (119) - perhaps

in-yenyēri (in-) - star

in-yenzi (in-)(105) - cockroach

Yezu (or, Yesu) - Jesus

uru-yige (inzige)(24) - locust

iki-yīko (ibi-)(63) - spoon

aka-yīko (utu-)(63) - teaspoon

ku-yoba (bye) - to lose the way, err

ku-yobera (ye) - to perplex, dumbfound

ku-yoberwa (we)(114) - to be mistaken, not know

ku-yobora (ye) - to lead

ku-yoboza (je) - to ask the way

umu-yobozi (aba-) - leader, chairman

in-yõta (in-)(45) - thirst

in-yuguti (in-) - letter (alphabet)

uru-yuki (inzuki)(24) - bee

yuko (45) - that, if, whether

in-yuma (118) - outside, behind

in-yungu - see: iny-ungu

aka-yunguruzo (utu-) - sieve, strainer

Z

ku-za (je)(25) - to come

uru-zabibu (in-) - vineyard

umu-zabibu (imi-) - vines, grapes

Zaburi - Psalm

iki-zamini (ibi-) - examination, test

ku-zamuka (tse)(56) - to go up hill

ku-zana (nye)(22) - to bring, come with

ku-zana ingese - to become rusty

in-zara (in-)(21) - hunger, famine

iki-zenga (ibi-) - pool

ku-zẽnguzwa (jwe) - to be dizzy

ku-zerera (reye) - to wander about

ku-zeyutsa (kije) - to disappoint

-zi (45)(no infinitive) - know

umu-zi (imi-)(76) - root

ama-zi (no sing.)(19) - water

urũ-zi (see: ur-ũzi)

aka-zi (no pl.)(26) - work, task, job (i.e. employment)

iki-zibaho (ibi-) - dress

ku-zibuka (tse) - to become open, unstopped

ku-zibura (ye) - to open, unstop

uru-ziga (in-) - circle

ku-zigama (mye) - to save (as, money), keep

uru-zige (in-)(24) - locust

in-zĩka (in-)(109) - grudge, crossness
kugira inzika - to be cross

umu-ziki (imi-) - music

i-zĩko (ama-)(18) - fireplace, stove (the 3 stones on which a cooking pot rests)

-zima (adj.)(8) - alive, whole, healthy

i-zima, kudakürwa ku - to be firm, stubborn

i-zima, kutãva ku - to be firm, stubborn

ubu-zima (no pl.) - wholeness, life

ku-zima (mye) - to go out, be extinguished (fire)

ku-zimana (nye) - to serve meal to guests, give a feast

ubu-zima-gatozi (no pl.) - "personnalité civile", incorporation

ku-zimira (ye)(102) - to be lost (lose the way)

umu-zimu (aba-) - ancestral spirit, ghost

in-zimuzi (in-) - gossip

ama-zimwe (no sing.) - gossip

ku-zimya (mye) - to put out (fire)

i-zina (ama-)(41) - name

ama-zinda (no sing.) - forgetfulness

ku-zinduka (tse) - to get up early

ku-zīnga (nze) - to fold, roll up, crumple

ku-zinukwa (tswe) - to stop loving, abandon

ku-zira (ze) - to be forbidden, taboo, to exclude, oppose

in-zira (in-)(7) - path, way
inzira y'ubusamu - a short cut
inzira y'uruboko - a round-about-way

-ziranenge - holy, pure, spotless
Mwūka Muziranenge - Holy Spirit

ku-zirika (tse) - to tie an animal (to stake, etc.)

ku-zirikana (nye) - to consider, think on, ponder, meditate, be concerned about

ku-ziririza (jiririje) - to observe

ku-zitira (ye) - to plant (make) a hedge

uru-zitiro (in-) - hedge, fence

ku-zitura (ye) - to untie animal (from stake, etc.)

ku-ziza (je) - to reproach, blame

in-zoga (in-)(85) - beer, alcoholic drink

in-zoka - (see: inz-oka)

in-zovu (in-) - ten thousand, elephant

in-zozi (in-) - dream

in-zu (ama-)(7) - house, room

i-zūba (ama-)(18) - sun

ku-zuka (tse) - to come to life, resurrect

i-zuka (no pl.) - resurrection

umu-zuko (no pl.) - resurrection

umu-zŭngu (aba-)(47) - white person, European

ku-zūnguza (je) - to shake (head)

ku-zura (ye) - to raise from dead, resurrect (tr.)

i-zūru (ama-)(18) - nose, nostril

* * *

A

abandon, to - guhāna, gutererana, kuzinukwa

abcess - ikibyimba

ability - ubushobozi

able, to be - gushobora, kubasha

aboriginal - kavukire

about (concerning) - ibya, ibyerekeye
(approximately) - hafi, nka

about to, to be - kwenda

above - hejuru, hejuru ya

absent, to be - gusiba

absolutely - rwose, pe

abstain, to - gusiba

abundant, to be (crop) - kurumbuka

accept, to - kwakira, kwemera, kwenda

accident - igisida, akisida, ishyano, impanuka

acclamation, cry of - impundu

accompany, to - kugendana, kujyana na, gushagara, guherekeza

accomplish, to - gusohoza

according to - kubwa

account (finance) - ibitabo by'amafaranga

accusation - ikirego

accuse, to - kurega

accustomed, to be - kumenyera

across (a body of water, valley) - hakurya

act, to - gukora

action - umurimo, igikorwa

actions (habitual) - imigenzereze. imigirire

adamant, to be - kutava ku izima

add, to - guterana (int.), guteranya (tr.), kongera

add words, to - kungamo

administration - imitegekere

admit, to - kwemera

adore, to - kuramya

adulterer - umusambanyi

adultery - ubusambanyi

adultery, to commit - gusambana

advance, to - kujya imbere, gutambuka

advice - inama

advise, to - kugīra inama, guhanura

advisor - umujyanama

affair - urubanza
e.g. dealing with a case of misconduct

affirm strongly, to - kwirenga

afire, to set - gukongeza

afraid, to be - gutinya, kugira ubwoba

after - inyuma, hanyuma

afternoon - ni munsi

afterwards - hanyuma, bukeye

again, to do - gusubira, kongera
again - ukundi
again and again - hato na hato

against, to talk - guhinyura

age - imyaka y'amavuka
  old age - ubukuru, zabukuru
  middle (30-50) - ubukwerere, imikwerere
  all ages - ikigero cyose

ago, long - kera

agree, to - kwemera

agreement, to be in - gukiranuka

aid, to - gufasha, kugoboka, gutabara, kuvuna

aid, voluntary - umusanzu, ubuvunnyi
  one who aids - umuvunnyi

aim at, to - gufora

aim, to have for - -gamije (no inf.)

air - umwuka, ikirere

airplane - indege

alarm, cry of - induru

alert, to be - kuba maso

alive - -zima (muzima, kizima, etc.)
  alive, to be - kubaho

all - -ose (bose, byose, etc.)

allow, to - gukundira, kureka

almost - hafi

alone - -nyine (wenyine, etc.)
  -sa (musa, bisa, etc.)
  alone, to be - kwiherera

along - ku ruhande rwa

also - na, kandi

although - nubwo, naho

always - iteka, ubudahwema, iminsi yose

always (do), to - kujya, guhora

am (I am) - ndi

amaze, to - gutangaza

amazing thing - igitangaza

ambush - igico
  lie in ambush, to - kubikira

America, U. S. of - Leta zunze z'Amerika

among - hagati ya, mu, muri

amount - urugero

amuse a child, to - kubeshyabeshya

ancestor - sogokuruza

ancestral spirit - umzimu

ancestral spirit, harmful -igisigo

and - na, no, kandi
  and now - none, noneho, none rero
  and so - none, noneho, none rero, niko

angel - (umu-)marayika

anger - uburakari, umujinya (long lasting), ishavu (light)

angry, to be - kurakara

angry, to become - kurubira

anguish - impagarara

animal - inyamaswa, igisimba

animator - umukangurambaga

announce, to - gutangaza, kuranga

annoy, to - kurushya

annually - uko umwaka utaha

anoint, to - gusīga

another - -ndi (undi, abandi, etc.)

answer - igisubizo

answer, to - gusubiza

answer when called, to - kwitaba

ant: pincher ant - intozi
small food ant - ubushishi
white ant - umuswa

antelope, small - impongo

anxiety - amaganya, impungenge, inkeke

anxious, to be - guhangayika, guhagarika umutima, kubunza umutima

anybody - umuntu wese

anyhow, to do - gupfa ku

anything - ikintu cyose

apart - ukwa

apologize, to (before accusation) - kwisegura

apparent, to be - kwihandagaza

appeal to higher court, to - kujurira

appear, to - kuboneka, kugaragara
appear suddenly and without precedent, to - kwaduka, gutunguka
appear, to cause to (as in court) - guhingutsa

apprehension - umususu

approach, to - kwegera
approach, to cause to - kwegereza

April - Mata, ukwezi kwa kane

Arab - Umwarabu

are - ni, -ri (bari, biri, etc.)
are not - si, ntibari, etc.

area - ikirere, intāra

argument - impaka, amakimbirane

arise, to (from bed, ground) - kubyuka
(from dead) - kuzuka

arm - ukuboko

armpit - ukwaha

army - ingabo

arouse, to - guhugura

arrive, to - kugera, gusohora, guhinguka, gusesekara
arrive, to cause to - kugeza
arrive by boat, to - komokera
arrive at, to - gushyika

arrive before another, to - gutanga

arrow - umwambi

art - umwuga

as - ko, uko, nk'uko, nka
as for - kubwa

ashamed, to be - gukorwa n'isoni

ashes - ivu

ask (question), to - kubaza

ask for (favor, article), to - gusaba

ask the way, to - kuyoboza

assessment - umusanzu

assist, to - gufasha, kuvuna, gutabara, kugoboka

assistance -ubuvunnyi

astonish, to - gutangaza
astonished, to be - gutangara, kumirwa

astonishing thing - akumiro, igitangaza

astounded, to be - kumirwa

astray, to go - kuzimira

at - i, ku, kuri, kwa

attack, to - kujujubya

attain, to - gushyika

attempt, to - kugerageza

attention to, to pay - kwita, kwitondera;
not pay attention, to - kurangara

attitudes - imiterere, imimerere, amatwara

August - Kanama, ukwezi kwa munani

aunt: my maternal - mama wacu
your maternal - nyoko wanyu
his, her, their maternal - nyina wabo
my paternal - masenge
your paternal - nyogosenge
his, her, their paternal - nyirasenge

authority - ubutware

automobile - imodoga, imodokari

avenge, to - guhōra

awaken, to - gukanguka (int.)
gukangura (tr.)

away, to put - kubika

away, far - kure

axe - incabiti, indyankwi, interezo, ishoka

B

babble, to - kudedemanga

baby - umwana, akana
newborn - uruhinja

back (of person) - umugongo

back, at the - inyuma

back end of boat - ibwerekeza

backing (support) - ubwishingizi

bad - -bi (mubi, kibi, etc.)
that's too bad - n'ishyano
bad luck - ishyano, umwaku
bad fate - umwaku

badly - nabi

bag - isaho, igunira, umufuka, umupfuka

balance (in account) - insagu

ball - umupira

banana: stalk of, tree - igitoki(e)
ripe - umuneke
beer - mazizi
cooking - ikinyamunyu
lady-fingers - akamaramasenge
red - igisukari
plantation of - urutoki(e)

banana juice (unfermented) - umutobe

bank (of river, lake) - inkombe

baptism - umubatizo

baptize, to - kubatiza

bargain, to be a - guhenduka

base of tree - igishitsi

bashfulness - isoni
bashful, to be - kugira isoni

basin - ibēsani

basket: large - intonga
made of bamboo strips - inkangara
tall pointed - igiseke
small flat - icyibo
deep, no lid - igitebo

bathe (oneself), to - kwiyuhagira
bathe another, to - kuhagira

battle - intambara

be, to - kuba, -ri, kumera (in a certain state)

beach - inkuka

bead, to - gutaka amasaro

beads, tiny - amasaro

beans - ibishyimbo
green - imiteja

bear (fruit), to - kwera

beat, to - gukubita
beat drum, to - kuvuza ingoma

beautiful - -iza (mwiza, cyiza, etc.)
beautiful person - umunyaburanga bwiza, uw'igikundiro

beauty - ubwiza
extraordinary beauty - ishyano
physical beauty - uburanga

because - kuko
because of - ku mpamvu za (z'uko), kubwa, kubera

become, to - guhinduka, kuba, kumera

bed - uburiri, igitanda
(of poles and rope) - urutara
make a bed, to - gusasa uburiri

bee - uruyuki (pl. inzuki)

beehive - umutiba (empty)

beer - inzoga

beer, to make - kwenga

before - mbere, imbere

beg, to - gusaba, gusabiriza, gusega
beg earnestly, to - guhendahenda

beggar - umusabirizi, umusezi

begin, to - gutangira, guhanga
begin by, to - kubanza

beginner - umutangizi

beginning - itangiriro, intangiriro, mbere na mbere

behave, to - kwifata

behave towards, to - kugenza, gufata

behavior - umwifato, imyifatire, amatwara

behind - inyuma

belated - bitinze

Belgian - Umubirigi

Belgium - Ububirigi

belief - kwizera
beliefs - imyizerere, inyigisho

believe, to - kwizera

below - hepfo, hepfo ya

belt - umushumi, umukandara
put on belt, to - gukenyeza

bend knees, to - guhina

bend over, to - kubama

beneath - munsi ya

berries - inkēre (or, inkēri)

beseech, to - kwinginga

beside - iruhande

best - ikiruta

"best man" - imperekeza

betray, to - kugambana

better - ikiruta, kurusha, kuruta

better (after illness), to be - koroherwa

between - hagati ya

beware, to - kwirinda

bewitch, to - kuroga

beyond - hirya

beyond measure, reason - birenze urugero

Bible - Biblia Yera, Igitabo cy'Imana

bicycle - igare

big - -nini (munini, binini, etc.)

bind, to - kuboha

bird (small) - inyoni
(of prey) - igisiga

birth - ivuka
give birth to, to - kubyara

bite, to - kuruma, kuryana

bitter, to be - kubīha

bitterness - inzika

black - umukara
black, to be - kwirabura

bladder - uruhago

blame - umugayo, amakemwa

blame, to - gushinja, kuziza

blameless person - inyangamugayo

blanket - uburingiti

bleed, to - kuva amaraso
stop bleeding (int.), to - gukama

blessed, to be - guhirwa

blessing - umugisha, amahīrwe

blind, to be - guhuma, guhumagurika
blind person - impumyi

blood - amaraso

blow, to - guhuha
blow fire, to - kwatsa

blow with fist (n.) - igipfunsi

blue - bururu, bisa n'ijuru
dark blue - umukara

board - urubaho

board ship, to - kwikira

boast, to - kwirata

boat - ubwato

boat, to get into - kwikira

body - umubiri

boil - ikibyimba

boil, to - kubira (int.), kubiza (tr.)

bonded, to be - kuba afite ubwishingizi

bonds - ingoyi

bone - igufwa

book - igitabo

born, to be - kuvuka
born of, to be - gukomoka

borrow, to - kugurana, gutira
kuguriza (actual article to be replaced),
kuguza (esp. money)

boss - (female) - mabuja
(male) - databuja

both - -ombi (bombi, byombi, twembi)

bottle - icupa

bottle opener - urufunguzo

bottom - hasi

bow (as with arrows) - umuheto

bowl (wood) - imbehe

box - isanduka, isandugu
box with lid (small tin) - umukebe

boy - umuhungu

braid, to - kubohekanya

branch - ishami

brass - umuringa

bread - umugati (European);
umutsima (African)
to make (knead) bread - gukora umugati, gufunyanga

break, to - kumena (tr.), kuvuna (tr.)(something thin); kuvunika (int.), kumeneka (int.), gucika (int.), kwangiza (tr.)

break into bits (tr.), to - kumanyagura, kuvunagura

breast milk - amashereka

breath - umwuka

breathe, to - guhumeka

bribe (n.) - amafaranga yo kwituga, ibiturire, ruswa, impongano

bribe, to take - kurya ruswa, kwakira impongano

brick - itafari
make bricks, to - kubumba amatafari

bricks, unburned - urukarakara

bride - umugeni

bride-groom - umukwe
friend of bridegroom - imperekeza

bridge (small) - iteme, ikiraro (big, metal)
(of poles) - urutindo
foot-bridge - umugogo

bright (of light), to be - kurabagirana

brim - urugāra

bring, to - kuzana
bring back wife who had left, to - gucyura umugore
bring in from sun, to - kwanura
bring water, to - kuvoma
bring near, to - kwegereza

broad - -gari (hagari)

broil, to - gukaranga

broom - umukubuzo

brother - mwene se
(of girl) - musaza
(younger brother of boy) - murumuna
(older brother of boy) - mukuru

brush teeth, to - kwiyoza amenyo

bucket - indobo

buffalo - imbogo

build, to - kubaka

builder - umwubatsi

building (construction) - inyubako
building (manner of) - imyubakire

bump into, to - gusekura

burden - umutwaro

burial - ihambwa

burlap - igunira

burn - ubushye

burn, to - kwaka (int.), gushya (as house, etc.)(int.)
burn (set fire to), to - gutwika

burst, to - guturika (int.), guturitsa (tr.)

bury, to - guhamba

bus - ibisi

bush - igihuru (thick)
the bush (uninhabited area) - ishyamba

business - umurimo

busy - kugira imirimo myinshi, guhugīra, guhugīrwa

but - ariko, nyamara, ahubwo (but rather)

butcher, to - kubaga

butcher shop (butchering place) - ibagiro

butter - amavuta

button - igifungo

buy, to - kugura
(esp. food) - guhaha

by - na

C

calf - inyana

call, to - guhamagara,
(name) - kwita
call at a distance, to - kurangurura

calm (someone), to - guhendahenda

camel - ingamiya

can, tin - igikombe

can (be able) - gushobora

Canadian - Umukanada

candle - itabaza

candy - ibombo

capable, to be - guhuguka

car - imodoka

card - igipande

care about, to - kubabara
care for, to - kwitaho
care for body and house, to - kugira isuku
care for the sick, to - kurwaza
care for lovingly, to - gukuyakuya, gukundwakaza

careful, to be - kwitonda, kwirinda
careful about, to be - kwitondera

carefully - buhoro-buhoro

careless (with things), to be - kwandarika ibintu
in personal appearance - kwiyandarika
in work, etc. - kutitaho

carpenter - umubaji

carry, to - gutwara, kwikorera, guterura
carry on one's back, to - guheka
carry on, to - gukomeza

case to law, to take - kuburana

cassava - umwumbati

cast lots, to - gufinda

cat - injangwe

catch, to - gufata

cause - impamvu, igituma

cause, to - gutuma, gutera

cautious, to be - kwitonda

cave - isenga

cease, to - kureka, guhwema
without ceasing - ubutitsa, ubudasiba, ubudahwema

celebrate, to - kwizihiza

celebration - ibirori

census - ibarura

center, in the - hagati

ceremony - umuhango

chain - umunyororo, umunyururu

chair - intebe

chairman - umuyobozi

chalk - ingwa

change (coins)(n.) - ibikoroti

change, to - guhinduka (int.), guhindura (tr.)
change money, to - kuvunja

chapter - igice

character - kamere

characteristic - ingeso, imimerere

charcoal - ikara

charge - ikirego

charm - igiheko, ingisha
made with beads - impigi

chat, to - kuganira

chat (for a long time), to - kurondogora

cheap, to be - guhenduka

cheat, to - kuriganya

chest (body) - igituza

chew, to - guhekenya

chicken - inkoko

chief - umutware

chieftanship - ubutware

child - umwana
spoiled child - umutesi
disobedient child - tereriyo

childhood - ubwana

chin - akananwa

choke, to - kuniga

choose, to - gutora, guhitamo, kurobanura
choose from group, to - gutoranya, gutoragura

chop up, to - gucagagura

chosen thing - intore

Christ - Kristo

Christian - Umukristo

Christianity - Ubukristo

Christmas - Inoheli (or, Inoweli)

church (building) - urusengero
(people) - itorero

circle - uruziga

circulate, to - gutembera

citizen - umwene gihugu

city - umujyi (or, umugi), umudugudu

clan - umuryango

clap, to - gukoma amashyi

class - ikarasi

clatter (of voices) - urwamo

claw - urwara

clay - uburongo
work, mold clay, to - kubumba

clean - -iza (mwiza, cyiza, etc.)
clean, to be - kugira isuku
clean (ceremonially), to become - guhumanuka
clean, to make - kuboneza, kweza, gusukura
clean ceremonially, to make - guhumanura
clean up, to - gutunganya

cleanse oneself, to - kwisukura

clear, to make - kugaragaza

cliff - agacuri

climb, to (as tree) - kurira
climb up (as mountain), to - kuzamuka
climb down (tree), to - kururuka

cloak - ikoti

clock - isaha

close, to - gukinga, gufunga
close eyes, to - guhumiriza
close up path, to - gusiba

close together, to get - kwegeranya

closet - akabati

cloth - umwenda, igitambaro
cloth women wear over shoulder - umwitero

clothe, to - kwambika

clothes - imyambaro, imyenda
take clothes off, to - kwambura

clothing - umwenda

cloud - igicu

clown, to - gushyenga

club - inshyimbo

coal, hot - ikara

coat - ikoti

cock - isake

cock-crowing, at - mu nkoko

cockroach - inyenzi

coffee - akawa, ikawa

coins - ibikoroti

cold, to be - gukonja, kugira imbeho
cold - -bisi (kibisi, etc.)

cold in head - ibicurane

coldness - ubukonje, imbeho

color - ibara

colt - icyana

comb - urusokozo

comb, to - gusokoza

come, to - kuza
come back, to - kugaruka
come from, to - kuva, guturuka
come on! - nimutyo, henga
come out, to (as stakes in ground) - gushinguka
come out of, to - kuva
come to (someone), to - gusanga
come to an end, to - guhera
come to life, to - kuzuka
come together, to - guterana
come unexpectedly, to - gutungura

comfort, to - guhumuriza
comforted, to be - guhumura

comings and goings - urujya n'uruza

comma - akabago, agakato, akitso

command - itegeko

command, to - gutegeka, kugenga

commit oneself to, to - kwitanga

common - rusange

community - imiturire, mu baturage

companion - mugenzi

company - umushyitsi

compare, to - kugereranya

compel, to - guhata

competition - ishyaka

complain, to - kwivovota, kuganyira, kwitonganya, kwitotomba, kwinuba

complaints - amaganya

complete, to - kunoza, gusohoza

completely - rwose, byimazeyo

compost pit - ingarane

concerned about, to be - kuzirikana, kwitwararika

concluded (as meeting), to be - guhumuza

conclusion - umwanzuro, umusozo

condemnation - urubanza

condemned, to be - gucirwaho iteka

conduct - imibereho, umwifato, imyifatire, amatwara

confess, to - kwihana, kwatura

confide in, to - gusabana, gushyikirana

confusion - imidugarara

congratulate, to (esp. birth) - guha impundu, gutanga impundu
(as graduate) - gukura ubwatsi
e.g. tugukuriye ubwatsi

conquer, to - kunesha, kuganza, kujujubya

conscience - umutimanama

consent, to - kwemera

consequences - ingaruka

consider, to - kuzirikana

console, to - guhuriza

container, tin - igikombe

continually - guhora, kujya, ubutitsa, ubudasiba, ubudahwema

continuation - akarande

continue, to - gukomeza, guhora

contradict, to - kuvuguruza

contrary, on the - ahubwo, ibiri amambu

contribution - umusanzu

control, to - gutwara, gutegeka

conversation - ikiganiro

converse with, to - kuganira

cook (n.) - umutetsi

cook, to - guteka
cooked, to be - gushya

cool, to (int.) - guhora
cool, to be - gukonja

cool at end of day (at daybreak, coolness) - amafu

cooperate, to - gufatanya

cord - umugozi
cord of the tongue - intananya

cork - igipfundikizo

corn - ikigori
corn, Kaffir - ishaka (amasaka)

corner (of room, house) - imfuruka

corpse - umurambo
of animal, criminal - intumbi

cost - ikiguzi, igiciro

cough - inkorora

cough, to - gukorora

council - inama

councillor (member of council) - umujyanama

counsel - inama

counsel, to - kugīra inama
counsel together, to - kwigīra inama

count, to - kubara

country - igihugu, ishanga (amahanga), (rural) - icyaro

courage - umuhati

court - urukiko

courtyard - ikibuga

cover (lid) - umutemere, igipfundikizo uburingiti

cover, to - gupfuka
cover with lid, to - gupfundikira
cover oneself with, to - kwifubika
cover oneself in bed, to - kwiyorosa

covet, to - kwifuza, kurarikira

cow - inka

cow manure - amase

craftsmanship - ubukorikori

crane, crested - umusambi

crazy, to be - gusara

create, to - kurema, guhanga

cripple - ikimuga, ikirema

criticize (badly), to - guhinyura

crooked, to be - kugorama

crops - imyaka

cross - umusaraba
remove from cross, to - kubambura

cross, to be - kugira inzika

cross body of water, to - kwambuka

crossness - inzika

crosswise, to place, (or, to be) - gutambika

crow, to - kubika

crowd - inteko, rubanda, imbaga, ikivunge cy'abantu
(of followers) - ishengero

crowd, to - guhubuka

crown - ikamba

crucify, to - kubamba

cruel, to be - kutagira imbabazi, kuba umunyamwaga

crumbs - ubuvungukira

crumple, to - kuzinga

cry, to - kurira, gutaka

cry aloud, to - gusakuza
cry out, to - gusakabaka

cry of alarm - induru

cultivate, to - guhinga

cultivator - umuhinzi

cup - igikombe

cupboard - akabati

cure - gukiza

curiosity - amatsiko

curse, to - kuvuma, gutuka

cushion - umusego

custom - umuhango, umugenzo, umuco, ingeso

cut, to - guca, gukata
cut, to be - gucibwa
cut down tree, grass, to - gutema
cut firewood, to - kwasa
cut lengthwise, to - gusatura
cut in pieces (meat, vegetables, cloth), to - gukeba
cut off one's path, to - gutangīra
cut oneself, to - kwitema
cut up, to - gucagagura
cut hair, beard, to - kogosha

cut (n.)(in body) - uruguma

D

damage, to - konona, kwangiza
damaged, to be - kononekara
damage immature crop or produce, to - kwangiza

damp, to be - gukonja

dance, to - kubyina
dance the war (intore) dance, to - guhamiriza

dancer - intore

danger - akaga, impagarara

dare, to - gutinyuka, kubahuka
dare to do something bad, to - guhangara

dark, to be - kwijima
dark, to get - kwira
it's getting dark - burije

darkness - umwijima
darkness in daytime - ubwirakabiri

date - itariki (in month)

daughter - umukobwa

dawdle, to - gusodoka

dawn - umuseke
at dawn - umuseke utambitse

day - umunsi
day after tomorrow - ejo bundi
day before yesterday - ejo bundi
next day - bukeye
hot part of day - agasusuruko
late in day (near sunset) - igicamunsi

daytime - amanywa

dead - -pfuye
half-dead - intere

deaf person - igipfamatwi

dear - ukundwa

death - urupfu
at the point of death, to be - gusamba, kuremba

debt - umwenda

deceit - uburiganya

deceitfulness - ibihendo

deceive, to - guhenda, gushuka, kubeshya
deceive lightly, to - kubeshyabeshya, gushukashuka

December - Ukuboza, ukwezi kwa cumi n'abiri

decide, to - gushinga, kugambirira, kugena

decision (final) - umwanzuro

decision, facing a - mu rungabangabo

declare, to - kogeza

dedicate child, to - gutura umwana Imana

deep - -re-re (kirekire, etc.)

defeat, to - gutsinda

defeat utterly, to - kuganza

defecate, to - kunnya

defend oneself, to - kuburana
defend oneself against accusation, to - kwiregura

defender - umuvunnyi

deficit - igihombo

defile, to - guhumanya
defiled, to be - guhumana

delay, with - bitinze, hatinze, gutinda

deliberately - nkana

delicious, to be - kuryoha

deliver (baby), to - kubyara
come to time to deliver, to - kuramukwa
deliver, to (what doctor does) - kubyaza

delivered (from harm), to be - kurokoka

demon - daimoni

den - isenga, indiri

deny, to - guhakana

depart, to - gusezera

deprive oneself of, to - kwiyaka

depth of lake, in - i muhengeri

descend, to - kumanuka
cause to descend, to - kumanura
descend from, to - gukomoka

describe, to - kurondora

desire, to - gushaka, kwifuza
desire strongly, to - kurarikira

desire, strong - irari

desk - ibiro

despair, to - kwiheba
be in despair, to - gushoberwa

despise, to - kugaya (object, not person), gusuzugura

destine for, to (a certain use, purpose) - kugenera

destitution - ubutindi

destroy, to - kurimbura, gutsemba, gusenya

dew - urume, ikime

diarrhea, to have - guhitwa

die, to - gupfa
be about to die, to - kuremba, gusāmba
make die slowly, to - kwica urubozo

different, to be - gutandukana, guca ukubirina

difficult, to be - kugora, gukomera, kurushya

difficulties - amagorwa

difficulty - ingorane
be in great difficulty, to - kuba mu

mazi abira
not experience difficulty, to - guteta

dig a hole, to - gucukura

dig in the garden, to - guhinga
dig into side of (as hill), to - gukorogoshora

dignity - ubwiyubahe

dilemna, in a - mu rungabangabo

diminish, to - kugabanuka

dinner - ibyo kurya by'isaa sita (noon)
ibyo kurya bya ni joro (at night)

dip in water, to (as finger) - kwibiza, kujabika

diploma - impamyabushobozi

direct towards, to - kwerekeza

direction - icyerekezo

director - umutegetsi

dirt (as on floor) - umwanda, ico
(on body, clothes) - imbyiro

dirty - -bi (mubi, kibi, etc.)

disagreement - amakimbirane

disappear, to - guhera
disappear behind, to - kurenga
disappear into ground, to - kurigita

disappoint, to - guhinyuka

discard, to - guta, kujugunya
discarded, to be - gutabwa

discourage, to - gucogoza

discouraged, to be - gucika intege, kugwa mu kantu

discuss, to - kuvugana

disease - indwara

dish - isahane

dishonest, to be - guhemuka

dishonest person (doesn't keep promise) - umuhemu

dishonesty - ubuhemu

dislike, to - kwanga

disobedient child - tereriyo

disobedient person - ikigande

disobey, to - gusuzugura, kutumvira, kugoma

disorder (noisy) - imidugararo, imvururu

dispensary - ibitaro, ivuriro

dispersed, to be - gutatana

display, to - kumurikwa

displease, to - guhinyuka

dispute - impaka, amahane

disrespect, to - kubahuka

distinct, to be - gutandukana

distinguish between, to - gutandukanya

distribute food, to - kugaburira

disturb, to - gutoba (esp. water)

divide, to - kugabanya

division - igice

divorce, to - kwahukana, gutandukana, gutana

dizzy, to be - kuzenguzwa

do, to - kugira, gukora
do, to cause to - gutera, gutuma

do first, to - kubanza
do something, to - gucira

doctor - umuganga

doctor, to - kuvura

doctrines - inyigisho, imyizerere

dog - imbwa

donkey - indogoba

door - urugi, umwango (Sw.)

door-post - igikingi

doorway - umuryango

dormitory - icumbi

doubt, to - gushidikanya

dove - inuma

down - hepfo

dowry - inkwano
dowry, to pay - gukwa

drag along, to - gukurubana

draw, to (pictures) - gushushanya

draw near, to - kwegera

dream - inzozi

dream, to - kurota

dress - ikanzu, ikizibaho, amahenure (very short)

dress oneself, to - kwambara
dress another, to - kwambika
dress beautifully, to - kurimba

dresser - ibiro

drink, to - kunywa
go in search of drinks, to - kuvumba

drip, to - gutonyanga

drive toward, to - kwerekeza
drive stake, to - gushinga

driver - umushoferi

dropsy - urushwima

drown, to (int.) - kurohama

drowning - uburohame

drum - ingoma

drunk, to be (a person) - gusinda
drunk, to be (liquid) - kunyobwa

dry, to - kuma (int.)
dry up, to - gukama, kuraba (plant)

dry season - icyi (June - September)
urugaryi (December - January)
impeshyi (June)
dry season, to end - guhanguka

duck - igishuhe

due to - ku mpamvu z'uko

dull, to be - kugimba, gutiga

dumbfound, to - kuyobera
dumbfounded, to be - gushoberwa, kugwa mu kantu

dumb person (physical) - ikiragi

dust - umukungugu

dust, to - guhanagura

duty - umurimo

dwarf - igikuri

dwell, to - gutura

dwelling place - inturo

dying person - indembe

dysentery - amacinya

E

each - -ose (yose, byose, etc.)

eagle - kagoma (3rd cl.)

ear - ugutwi

early - kare
  early, to get up - kuzinduka

earnestness - umuhati

earth - isi, igitaka

east - iburasirazuba

Easter - Ipasika

easy, to be - koroha

eat, to - kurya, gufungura
  eat a lot, to - guhaga
  eat together, to - gusangira
  eat with (instrument), to - kurisha
  eaten, to be - kuribwa

eclipse - ubwirakabiri

economical, to be - kurondereza

edge (of cup) - urugāra

effort, to make - kugerageza, gushishikara

egg - igi
  of insect - umugi

eight - munani

eighty - mirongwinani

elder - -kuru (mukuru, etc.)

election - itora

electricity - amashyanyarazi

elephant - inzovu

elsewhere - ahandi

embrace, to (arm across back) - guhobera

embroider, to - gutaka

emphasize, to - kwerura, gushimangira

employee - umukozi

employer (female) - mabuja
  (male) - databuja

empty - gusa, ubusa
  e.g. igikombe ni gusa - the cup is empty
  igikombe kirimwo ubusa - the cup is empty

empty-handed - amāra masa

empty out, to - kujugunya; kumena (liquid)

encircle, to - gutangatanga, gushungera, kugota

enclosure - urugo

encounter, to - gusanga

encourage, to - guhumuriza, gukomeza, gutera inkunga, gushishikaza

end - iherezo; impera (with words of time)
  e.g. ku mpera y'ukwezi - at end of month

end, to - gushira (int.); kumara (tr.)
  come to an end, to - guhera, gukuka
  end (dry season), to - guhanguka
  end meeting, to - guhumuza
  end of oneself, to be at - gushobera, gushoberwa
  end with, to - kugeza

enemy - umwanzi

enjoy, to - kunezererwa, kwinezeza

enough, to be - gukwira, - hagije

it is enough - birahagije

enrich, to - gukungahaza

enter, to - kwinjira
refuse permission to enter, to - guheza
enter a person, to - guhanga umuntu

enthusiasm - umwete, (for work) ishyaka

entice, to - gushukāshuka

entirely - rwose

entrance forbidden, or exclusive - mu muhezo

entrance to kraal - irembo

envelope, to - gusāba

epidemic - icyorezo

epilepsy - igicuri

equal, to be - kungana (size, force, age); kureshya (length, height); kuringanira
make equal, to - kuringaniza

erase, to - gusiba

erosion - isuri

err, to - gufudika, kuyoba

error - ifuti, ikosa
make an error, to - gucikwa

escape, to - gucika
it escaped me - byanciyeho

escort, to - guherekeza, gushagara

especially - cyane cyane

essential - ingombwa

establish, to - gushinga, gushimangira

esteem - icyubahiro

Eternal One - Uwiteka

eternally - iteka ryose

European - umuzungu

even - ndetse
even if - bona
even though - nubwo, naho

even, to be - kuringanira
make even, to - kuringaniza

evening - ni mugoroba (2:00 - 6:00)
become evening, to - kugoroba

ever, to have - kwigera
e.g. wigeze ubona - have you ever seen?

every - -ose (wese, yose, etc.)
every day - iminsi yose
everything - byose
everywhere - hose

evidence (i.e. proof) - intangamugabo, gihamya

evil - ikibi
ubugizi bwa nabi - evil acts

exaggerate, to - gukabya

examination - ikizamini

examine, to - gupima, gusuzuma
examine carefully, to - gusesengura

example - icitegererezo, urugero

exceedingly - cyane
exceedingly white - -era de

excellence - akataraboneka, ihōho

excellent, to be - kuryoha

except - keretse, uretse

exchange, to - kugurana
exchange greetings, to - kuramukanya

exclude, to - kuzira

excluding - uretse

excuse me - mpore, bambe, nako

excuse(s) - urwitwazo

excuse(s), to make - gutora impamvu

exercise, to - kwitoza

exercises, to do - kwiyereka

exhaust, to - kurondora
  exhausted (from work), to be - kugwa agacuho

exhort, to - gushishikaza

exist, to - kuba
  there exists - hariho

exit, to - gusohoka

expect, to - kwiringira, kurindira

experienced, to be - gusesa akanguhe

explain, to - gusobanura
  ask to explain, to - gusobanuza, gusiganuza

expression, to change (due to bad news) - guhonga

exterminate, to - gutsemba

extinct, to become - guhera

extinguish fire, to - kuzimya
  extinguished (fire), to be - kuzima

extort, to - guhenda

extremely - pe, bikabije

eye - ijisho
  eye of needle - umwenge
  close eyes, to - guhumiriza
  set eyes on, to - kurabukwa
  something in the eye - igitotsi

F

fable - umugani
  tell a fable, to - gucira umugani

face - mu maso (hanjye, hawe, etc.)

face (someone), to - guhangana

fact, in - ndetse

factory - inganda

fade, to - gucyuya

fail to find, to - guheba
  fail an examination, to - gutsindwa
  fail someone, to - guhemuka

faint, to - kuraba
  faint from hunger, to - kugwira isari

faith - ukwizera

faithful, to be - kunambaho (till death), kudahemuka

faithful person - umunyamurava, indahemuka

faithfully, to work - gukorana umurava

faithfulness - umurava

fall, to - kugwa
  (as building) - gutemba, gusenyuka, kuriduka
  cause to fall, to - kugusha
  fall down before, to - kwikubita imbere
  fall from above, to - guhubuka, guhanuka

fall into ruin, to - kuriduka, gusenyagurana

falsehood - ikinyoma

fame - inkuru

family - umuryango

famine - inzara

famous - ikirangirire

far, far away - kure

fare (as in boat) - ihoro
receive fare, to - guhoza

farewell, to bid - gusezera

farmer - umuhinzi

fast - vuba, ningoga

fast, to - kwiyiriza ubusa, kwigomwa

fat - amavuta, ikinure
fat child - umushishe

fat, to be - kubyibuha

fate, bad - umwaku

father (my, our) - data, umukambwe (old)
(your) - so, umukambwe
(his, her, their) - se, umukambwe

father-in-law (my) - databukwe
(your) - sobukwe
(his, her, their) - sebukwe

fault - amakemwa

favor - ubutoni

favorite - umutoni
a favorite, to be - gutona

favoritism - ubutoni

fear - ubwoba, umususu

fear, to - gutinya, kugira ubwoba, kwishīsha

fearful, to be - kugingimiranya

fearless, to be - gutinyuka

feast, to give a - kuzimana

feather - iryoya

February - Gashyantare, ukwezi kwa kabiri

fee paid to witchdoctor - ingemu

feed, to - kugaburira

feel, to - kumva

fellowship (n.) - ubusābane, umushyikirano

fellowship, to have - gufatanya, gushyikirana

female - igitsina-gore

fence - uruzitiro

fête - ibirori

fetish - igiheko

fever - ubuganga, ingurumira y'umuriro, umuriro

few - -ke, -keya (bike, makeya, etc.)

field - isambu; (cultivated) - umurima

fifty - mirongwitanu

fig tree - umutini

fight, to - kurwana (int.); kurwanya (tr.)
fight verbally - to - gutāta

figurative speech - amarenga

fill, to - kuzura (int.); kuzuza (tr.), gukungahaza
half-filled, to be - gucāgata
filled to the brim, to be - gusendera

filter, to - kumimina, kuminina

filthiness - ico

final (absolutely) - burundu

final word - umwanzuro

finally - kw iherezo, byimazeyo

find, to - kubona, gusanga
find lost object, to - gutora
find out, to - kwihugura
find the way after being lost, to - guhabuka
not to find, fail to find - kubura, guheba

fine - neza

finger - urutoki(e)
index finger - mukubitarukoko
little finger - agahera
middle finger - musumbazose
ring finger - marere

finger-nail - urwara

finish, to - kumara, kurangiza (tr.), kurundarunda, kunoza

fire - umuriro
set fire to, to - gutwika
(fire) go out, to - kuzima
(fire) put out, to - kuzimya

fireplace - iziko (stones under cooking pot)

firewood - urukwi
gather firewood, to - gusenya, gutashya

firm (stubborn), to be - kutava ku izima

first - mbere e.g. uwa mbere

first, to do - kubanza

firstborn - imfura (impfura)

fish - ifi

fish, to - kuroba

fisherman - umurobyi

fishing net - urushundura

fist - igipfunsi

five - -tanu, eshanu (3rd, 6th cl.)
five times - gatanu

flashlight - isitimu

flat, to be - kuringanira, gutambika
make flat, to - kuringaniza

flavor, to - guhumuza

flavor, to lose - gukayuka

flea - imbaragasa

flee, to - guhunga

flesh - inyama, umubiri

flock (of sheep) - umukumbi

floor - hasi

floor (étage) - igorofa

flour - ifu

flow, to - gutemba

flower - indabyo, uburabyo

fly - isazi

fly, to - kuguruka

flycatcher (bird) - umusamanzuki

foam - ifuro

fog - igihu

fold, to - kuzinga, guhina (esp. arms)

follow, to - gukurikira
follow someone in a position, to - gusimbura
follow after earnestly, to - guhihibikana

folly - ubupfu

fond of (food), to be very - kwibanda kurya

food - ibyo kurya, ibiryo
food for journey - impamba

fool - umuswa

fool, to - kubeshyabeshya, gushukāshuka
fool around, to - gucura urugomo

foolish person - igicucu

foot - ikirenge

for - kubwa, ku, kuri, -ira, -era as verb suffix e.g. gukorera - to work for

forbid, to - kubuza
forbidden, to be - kuzira

force - intege

force (against will), to - guhata

ford - umwaro

forehead - uruhanga

foreign country - ishanga, amahanga

foreign, something - inzaduka

foreigner - umunyamahanga, umuvamahanga

forest - ishyamba

foretell, to - guhanura

forever - iteka ryose, akaramata

forget, to - kwibagirwa
forget momentarily, to - guhuga

forgetfulness - amazinda

forgive, to - kubabarira

forgiveness - imbabazi

fork - ikanya

form - ishusho

forsake, to - kureka, gusiga, kuzinukwa

fortunate, to be - guhirwa

fortune, good - amahīrwe

forty - mirongwine

forward - imbere

fountain - isōko

four - -ne, enye (3rd, 6th cl.)

fowl - inkoko

franc - ifaranga

free - ku buntu (i.e. without charge)

freedom - umudendezo

freedom, to have - kwidegembya

French (language) - igifaransa

fresh - -bisi

fresh, to be - gutoha

fret, to - kuganyira

Friday - ku wa gatanu

friend - inshuti (incuti), mugenzi

friendly, to be - kurangwaho ubucuti

friends with, to be - gushudika

friendship - ubucuti
friendship, close - ubusābane

frightened, to be - guhagarika umutima, guterwa ubwoba

fringe - inshunda

from - i, ku, mu

front of, in - imbere

froth - ifuro

froth at mouth, to - kubimba ifuro

frugal, to be - kurondereza

fruit - imbuto

fry, to - gukaranga

fulfill, to - gusohoza

fulfilled, to be - gusohora

full, to be - kuzura

fullness - ubwuzu

fully - bwite

fun at, to poke - gucyocyora

fur - ubwoya

furthermore - kandi, byongeye kandi

fuss, to - kwitonganya

future - ibihe bizaza

G

gain - inyungu

gain, to - kunguka

game - igikino, umukino
  wild game - inyamaswa

garden - umurima, ubusitani

gardener - umuhinzi

garment - umwambaro, umwenda

gate - irembo

gather, to - gusoroma
  gather together, to - (int.) guterana, gukorana; (tr.) guteranya, gukoranya
  gather firewood, to - gusenya, gutashya

gathering - iteraniro, ikoraniro

gaze at, to - kurangamira

general - rusange

gentle (person) - umugwaneza

gentleness - ubugwanza

gently - buhoro, buhoro-buhoro

germinate, to - kumera

get, to - guhabwa, kubona
  get up early, to - kuzinduka
  get up (from bed, ground), to - kubyuka
  get up quickly (from bed, seat), to - kubaduka
  help someone get up, to - kubyutsa

ghost, ancestral - umuzimu

giant - igihangange

gift - impano, impongano
  gift to superior - ituro

girl - umukobwa, inkumi (teen-age)

give, to - guha, kugaba, gutanga
  give birth to, to - kubyara
  give completely, to - kwegurira
  give oneself wholly to, to - kwibanda ku, kwiyegurira
  give up, to - kwigomwa, guhara (something loved), gutezuka
  given, to be - guhabwa

giving (an offering) - imitangire

glad, to be - kunezerwa, kwishima

gladness - ibyishimo, ishimwe

glance at, to - gutera imboni

glass - ikirahuri

glasses (eye) - amataratara, amadarubindi, indorerwamo

gleam, to - kubengerana

glimpse, to have - kurabukwa

glory - ubwiza

glutton - igisambo

go, to - kujya (with word of place)
kugenda (with no word of place)
go ahead, to - kwicuma
go back, to - gusubira
go by oneself, to - kwigendera
go down hill, to - kumanuka
go from place to place, to - kujarajara
go home, to - gutaha
go on further, to - kurombereza
go out against, to - guhurura
go out (fire), to - kuzima
go outside, to - gusohoka
go to bed, to - kuryama
go to find, to - gusanga
go to meet, to - gusanganira
go toward, to - kugana
go up hill, to - kuzamuka
go with, to - kugendana, kujyana
come on, let's go - hogi, nimuhogi tugende

goat - ihene

goat manure - amahurunguru

goat milk - amahenehene

God - Imana

goings and comings - urujya n'uruza

gold - izahabu

good - -iza, neza (mwiza, cyiza, etc.)

good-afternoon - mwiriwe, mwiriweho, wiriwe

good-bye - muririrwe, muririrweho
(don't expect to see again soon) - murabeho
say goodbye, to - gusezerana

good-morning - mwaramutseho

good-night - muraramukeho

Gospel - Ubutumwa Bwiza

gossip - amazimwe, inzimuzi

gouge out (eye, etc.), to - kunogora

gourd - igicuma

govern, to - gutegeka, kugenga

government - Leta, ubutegetsi

grab, to - gusumira
grab unexpectedly, to - kugwa gitumo

grace - ubuntu

grain, head of (Kaffir corn, etc.) - ihundo

grandchild - umwuzukuru

grandfather - sogokuru, sekuru

grandmother - nyogokuru, nyirakuru

grant - imfashanyo

grant, to - kwemera

grapes - umuzabibu

grasp, to - gufata

grass - ubwatsi, icyatsi

grass ring used to carry load - ingata

grave - imva

gravel - umucanga, umusenyi

great - -kuru (mukuru, gikuru, etc.)

great-grandfather - sogokuruza, sokuruza, sekuruza

great-grandmother - nyogokuruza, nyokuruza, nyirakuruza

green - (fresh) - bisi; (unripe) - -toto
green color - bisa n'ibyatsi bibisi

green, to be - gutoha

green beans - imiteja

greens - imboga, uruboga

greet, to - kuramutsa, gutaha, gutashya
exchange greetings, to - kuramukanya
greet (at beginning of letter), to - gusuhuza

greetings - intashyo, hobe (hello)

grief - umubabaro, agahinda
cause grief, to - kubabaza

grieve, to - kuganya, kubabara

grind, to - gusya, (in mortar) gusekura

grinding stone - urusyo

groan, to - kuganya

ground - hasi, ubutaka

ground, to be - gusebwa

ground nut - ikinyobwa, akabemba

group - agatsiko, inteko, umutwe
group (for work assignment) - icyiciro

group, to - kubangikanya, gukomatanya

grow, to - gukura
grow up, to - kwaruka
grow luxuriously, to - gusagamba

grudge - inzika, umujinya

guard (by door of important person) - umukumirizi

guard, to - kurinda
guard, to be on - kuba maso
guard yourself from, to - kwirinda

guess, to - gufora

guest - umushyitsi

guest room - icumbi

guide - umuyobozi

guide, to - kuyobora

gym, to do - kwiyereka

H

habit - ingeso, umugenzo

hail - urubura

hair (of human head) - umusatsi
(of any but human head) - ubwoya

half - igice kimwe cya kabiri, inusu (Sw.)
half-filled, to be - gucāgata
half-dead - intere

hammer - inyundo

hammock - ingobyi

hand - ikiganza
palm of hand - urushyi (pl. amashyi)
shake hands, to - gukora mu ntoki

hand over, to - gushyīra

handle of cup, pail - umukōndo

handsome person - umunyaburanga bwiza, uw'igikundiro

handsomeness - uburanga

hang, to (int.) - kunagana

hang up, to - kumanika

happen unexpectedly, to - gutungura

happened, what - ibyabaye

happiness - umunezero

happy, to be - kunezerwa, kwishima
happy, to make - kunezeza, kunezereza

harbinger - amendeze

hard, to be - gukomera
hard of heart, to be - kunangirwa
hard to untie, to be - kunangirwa
harden heart, to - kwinangira umutima
no hard feelings - nta mpfane

harm, to - guhangara (as in "nothing can harm us")

harshness - umwaga
harsh person - umunyamwaga

harvest - umwero, isarura, imyaka (crops)

harvest, to - gusarura
harvest millet, to - kugesa

haste - ubwira

hasty manner, in a - ku buryo bukataje

hat - ingofero

hate, to - kwanga

have, to - -fite, kugira
have to, to - -kwiriye
have... thanks to, to - gukesha
e.g. Nkesha Imana agakiza - I have salvation, thanks to God

haze - igihu

he - we, a- (verb prefix)

head - umutwe
head of grain (esp. Kaffir corn) - ihundo
head of grain (immature) - umugengararo
head (of something dead) - igihanga

head up, to (as, cabbage) - kubumba
(as grain) - kugengarara

heal, to - gukiza (tr.), kuvura (tr.)
heal (int.), to - gukira
healed, to be - gukizwa

health - ubuzima
in good health - -taraga (adj.)

healthy - -zima (muzima, kizima, etc.)

heap - ikirundo

heap, to - kurunda

hear, to - kumva

heart - umutima

heat - ubushyuhe

heat, to - gushyushya

heathen - umupagani

heaven - ijuru

heavy, to be - kuremera
heavy-laden, to be - kuremerwa

hedge - uruzitiro
hedge, to plant - kuzitira

heel - agatsintsino

height - ubuhagarike, uburebure

hello - muraho, mwaramutseho, mwiriweho, hobe

help, to - gufasha
help willingly, to - gutabara
go to help, to - kugoboka

help, unexpected - ingoboka

hem in, to - kugota

her - we, cye, bye, etc.

herd - ishya, ubushyo
(pigs only) - umugana

herd, to - kuragira

herdsman - umushumba

here - hano, ino, aha
here is - dore
here and there - hamwe na hamwe

hereditary trait - akarande

hesitate, to - gutindaganya, kugingimiranya

hide, to - guhisha (tr.); gupfurika (int.)
hide from sight, to - gukingiriza (tr.)

high - -re-re (muremure, ndende, etc.)
on high - hejuru
higher up - haruguru
a high place - ahirengeye

hill - umusozi

hinder, to - gukoma

hinder from seeing, to - gukingiriza

hinder progress, to - kudindiza

hinder from getting, to - kuvutsa

hindrance - inkomyi

Hindu - Umuhindi

hippopotamus - imvubu

hired person - umucanshuro

his - we, cye, rwe, etc.

history - inkuru, histwari

hit, to - gukubita

hither and yon - hirya no hino

hoe - isuka

hoe, to - guhinga

hoe, worn out - ifuni

hoe handle - umuhini

hold, to - gufata
hold (someone), to - gutangīra
hold out hands, to - gutega amashyi

hole - umwobo
large hole in ground - icyobo, urwina
hole in cloth, pot, object - umwenge
small hole - intoboro

hole, to get (as pot) - gupfumuka
hole, to make - gupfumura

holiness - kwezwa

holy, to be - kwera, kwegurirwa Imana
holy, to make - kweza
holy (adj.) - ziranenge

Holy Spirit - Umwuka Wera, Mwuka Muziranenge

home, at - i muhira, i wanjye, i wabo, etc.
at the home of - kwa

home, to go - gutaha

homosexual acts, to commit - gutinga

honey - ubuki

honor - icyubahiro, ishema

honor, to - kubaha, gusingiza, kuramya

hope - ibyiringiro

hope, to - kwiringira

horizontal, to be - gutambika
horizontal position - ubutambike

horn (of animal) - ihembe

horse - ifarashi

hospital - ibitaro, ivuriro

hot, to be - gushyuha

hour - isaha

house - inzu

how (manner) - uko, uburyo, ukuntu
(in question) - -te? (ate? bite? etc.)

how do you do? - muraho

how many? - -ngahe? (bangahe, bingahe,etc.)

how often? - kangahe?

however - ariko, ahubwo, ibiri amambu, icyakora

howl, to - kuboroga

hug - umuhoberano

hundred - ijana

hunger - inzara

hungry, to be - gusonza, kugira inzara

hunt (game), to - guhiga
hunt for, to - gushaka, gushakashaka

hurry, to - kwihuta, kubanguka, gutebuka, gukataza
hurry, to be in a - kugira ubwira

hurt, to - kubabara (int.), kubabaza (tr.)
hurt, to be - kubabara, kubabazwa

husband - umugabo

husk, to - gutonora

hut (temporary) - ingando

hymn - indirimbo

hypocrisy - uburyarya

hypocrite, to be - kuryarya

hypocritically, to act - kuryarya

I

I - jye, jyewe, jyeweho
I alone - jyenyine

ice - urubura, amazi akonje cyane

idea - igitekerezo

idiom - inshoberamahanga

idleness - ubudeshyi

idol - ikigirwamana

if - ni, niba, yuko

ignorance, to come out of - kujijuka
ignorance, to bring out of - kujijura

ignorant of, to be - kuyoberwa, kujijwa

ignorant person - injiji

ignore someone, to - kurangārana

ill, to be - kurwara
very ill, to be - kuremba

illness - indwara

image - igishushanyo

imitate, to - kwigana

immediately - nonaha, ubu ngubu
to ..... immediately - guherako ...
e.g. aherako agenda - he immediately went

impartial, to be - kutabera

impartial person - intabera

importance - amatwara

important - -nkuru (mukuru), ingenzi, imena
important, to be - gukomera

improved (physically), to be - koroherwa

in, into - mu, muri

incapable person - umuswa

inception - inkomoko

incipience - amendeze

incite to do something, or act, to - kubwiriza

income - inyungu

incorporation - ubuzima-gatozi

increase, to - kunguka
(of animals) - kororoka (int.), gutubura (tr.)

inculcate, to - kwitoza

independence - ubwigenge

independent, to be - kwigenga

indeed - ndetse, koko

Indian - Umuhindi

infant - uruhinja

inferior to - hanyuma ya

infinitive - imbundo

infirm person - ikimuga

influence, to - kureshya

inform, to - guhugura, kumenyesha
send to inform, to - kurarika
informed, to be - kwihugura, kujijuka

inhabit, to - gutura

inherit, to - kuragwa, kugira umunani

inheritance - umwandu
leave inheritance, to - kuraga

injection - urushinge

injured, to be - gukomereka

ink - vino

innocent - umwere

insect - igisimba
little insects that supposedly make honey - ubuhura

inside - imbere

instead - mu cyimbo, mu kigwi

instruct, to - kujijura, kwigisha

insult - igitutsi

insult, to - gutuka

intelligence - ubwenge

intelligent, to be - guhuguka

intemperance - ivutu

intention - imigambi

intentionally - ikigize cya nkana, bigirankana, nkana

interest - umwete

interim person - agateganyo

interior - indiri

interminable - urudaca

interpret, to - gusobanura
ask to interpret, to - gusobanuza

interrogation, word of - mbese, ese, se

interrupt, to - kurogoya

interrupter - kirogoya

intimidate by, to - gukangisha

into - mu, muri

introduce something new, to - guhanga

invalid - ikimuga, ikirema

invent, to - guhanga, guhimba (esp. poem, story)

invite, to - kurarika, gutumira

iron - icyuma
iron to iron clothes - ipasi, iferu

iron clothes, to - gutera ipasi

irritate, to - kurya

irritation - ishavu

is - -ri, ni
is not - si
Isn't it?, Isn't that so? - si byo?

island - ikirwa

itch (scabies) - ubuheri

itch, to - kuryaryata

itself - ubwayo, ukwayo, etc.

J

jacket - ikoti

January - Mutarama, ukwezi kwa mbere

jealous, to be (momentarily) - -fite ishyari

jealous, to be (as in characteristic or in past) - kugira ishyari

jealousy - ishyari

jest, to - gucyocyora

Jesus - Yesu, Yezu

jigger - ivunja

job - akazi

join, to - gufatanya, kunga

joke, to - gushyenga, guteta

jokes - amashyengo

journal - ikinyamateka, akabarankuru

journey - urugendo

joy - umunezero, ibyishimo, ishimwe
cry (shout) of joy - impundu
great joy - ubwuzu

judge - umucamanza, umunyarukiko

judge, to - gucira urubanza

judgment - urubanza

jug - umudomo

July - Nyakanga, ukwezi kwa karindwi

jump, to - gusimbuka

June - Kamena, ukwezi kwa gatandatu, impeshyi

jungle - ishyamba

just, to be - gukiranuka, kutabera

just, to (to just. . .) - gupfa ku

just as - nka, nk'uko

just person - intabera

justice - ubukiranutsi

justice to one who has been treated unjustly, to give - kurenganura

K

Kaffir corn - ishaka (amasaka)

keep, to - kugumana
keep (as money), to - kuzigama
keep (law, command), to - kwitondera
keep on, to - gukomeza

kettle - ibirika
big kettle - ibinika

key - urufunguzo

kick (in womb, baby), to - gufunyanga

kill, to - kwica, guhemura

kilogram - ikikiro

kind (species) - ubwoko

kind (gentle) person - umugwaneza

kindle, to - gucana

kindness - ubugwaneza

king - umwami

kingdom - ubwami

kingly - icyami

kiss, to - gusoma
kiss repeadtedly, to - gusomagura

kitchen - igikoni

knead (bread), to - gufunyanga, gukora umugati

knee - ivi

kneel, to - gupfukama

knife - imbugita, icyuma

knit, to - kuboha

knock, to - gukomanga
knock down, to - guhondagura
knock down with, to - kuvuza

knot - ipfundo
make a knot, to - gupfundika
tie knots, to - gupfundikanya

know, to - kumenya, -zi
not know, to - kuyoberwa, kujijwa
know oneself, to - kwiyizi

knowledge - ubwenge, ubumenyi

knowledgeable, to be - kujijuka

known, to become - kumenyekana, kwamamara
make known, to - kwamamaza, kogeza, kuranga

kraal - urugo

L

labor pains, to have - kuramukwa

lack, to - kubura, kugomba

ladder - urwego

lady, young (unmarried)- inkumi

lake - ikiyaga, inyanja

lamp - itara, itabaza

lampstand - igitereko

land - ikibanza, imusozi, isambu

language - ururimi

lap, to take on - gukikira

large - -nini

last - iheruka, imperuka
last, to be - guheruka
have or make come last, to - guherutsa

last long, to - kuramba

late, to be - gukererwa, gutinda, gutindaganga
it's late (in day) - burije
get late (in day), to - kwira
make late, to - gukerereza

later - ubwanyuma, hanyuma

later on - hatinze, bitinze, hato, hatoya

laugh, to - guseka

launderer - umumeshi

law - itegeko

lay (tr.), to - kurambika

layman - umurayiki

laziness - ubunebwe, ubudeshyi, ubute

lazy, to be - kunebwa, kugarama, kugira ubute

lead, to - kuyobora, kurōngōra
lead (esp. animals), to - gushorera
lead home, to - gucyura
lead by the hand, to - kurandata

leader - umuyobozi

leaf - ikibabi

leak, to - kuva

lean against, to - kubyiga, kwegeka
(person leans) - kwegamira

learn, to - kwiga, kwihugura

least - uwa nyuma
at least - byibura, nibura

leave, to - gusiga, kureka, kugenda
leave alone, to - kwihorera
leave a place, to - gukuka
leave gradually, to - gutezuka
leave home, to - kuraruka
leave mate (temporarily), to - kwahukana
leave of, to take - gusezera
leave off, to - kureka
leave shore (in boat), to - komoka

leaven - umusemburo

leaven, to - gusembura

left - i bumoso

left, to be - gusigara

left-over bits - ubuvungukira

leg - ukuguru

lemon - indimu

lend, to - gutiza (actual article to be returned)
kuguriza, kugurana (article to be replaced)
kuguza (esp. money)

length - uburebure, ubutambike, umurambararo

leopard - ingwe

leper - umubembe

leprosy - ibibembe

lesson - icyigisho, isomo

let - henga, reka, ngaho (also, subjunctive mood)

letter - urwandiko (epistle), ibaruwa

letter (of alphabet) - inyuguti

liberty - umudendezo

lid - umutemeri, igipfundikizo

lie - ikinyoma

lie, to - kubeshya, kuriganya
lie about, to - kubeshyera
lie down, to - kuryama, kurambarara
lie on pillow, to - kwisegura

life - ubugingo, ubuzima, imibereho

lift, to - guterura
lift up, to - kubyutsa

light - umucyo
light of the moon - umwezi

light (weight), to be - guhuhwa

light weight (though voluminous) - igihwayihwayi

light (kindle), to - gucana, gukongeza

light of, to make - guteta

lightening - umurabyo

like - nka, bene, nk'uko
like that - gutyo (dutyo, batyo, etc.)
like this - gutya (dutya, batya, etc.)

like, to - gukunda

like, to be - gusa, kumera

likeness - ishusho

lime - ingwa

line - umurongo, umusitari

lion - intare

lip - umunwa

list of things - gahunda, urukurikirane

listen , to - gutega amatwi
(in sense of eavesdrop) - kumviriza

little - -to, -toya (muto, bitoya, etc.)

little by little - buhoro-buhoro

live, to - kubaho, kuba
live alone, to - kwibana
live in certain place, to - gutura
live long, to - kuramba
live for God, to - kwiyegurira Imana, gukorera Imana mu mibereho yacu yose, kwiberaho gukorera Imana

liver - umwijima

load - umutwaro

load, to put down - gutura

load, to - gupakira

loan - amaguzanya

loan, to - kuguza

locality - umuhana

lock, to - gukinga

locust - uruyige

lodging, to give- gucumbikira
lodging, to leave- gucumbukura

lodging place - icumbi

log - umugogo

loiter, to - gusodoka

lonesome for, to be - gukumbura

lonesomeness - urukumbuzi

long - -re-re (muremure, kirekire, etc.)
long ago - kera (also, future)

long (extended), to be - kurambura
e.g. amagambo arambuye - lengthy speech

long for, to - kwifuza

look, to - kureba
look! - dore
look about on all aides, to - kuraranganyamo amaso, gukebaguza
look at intently, to - kwitekereza, gutumbīra
look at, leaning over to see, to - kurunguruka
look everywhere, to - kurebareba
look for, to - gushaka
look up, to - kurarama

loosed, to be - guhambuka

loquat - umudigaferi

lord - umwami

lose, to - gutakaza, kubura, guta
lose one's mind, to - gusara
lose one's way, to - kuyoba, kuzimira
cause to lose, to - kuvutsa

lost, to be - kuzimira, guhaba

lost, to be eternally - kurimbuka

lots, to cast - gufinda

loud voice - ijwi rirenga

louse - inda

love - urukundo

love, to - gukunda
pretend to love, to - gukunda urumamo
stop loving, to - kuzinukwa
love one spouse over others, to - gukundwakaza

low - -gufi (kigufi, ngufi, etc.)

lower, to - kumanura

lower down - hepfo

luck, bad - ishyano, umwaku

lust - irari

lust (strong), to - guheheta

luxury, to have (live in) - kudamarara

M

machete - umupanga

mad, to be (sense of crazy) - gusara

maggot - urunyo

maize - ikigori

majesty - ishema

majority - nyamwinshi
majority vote - amajwi nyamwinshi

make, to - gukora, kugira
make bricks, to - kubumba
make fun of, to - gusebya

malaria - ubuganga

male - igitsina-gabo

man - umugabo (married)
of middle age, robust - igikwerere

manioc - umwumbati

manner - uburyo

manners, person of good - imfura (impfura)

manure - amase
manure heap - icukiro

many - -inshi (benshi, byinshi, etc.)
how many? - -ngahe
how many times? - kangahe

March - Werurwe, ukwezi kwa gatatu

market - isoko, iguriro

marriage - ubukwe, gushyingiranwa

marriage, to give in - gushyingira

marrow - igihaza

marry, to - gushyingirwa, kurongora, gushakana
marry brother's widow, to - guhungura
marry woman who has left husband, to - gucyura umugore

marsh - igishanga

marvelous!, that's - ni ishyano

mash, to - gucucuma

mason - umufundi

master (my) - databuja
(your) - shobuja
(his, her, their) - shebuja

mat - ikirago
small mat - umusāmbi
woven grass mat - ikidasesa

matches, box of - ikibiriti

mate (of pair of things) - mugenzi

mature (person), to be - gusesa akanguhe

maturity - umwero (esp. of harvest), ubuhame

May - Gicurasi, ukwezi kwa gatanu

me - jye, jyewe, jyeweho

meal - ifunguro

meal, to have - gufungura

means (of doing something) - ukuntu

measure - inshuro, urugero

measure, to - gupima, kugera

measureless - birenze urugero, kutagira ingano

meat - inyama

medicine - umuti

meditate, to - kuzirikana

meet, to - guhura, guterana, gukorana
meet, to go to - gusanganira

meeting - iteraniro
meeting place - ihuriro
in a meeting - mu ruhame

melt, to - (as butter) - kuyaga
(as sugar) - gushonga
cause to melt, to - kuyaza

member of church - umunyetorero

member of council - umujyanama

mercenary - umucanshuro

mercy - imbabazi

merely - -sa (bisa, basa, etc.)

message - ubutumwa

metal - icyuma

method - uburyo, ukuntu

middle, midst - hagati
in middle of lake - imuhengeri

middle age (30-50) - ubukwerere, imikwerere

midnight - igicuku

might (strength) - ukuboko

mildew - uruhumbu

milk - amata
breast milk - amashereka
clabbered milk - ikivuguto
milk of goat - amahenehene

milk, to - gukama

milk pot - inkongora

millet - ururo, uburo

million - agahumbagiza, miliyoni

mind, to lose one's - gusara

mine - -anjye (uwanjye, ibyanjye, etc.)

minute - idakika, iminota
just a minute - henga, reka

minute (tiny) - -zinya (kanzinya)

miracle - igitangaza

mirror - indorerwamo

miscalculate, to - gucikwa

misery - ubutindi

misfortune - akaga, amakuba

miss, to (absent) - gusiba
    miss someone, to - gukumbura

Miss - Madamuzera

mistake - ifuti

mistake, to make - gufudika, gucikwa
    mistaken, to be - kuyoberwa

mistrust, to - gukenga, kwishisha

mix, to - kuvanga

mixture (e.g. medicine, shoe polish, etc.) - umuti

moan, to - kuganya

mock, to - gushinyagura, gusebya

mockery - agashinyaguro

moisten, to - kubobera

mold - uruhumbu

mold bricks or clay, to - kubumba

moment, brief - akanya

Monday - ku wa mbere

money - amafaranga, ifeza, impiya, inota

monkey (small gray) - inkende

month - ukwezi
    January - Mutarama
    February - Gashyantare
    March - Werurwe
    April - Mata
    May - Gicurasi
    June - Kamena
    July - Nyakanga
    August - Kanama
    September - Nzeli
    October - Ukwakira
    November - Ugushingo
    December - Ukuboza

moon - ukwezi
    light of moon - umwezi

more, to do - kurushaho, kurushiriza
    more than, to be - gusāga
    more, what's - byongeye kandi

moreover - kandi, ndetse, byongeye kandi

morning - igitondo

mosquito - umubu
    mosquito netting - agatimba

mostly - cyane cyane

mother (my) - mama, umukecuru wanjye
    (your) - nyoko, umukecuru wawe, wanyu
    (his, her, their) - nyina

mother-in-law (my, our) - mabukwe
    (your) - nyokobukwe
    (his, her, their) - nyirabukwe

motorcycle - ipikipiki

mountain - umusozi
    mountain (high) - ikirunga
    mountain top - impinga

mouse - imbeba

mouth (inside) - akanwa

mouth, to open - kwasama

move (int.), to - kujegajega, kwinyagambura

move, to (dwelling) - kwimuka
    move about, to - gutembera
    move aside, to (to permit passage) -

kuberereka, kubisa
move on farther, to - kwicuma
move to one side, down, to (tr.) - gutsura

Mr. - Bwana

Mrs. - Madamu

much - cyane, -inshi (byinshi, etc.)

much, to be too - gukabya

mud - urwondo, ibyondo, uburongo

multiply, to - kugwiza (tr.), gukuba (tr.), kugwira (int.)
of animals (int.) - kororoka, gutubura (tr.)

murderer - umwicanyi

murmur, to - kwivovota, kwijujuta (discontent)

music - imuzike, umuziki

must - -kwiriye, kugomba

my - -anjye (wanjye, byanjye, etc.)

myself - ubwanjye, jyenyine

mystery - ubwiru, urujijo

N

nail - umusomari, umusumari

nail, to - gushimangira

naked - gusa, ubusa

naked, to go - kugenda gusa
naked, to be - kwambara ubusa

name - izina

name, to - kwita

narrative - igitekerezo

narrow, to be - gufungana

nation - ishyanga (amahanga)

national (person) - umwene gihugu

native - kavukire

nature - kavukire, kamere, imiterere

nausea - iseseme

navel - umukōndo

near - hafi, bugufi, (with object) hafi ya
nearby - hafi, bugufi

nearly - hafi

necessary, to be - gukwira
e.g. it's necessary - birakwiriye

neck - ijosi

need - ubukene
need, urgent - inkeke

need, to - kugomba

needle - urushinge

needy, to be - gukena

neglect, to - kwirengagiza, kurangārana (esp. person)
I neglected to do it - byanciyeho

negligence - uburangazi

neighbor - umuturanyi, umuturage

neighborhood - umuhana, igiturage

nephew (son of man's sister) - umwishywa, umusengeneza; (son of man's brother) - umuhungu wacu (wanyu, etc.)

nest - icyari

nest, to make - kwarika

net, fishing - urushundura

netting (mosquito) - agatimba

never - ntabwo

never, to have - kwigera (in negative)
e.g. sinigeze mbona - I've never seen

nevertheless - nyamara

new - -shya (gishya, rushya, etc.)
new, something - inzaduka

news - inkuru, amakuru

newspaper - ikinyamateka, akabarankuru

next (in ref. to time) - gutaha
next day - bukeye
next month - ukwezi gutaha
next week - icyumweru gitaha

nice - neza, -iza (mwiza, cyiza, etc.)

niece - umusengeneza
daughter of man's sister - umwishywa

night - ijoro, n'ijoro
the night before - bucya

nine - icyenda

ninety - mirongwicyenda, mirongurwenda

no - oya, nta, ashwi (emphatic), ashwi da!

nobleman - imfura (impfura)

nod, to - guhunikira (sleepy)

noise - urusaku, urwamo (voices), umuriri

noise, to make - gusakuza

none - nta

nonplussed, to be - gushoberwa, kugwa mu kantu

noon - ku manywa

no one - nta we

north - mu majyaruguru

nose - izuru

nostril - izuru

not - nta, si
not at all - na gato, haba na gato, haba na busa, namba
not in the least - na hato

nothing - nta cyo
nothing, for - ubusa, ku busa

notice - itangazo

notice, to - -ruzi (no infinitive)

nourished, well - umushishe

November - Ugushingo, ukwezi kwa cumi na kumwe

now - ubu
right now - ubungubu, ubu nyine
and now - none
now and then - rimwe na rimwe

number - umubare

nurse, to (int.) - konka
nurse, to (tr.) - konsa

O

oar - ingashyi

obey, to - kumvira (a person)
kwitondera (law, command)

observe, to - kuziririza

obstinate, to be - kutava ku izima

obvious, to be - kwihandagaza

occasionally - rimwe na rimwe

occupied, to be - guhugīra

ocean - inyanja

October - Ukwakira, ukwezi kwa cumi

off with you! - hoshi!

offer, to - gutanga (as in church)
offer a gift, to - gutura

offering - ituro

office - ibiro

often - kenshi
how often? - kangahe?

oil - amavuta

ointment, perfumed - amadahano

old, to become - gusaza; -kuru

old man - umusaza, umukambwe

old woman - umukecuru

olive, wild - umunzenze

omit, to - gusiba

on - ku

once - rimwe
once upon a time there was - hāriho
once and for all - byimazeyo

one - -mwe

onion - ubutunguru (or, igi-, or, uru-)

only - gusa, ubusa, -nyine

open, to - gukingura, gufungura, kuzibura
open (as flower), to - kurumbura
open, to become - kuzibuka
open the mouth, to - kwasama

openly - ku mugaragaro
openly, to speak - kwerura

operate (medical), to - kubaga

opportunity - uburyo

oppose, to - kuzira

oppress, to - gupyinagiza

oppressed (with burden), to be - gushengurwa

or - cyangwa

orange (fruit) - indimu ya oranji, icunga
(color) - igaju

ordain, to - kurobanura

order - gahunda
order that, in - kugirango

order, to put in - kuringaniza

order, to - gutegeka

orderliness - gahunda

ordinarily - ubusanzwe

ordinary people, the - rubanda rwa giseseka

organization - gahunda
(in sense of group) - ishyaka (e.g. U.N.)

origin - inkomoko
get one's origin from, to - gukomora

ornament, to - gutaka

ornaments, to wear - kurimba

orphan - imfubyi

other - -ndi (undi, abandi, ibindi, etc.)

ought (to have to) - kugomba, -kwiriye, kurinda

our - -acu (wacu, bacu, byacu, etc.)

out of - mu

out, to put - gusohora
out, to go - gusohoka

outside (of house) - hanze, inyuma

outside, to go - gusohoka

oven (underground, for drying bananas) - urwina

over - hejuru ya

over and above, to be - gusaguka

over there - hariya

overcharge, to - guhenda

overcome, to - gutsinda

overflow, to - gusesekara, gusāga
overflowing, to be - gusaguka

overlook, to - kwirengagiza

oversee, to - kugenzura, gupererereza

overturn, to - guhirika

owl - igihunyira

own, to - gutunga

own (one's own...) - bwite

owner of - nyira

P

pack, to - gupakira

pad, grass (to use on head for carrying load) - ingata

paddle - ingashyi

pagan - umupagani

page - urupapuro

pail - indobo

pain - ububabare, umubabaro
pain, to have - kuribwa, kubabara

paint - irangi
paint, to - gusīga irangi

palm of hand - urushyi

palm oil - amamesa

palm tree - umukindo

pan, cooking - isafuriya

panel, solar energy - ikidasesa

pants - ipantalo

papaya - ipapayi

paper - urupapuro, urukaratasi
newspaper - akabarankuru

parable - umugani

pardon - imbabazi

parent - umubyeyi

part - igice, igika, uruhare
(esp. part received) - umugabane

part in, to have - kugira uruhare

part with, to - gutandukana

participation - uruhare

partnership - ubusābane

partridge - inkwari

party, to have - gucura urugomo

party (political) - ishyaka

pass by, to - guhita, kunyura
pass along, to - kunyura, guca
pass away, to - guhanguka

pass beyond, to - kurenga
pass the night, to - kurara
pass through, to - guca, kunyura
pass through, to make - kuboneza

passage, to permit - kuberereka, kubisa

passer-by - umuhisi

past - ibihe byashize

past, to go - kurenga

pasture - ubwatsi, urwuri

pasture, to - kurisha

patch - ikiremu

path - inzira

patient, to be - kwihangana

pay (n.) - umushahara, igihembo

pay, to - guhemba, gutanga
pay debt, to - kwishyura
pay dowry, to - gukwa

pay attention, to - kwita ku

pay ransom, to - gucungura

peace - amahoro

peaceful, to be - gutuza

peak, mountain - impinga

peanut - ikinyobwa, akabemba

peas - amashaza

peel, to (with knife) - guhata
(with fingers) - gutonora

penalty, to make pay the - kuryoza

pencil - ikaramu

penetrate, to - kumena, gucengera
(as perfume, etc.) - gusāba
penetrate, to make - gucengeza

pension - ubwiteganirize

people (sense of nation) - ihanga, ishanga
(crowd) - itorero
the people - rubanda
ordinary people - rubanda rwa giseseka

pepper - ipiripiri, urusenda (hot)

perfect (n., adj.) - indakemwa

perfect, to - gutunganya

perfect, to be - gutungana

perfume - amarashi

perhaps - ahari, wenda, ubanza, yenda

period (or comma) - akabago, akadomo, akitso

period, to have (female) - kuba mu mugongo

perish, to - kurimbuka

permission - uruhushya

permission, to ask for - gusaba uruhushya

perplex, to - kuyobera
perplexed, to be - gushoberwa, kubunza umutima, kuyoberwa, guhera mu rungabangabo

persecute, to - kurenganya, gutoteza

persevere, to - gushishikara

person - umuntu

personnalité civile - ubuzima-gatozi

perspiration - icyuya

perspire, to (heavily)- kubira icyuya

persuade, to try to - guhendahenda

pester, to - kujujubya

photograph - ifoto

photograph, to - gufotora

phrase - interuro

pick, to - gusoroma
(as corn) - guca
pick out, to - gutoranya
pick up, to - gutora
pick up here and there, to - gutoragura

picture - ishusho

picture, to take - gufotora

piece - igice

piece of something broken - igisate

pierce, to - gutobora

pig - ingurube

pigeon - inuma

pile carefully, to - kurundarunda

pile together, to - kurunda

pillage - amahugu

pillage, to - gusahura

pillow - umusego

pillow, to lie on - kwisegura

pin - umusomari, umusumari

pincher ants - intozi

pineapple - inanasi

pipe (water) - umuheha
(tobacco) - inkono y'itabi

pit - umwobo

pity - impuhwe

place - ahantu
at one place - hamwe
at some places - hamwe na hamwe
high place - ahirengeye
in the place of - ikigwi, icyimbo

place, to - guhingutsa
place above, to - kumanika
place an object, to - gutereka
place on top of, to - kugereka
place near, to - kubangikanya

placenta - ingobyi

plain (near river, lake) - ikibaya

plain, to make - kwerura

plan - integuro, umugambi, ubugenere
plans - imishinga

plan for, to - kugambirira, guteganya, kugena

plane, to - kubāza

plant - imbuto

plant, to - gutera
plant small seeds, to - kubiba

plantation - ishyamba

planter - umubibyi

plaster, to - guhoma

plate - isahane

play, to - gukina

play an instrument, to - kuvuza, gucuranga

play cow game (igisoro), to - kubuguza

playground - ikibuga

plead, to - kuburana (at court)
plead with, to - kwinginga

please, to - kunezeza, kunezereza

plunder, to - gusahura

pocket - umufuka, umupfuka

poet - umusizi

poison - uburozi

poke fun at, to - gucyocyora

police agent - umuporisi

polish, to - guhanagura

politeness - ikinyabupfura, ubupfura

political party - ishyaka

ponder, to - kuzirikana

pool - ikizenga, icyuzi

poor, to be - gukena

poor man (person) - umukene

poorly - nabi

possess, to - gutunga
  possess a person, to - guhanga umuntu
  possessed by, to be - guhangwaho

possessions - ubutunzi
  possession - ubwatsi, isambu, umutungo
  (money) - imari

possessor of - nyira

possible, to be - gushoboka
  it's possible that. . . - ubanza

post (mail) - iposita

pot (clay cooking) - inkono
  (cooking) - isafuriya
  (small clay) - urwabya
  (water pot) - ikibindi

potato, sweet - ikijumba
  potato, white - ikirayi

pour, to - gusuka

poverty - ubukene, umukeno (strong word), ubutindi

powder - ifu

power - imbaraga, ububasha, ubushobozi

power, to have - kubasha

practice - umugenzo

practice, to - kwitoza

praise (n.) - ishimwe

praise, to - gushima, guhimbaza, gusingiza, kurata

pray, to - gusenga, gusaba, kwambaza Imana

prayer - isengesho, ishengesho

preach, to - kubwiriza

precede, to - kubanziriza, gutanga

precursor - amendeze

pregnancy - inda

pregnant, to be - gutwita

prepare, to - gutegura
  prepare for, to - guteganya
  prepare plans (projects), to - gutegura imishinga

present (gift) - impano

pretend to love, to - gukunda urumamo

pretty - -iza (mwiza, beza, etc.)

prevent, to - kubuza, gukoma

prey, bird of - igisiga

price - ikiguzi, igiciro

pride - ubwibone, ubwirasi

priest - umutambyi (in Bible), umusohoza-bitambo, umupadiri (Catholic)

prince - igikomangoma

principal (important) - imena

print, to - gucapa

printed, to have - gucapisha

prior to - mbere

priority - uburenganzira

prison - umunyororo, inzu y'imbohe

prisoner - imbohe, umuyororo, imfungwa

problem - ingorane

procrastinate, to - kwirengagiza

produce abundantly, to - kurumbuka

professor - umwarimu, umwigisha

profit (increase) - inyungu
(benefit) - akamaro

profit, to - kunguka, gucuruza

progress - amajyambere
progress, to hinder - kudindiza

prohibit, to - kubuza

project - umugambi, umushinga, imishinga

promise - isezerano

promise, to - gusezerana

proof - intangamugabo, gihamya

prop up, to - gushyigikira

property - isambu, ubukebe
property father gives to son when he marries - umunani
property, personal - umwihariko

prophesy, to - guhanura

prophet - umuhanuzi

prosperity - ishya n'ihirwe

protect, to - gukuyakuya, gukoma, kurinda

proud, to be - kwirata, kwibona

proverb - umugani

provocation - amakimbirane

Psalm - Zaburi

public - rubanda

publicly - ku mugaragaro, mu ruhame

publish, to - kwamamaza, kogeza, kuranga

pull, to - gukurura
pull out (as stakes in ground), to - gushingura
pull out by roots, to - kurandura
pull out of fire (water), to - kurohora

pumpkin - igihaza, umwungu

punctuation mark - akadomo

punish, to - guhana

punishment - igihano

pupil - umwigishwa, umunyeshuri

pupil of eye - imboni

pure, to be - kwera
pure, to make - kuboneza, kweza

purify oneself, to - kwiboneza, kwiyeza, kwisukura

purity of heart - (u)kwezwa

purple - umuhengeri (rarely used)

purpose - impamvu, intego, ubugenere

purpose, to have for (aim) - -gamije (no inf.)

purse - umufuka, umupfuko

pus - amashyira

push, to - gusunika, kubyiga
push away, to - guhirika
push for, to - gutsura
push someone, to - kwiroha
push to end of endurance, to - kurembya

put, to - gushyira
put away, to - kubika
put clothes on, to - kwambika
put down, to - kurambika
put down load, to - gutura
put in order, to - kuringaniza
put out fire, to - kuzimya
put out in sun, to - kwanika
put roof on, to - gusakara
put together, to - kubumbira, kubangikanya

puzzled, to be - gushoberwa, guhera mu rungabangabo

Q

quality - umuco

quantity - ubwinshi

quarrel - amahane, intonganyi

quarrel, to - gutongana

quarter (of year) i.e. trimester - igihembwe

question - ikibazo

question, to - kwiburanya
question, to ask - kubaza

quickly - vuba, bwangu, n'ingoga

quiet, to be - gutuza, guhora, guceceka

quiet, to make - guturisha, guhendahenda

R

rabbit - urukwavu

race (people) - ishyanga

rack - igitanda

rain - imvura

rain, to (fine) - gutonyanga
it's raining - imvura iragwa
make sound of approaching rain, to - guhorera

rainbow - umukororombya

rainy season - umuhindo (Sept. - Nov.)
itumba (Feb. - May)

raise animals, to - korora (Fr. élevage)

raise eyes (head), to - kurarama, kubura

raise from dead, to - kuzura

raise voice, to - kurangurura

ransom - incungu, inshungu

ransom, to - gucungura

rape, to - gukinda

rat - imbeba

rather (but rather) - ahubwo
(rather than) - aho

raw - -bisi (bibisi, etc.)

reach, to - kugeza
reach certain point of time, to - kugera

read, to - gusoma

ready, to be - kuba witeguye

really - by'ukuri, impamo

rear a child, to - kurera

reason - impamvu, igituma

reason about, to - kwiburanya

rebel - umugome

rebel (openly), to - kugoma

rebellion - ubugome

rebuke, to - gucyaha, gutonganya, kwiyama

recall, to - kwibuka

receive, to - kwakira, kubona
(something as gift) - kuronka

recently - vuba, vub'aha

recently, to have done - guheruka
e.g. sindaheruka kukubona - I haven't seen you recently.

reclaim, to - kwaka

recompense - ingororano

recompense, to - kugororera, kwitura

reconcile, to - kunga

record (phonograph) - idiski, isahane y'ifono

record, to - kwandika

recount to, to - gutekerereza

red, to be - gutukura

redeem, to - gucungura

redeemer - umucunguzi

reed (swamp of reeds) - urubingo

reflect light, to - kurabagirana

refrain from, to - kureka

refugee - impunzi

refuse, to - guhakana, kwanga

regain sight, to - guhumuka

region - ikirere, intāra

reign - ingoma

reinforce, to - gusongora, gushimangira

rejoice, to - kwishima
(over what you've seen) - kwishima
(over what you're told) - kunezerwa

rejoice, to cause to - kwizihiza

related, to be - -fitana (no inf.) isano, gupfana

relationship - umushyikirano

relationship with, to have - gushyikirana na

relative - umuvandimwe, mwene wacu, wanyu, wabo

relax, to - guhwema

release, to - kurekura

relinquish gradually, to - gutezuka

rely on, to - kwiringira

remain, to - kuguma, guhama
remain behind, to - gusigara

remember, to - kwibuka

remind, to - kwibutsa

remind often of one's faults, to - gucyurira umuntu

remove from cross (or from pegs), to - kubambura

renew, to - kuvugurura

rent - ihoro

rent, to receive - guhoza

repair, to - kuvugurura

repay, to - kwishyura
  repay good, to - kwitura ineza
  repay evil, to - kwitura inabi

repeat, to - kongera, gusubira

repeatedly - hato na hato

repent, to - kwihana

repercussion - ingaruka

replace, to - gusimbura
  replace temporarily, to - guhagararira

replacement, temporary - agateganyo

reply, to - gusubiza

report, to give - gutanga raporo

reports, false - impuha

represent, to - guhagararira

representative - umuvugizi

reprimand, to - gucyaha

reproach - amakemwa

reproach, to - kuziza

rescind (vote), to - gushingura

rescue, to - gukiza

resemblance - isāno

resemble, to - gusa, kumera nka

resist, to - kwangirira

resound, to make - kuvuza

respect - icyubahiro

respect, to - kubaha

respect, to not - kubahuka

responsibility - umurimo, inshingano, umwitwarariko

rest, to - kuruhuka, guhwema

restitution, to make - kwishyura

restore sight, to - guhumura

result - ingaruka

resumé, to give - guhina

resurrect, to - kuzuka (int.), kuzura (tr.)

resurrection - kuzuka, izuka, umuzuko

return, to - kugaruka (where speaker is), gusubira (where speaker is not)
  return from, to - gukuka
  return from wandering, to - kubunguka, guhabuka
  return good to, to - kwitura umuntu ineza
  return something, to - gusubiza

reveal, to - guhishura

reveal publicly, to - gusambura

revenge, desire for - inzika

reverence, to - kubaha

revile, to - gutuka

revive, to - kuvugurura

reward, to - kugororera, kwitura

rhythm - gahunda

rice - umuceri

rich, to be - gutunga, gukira

rich person - umukire
  esp. in cattle - umutunzi

esp. in produce - umukungu

riches - ubukire
esp. in cattle - ubutunzi
esp. in produce - ubukungu

ride, to - kugendera ku

ridicule, to - kurengurana, gushinyagura

right, on the - iburyo
all right - nuko
right away - ubungubu, nonaha
right now - ubu nyine
right side - uburyo

right, to be - gutungana

righteous, to be - gukiranuka

righteous person - umukiranutsi

rights - uburenganzira

ring - impeta

rinse, to - kunyuguza

riot - imvururu

rip, to - gushishimura (tr.)

ripe, to be - gushya

ripen, to - kwera, guhīsha

rise (from lying position), to - kubyuka
rise (sun), to - kurasa, kuva

ritual - umuhango

river - uruzi

road - umuhanda

roast (in fire), to - kōtsa

robber - umwambuzi

robbing by force - amahugu

robe - ikanzu

rock - ibuye
large rock - urutare (also, rocky place)

roll, to - gutembagaza (tr.)
roll along, to - kubirindura
roll up, to - kuzinga

roof, to put on - gusakara
roof, to take off - gusambura

room (in house) - icyumba
private room for guest - mu mbere

rooster - isake

root - umuzi

rope - umugozi

rot, to - kubora

round-about-way - inzira y'uruboko

rout, to - kuganza

row - umurongo, umusitari

row (boat), to - kuvugama, kugashya

royal - icyami

rub, to - guhanagura, gusīga
rub hard (as to polish), to - gutsirita

rubber - umupira

rug - umusāmbi

ruin, to fall into (as house) - kuriduka, gusenyagurana

rule - itegeko

rule, to - gutegeka, gutwara

rumors - impuha

run, to - kwiruka
run after, to - kwirukana

run fast, to (esp. to avoid being beaten) - kuyabangira ingata
run very fast, to - kwirukanka

rural - icyaro

rush upon, to - kwiroha

rust - ingese

rusty, to become - kuzana ingese

S

sack - igunira, umufuka, umupfuka, isaho, uruhago (small woven)

sacrifice - igitambo

sacrifice, to - gutamba, kwigomwa

sad, to be - kubabara, kugira ishavu
sad, to appear - kwijima
sad, to make - gushengura, gushavuza

sadness - umubabaro, ishavu

safe and sound - -taraga (adj.)

sake of, for - kubwa

salary - igihembo, imihemberwe, umushahara

saliva - amacandwe

salt - umunyu

salvation - agakiza
salvation, source of - amakiriro

same - kimwe, hamwe, etc.

sand - umucanga, umusenyi

sandal - inkweto

sandals, to wear - gukweta
sandals, to take off - gukwetura

satisfactory - neza, -iza (mwiza, etc.)

satisfied, to be - guhaga, kwishima

satisfy, to - guhaza, gukungahaza

Saturday - ku wa gatandatu

sauciness - amahane

save, to - gukiza
save (as money), to - kuzigama
save from being wiped out (as family name), to - gucikura
save (from danger, death), to - kurokora
save from danger, to try to - kurengera

saved, to be - gukizwa, kurokoka

saved ones - abarokore

saves, thing that - amakiriro

savior - umukiza

saw - umusumeno, umusomeno, urukero

say, to - kuvuga
saying - -ti (ati, bati, etc.)

scar - inkovu
scar from cut - indasago

scatter, to - gusandara (int.)(things)
gusandaza (tr.)

scattered (people, animals), to be - gutatana

schedule - ingengabihe

school - ishuri
para-primary - ishuri ry'ingoboka
primary - ishuri ribanza
secondary - ishuri ryisumbuye
university - ishuri rikuru

scold, to - guhana, guhanura, gutonganya, gucyaha (quietly), gukankamira (loudly)

scorn, to - kugaya, kunegura, guhinyura

scorpion - indyanishamurizo

scrape, scratch soil, to - guharura

scratch, to - gushima
scratch oneself, to - kwishima

scribe - umwanditsi

scrub (brush) - igihuru

scrutinize, to - gusuzuma

sea - inyanja

search, to - gushaka
search diligently, to - gushakashaka

season, dry (long, June-Sept.) - icyi
(short, Dec.-Jan.) - urugaryi
season, beginning of dry - impeshyi

season, rainy (Sept. - Nov.) - umuhindo
(March - May) - itumba

seat - icyicaro

second - uwa kabiri, icya kabiri, etc.

second a motion, to - gusongera, gushyigikira

secret - ibanga
secret (strong word) - ubwiru

secretary - umwanditsi

section (of people, as for work assignment) - icyiciro, igika

see, to - kureba, kubona, kuruzi
see something briefly, to - guca iryēra
see suddenly, to - kurabukwa

seed - imbuto

seeing that - ubwo

seek, to - gushaka
seek after (as goal), to - kurangamira
seek chance to "get" somebody, to - kugenzereza

seems that..., it - ubanza

seer - umuhanuzi

seize, to - gufata, gusumira

seize property of another, to - guhuguza

seized with terror, to be - gukangarana

self - ubwa (use reflexive)

self-love - kwikunda

self-respect - ubwiyubahe

self-surrender - kwitanga

selfish, to be - kwikanyiza

sell, to - kugurisha

send, to - kōhereza, gutuma
send away, to - guheza
send back (as cows), to - gucyura
send wife away publicly, to - gusenda

senior - -kuru (mukuru, bakuru, etc.)

sentence (gram.) - inshinga, interuro

separate, to - gutandukana (int.), gutandukanya (tr.), gusobanura (tr.)

September - Nzeri, ukwezi kwa cyenda

seriously, to not take - guteta

servant - umugaragu (male), umuja (female)

serve, to - gukorera, guhakwa
serve meal to guests, to - kuzimana

session (as of conference) - icyiciro

set (sun), to - kurenga
set aside, to - kurobanura
set eyes on, to - kurabukwa
set fire to, to - gutwika

set a time, to - kugena igihe
set (trap), to - gutega

seven - -rindwi, ndwi (with 3rd & 6th cl.)

seventy - mirongwirindwi

sever, to - guca

several - -mwe (bamwe, bimwe, etc.)

severity - umwaga

sew, to - kudoda

sex (male, female) - igitsina cy'abantu

shade - igicucu

shadow - igicucu

shake, to - gutigisa (tr.), kujegajega (int.)
shake (as earth), to - kunyeganyega (int.)
shake (as person), to - guhinda umushitsi (int.)
shake (as rug), to - gukunguta, gukunkumura (tr.)

shake hands, to - gukora mu ntoki

shake (object) hard, to - gucugusa, gukuka

shake head, to - kuzunguza

shallow - -gufi (kigufi, etc.)

shame - isoni

shape - ishusho

share, to - gusangira

sharp, to be - gutyara

sharpen, to - kunagura, gutyaza

shave, to - kogosha

she - we, a- (as verb prefix)

sheep - intama

sheet - ishuka

shell, to - gutonora, guhungura

shelter, temporary - ingando
shelter from rain - ubwugamo

shelter, to seek - kugama

shepherd - umwungeri

shepherd, to - kuragira

shield, to - gukingiriza

shine, to - kwaka, kumurika, kubengerana
(sun) - kuva
(reflected light) - kurabagirana

shipwreck - uburohame

shirt - ishati

shoe - ikirato, inkweto

shoes, to wear (put on) - gukweta

shoot, to - kurasa

shop - iduka, imangazini

shop (for food), to - guhaha

shore - imusozi, inkombe, umwaro, inkuka

short - -gufi (mugufi, kigufi, etc.)

short cut - inzira y'ubusamu

short dress (very) - umwenda w'amahenure

should - -kwiriye, kugomba, kurinda

shoulder - igitugu

shout, to - gutaka, gusakuza, gutera (ijwi) hejuru, kurangurura, gusakabaka

shout of joy - impundu

shove, to - guhirika

show, to - kwereka, kugaragaza, kumurikwa
show oneself, to - kwiyereka

shrivelled, to be (arm, leg) - kunyunyuka

shut, to - gukinga, gufunga

sibling - umuvandimwe, mwene nyina (se)

sick person - umurwayi

sick, to be - kurwara
care for the sick, to - kurwaza

sickle - umuhoro

sickness - indwara

side - uruhande, iruhande
on this side - hino
on this side of water - hakuno
on other side of water - hakurya

sieve - akayunguruzo

sift, to - gushungura

sigh, to - gusuhuza umutima

sight, to regain - guhumuka
sight, to restore - guhumura

sign - ikimenyetso

sign language - amarenga, guca amarenga

signal to come, to - kurembuza

silence - ituza

silence, to - guturisha, gutwama

silent, to be - gutuza, guceceka, kwihorera

silently - bucece

silver - ifeza

similarity - ihuriro, isāno

sin - icyaha, igicumuro

sin, to - gucumura, gukora icyaha

since - kuva, ko

sincerity - ubutariganya

sing, to - kuririmba

singular (gram.) - amamwe, buke

sinner - umunyabyaha

sip, to - gusoma

sir - bwana

sister - mwene nyina (se)
(of boy) - mushiki
(younger, of girl) - murumuna
(older, of girl) - mukuru

sit, to - kwicara

site, new - ubuvunnyi

six - -tandatu, esheshatu (3rd & 6th cl.)
six times - gatandatu

sixty - mirongwitandatu

skill - ubuhanga, ubukorikori

skilled, to be - guhuguka

skilled person - umuhanga, impuguke

skin - uruhu
skin for carrying baby - ingobyi

skirt, long - umukenyero

sky - ikirere, ijuru

slander - igitutsi

slander, to - gutuka

slap - urushyi

slate - urubaho

slave - imbata

sleep, to - gusinzira

sleepiness - igitotsi

slide, to - guserebeka
    slide down hill on banana trunk, to - gutsuka

slightly - buhoro

slip out (e.g. from pocket), to - gusosoroka

slow, to be - gutinda, gutindaganya

slowly - buhoro, buhoro-buhoro

small - -to, -toya (bato, bitoya, etc.)

smash, to - guhondagura

smear, to - gusīga

smell, to - kumva (tr.)
    cause to smell good, to - guhumuza
    smell good or bad, to - guhumura
    smell bad, to - kunuka

smile, to - kumwenyura

smoke - umwotsi

snake - inzoka
    one that bites at both ends - ikirumirahabiri

snare - umutego

sneeze, to - kwitsamura

so, so that - kugirango, ngo
    and so - none
    isn't it so - si byo?
    so-and-so - kanaka, nyiranaka (fem.)

soak in water, to - gutumbika

soap - isabune

soft, to be - koroha

soil - ubutaka, igitaka
    place where soil is thin - akāra

soldier - umusirikare, umusoda, ingabo

some - -mwe (bamwe, bimwe, etc.)
    some places - hamwe na hamwe
    sometimes - rimwe na rimwe, ubundi

son - umwana, umuhungu
    son of - mwene (pl. bene)

song - indirimbo

soon - vuba, bidatinze, vubaha

soot - imbyiro

sore (as ulcer) - igisebe, igikomere, uruguma (fresh)

sore, to be - kubabara

sorrow - agahinda
    deep sorrow - amajune

sort out, to - gusobanura

soul - ubugingo

sour, sharp - ikereta

sour, to be - kubīha

south - mu majyepfo

sow, to - kubiba

sower - umubibyi

space - umwanya

speak, to - kuvuga
    speak evil of, to - gusebya
    speak indistinctly, to - kudedemanga
    speak plainly, clearly, to - gufobora
    speak without thinking, to - guhomboka

spear - icumu

special, to be - kwiharira (for special

purpose)

speechless, to be - kudakoma

spend the night, to - kurara
spend night away from home, to - gucumbika
spend time, to - kumara

spill, to - kumena (tr.), kumeneka (int.)
gusesekara (int.)

spirit - umwuka
Holy Spirit - Umwuka Wera, Mwuka Muziranenge
spirit, ancestral - umuzimu
spirit, harmful ancestral - igisigo

spit - amacandwe

spit, to - gucira amacandwe
spit on, to - kuvundereza amacandwe

spoil, to - konona (tr.), kubora (int.)
spoil a child, to - gutetesha
spoil (as, cooked food), to - kugaga

spoiled, to be - kononekara

spoiled child - umutesi

spoon - ikiyiko, urupahu

spot - inenge

spread, to - gusāba (int.)
spread (as news), to - gukwira (int.), gukwiza (tr.), kogeza
spread everywhere, to - kwamamara (int.), kwamamaza (tr.)
spread grass, to - gusasa
spread out, to - kurambika

spring (of water) - isōko

spring up (water, blood), to - kududubiza

spy on, to - kugenza, gutata, kugenzura

squash - umwungu

squeeze, to - gukamura

stale, to be - kugaga

stammer, to - kugingimira

stamp - itembura

stand, to - guhagarara
stand up, to - guhaguruka
stand up, to cause someone to - guhagurutsa

star - inyenyeri

stare at, to - kurangamira, guhangana amaso

start, to - gutangira
start with, to - guhēra
start by, to - kubanza

startled, to be - gukanga

statistics - barura

stay, to - kuguma, guhama
stay a certain length of time, to - kumara

stead - ikigwi, icyimbo

steal, to - kwiba

step - intambwe

step, to - gutambuka
step on, to - gukandagira

steward - umujyanama, umunyabintu

stick - igiti
stick of fire-wood - urukwi
walking stick - inkoni

stick out (as, from pocket), to - gusososoroka

stiff, to make (i.e. to stiffen) - kugagaza

still - (use -racya- tense)

stingy, to be - kwikanyiza

stink, to - kunuka

stomach - igifu, inda

stone - ibuye

stoop down, to - kunama, kubama

stop, to - kureka, kurekeraho (int.), guhagarara (int.), guhagarika (tr.), kubuza (tr.), kurorera (int.)
stop! - buretse!
stop battle (argument), to - guhosha (tr.)
stop bleeding, to - gukama (int.)
stop boat, to - gutsīka (tr.)

stopper (as in bottle) - igipfundikizo

store (shop) - iduka, idukuru

store, to - kubika
store crops in granary, to - guhunika

storm of wind - ishuheri
storm on lake - umuhengeri

story - umugani, igitekerezo

story (floor) - igorofa

stout, to be - kubyibuha

stove - ifura, iziko

straight, to be - kugororoka, kweguka
straight, to make - kugorora

straighten up (erect), to - kweguka

strain (filter), to - kumimina, kuminina

strainer - akayunguruzo

strange, something - inzaduka

straw (drinking) - umuheha

stray, to - komongana

stream - umugezi

strength - intege, imbaraga

stretch out (arm), to - kurambura
stretch out (as lie down), to - kurambarara
stretch out (hide), to - kubamba

stretch tight, to - kurēga (tr.)

stretcher - ingobyi

strife - intambara

strike, to - gukubita
strike suddenly (unexpectedly), to - kugwa gitumo (see I Thess 5:3)

string - umugozi

strive for, to - guharanira, gutsura

strong, to be - gukomera
strong, to make - gukomeza

strong man - umunyamaboko, igikwerere

stubborn, to be - kudakurwa ku izima, kutava kw izima

stuck (in mud), to get - gusaya

student - umwigishwa, umunyeshuri

study, to - kwiga

study, manner of - imyigire

stumble, to - gusitara

stupid person - umuswa

sturdy, to be - gukomera

stutter, to - kugingimira

submerged, to be - kurengerwa

subtract, to - gukūra

succeed in one part but fail in another, to - kwesa umunyana

successful, to be - gutsinda

suddenly, to appear (happen) - guturumbuka, gitumo, gutunguka, gutungura

suffer, to - kubabara
suffer severely, to cause to - kubaga, kurembya

suffering, not physical - umubabaro
suffering, physical - ububabare

suffice, to - gukwira, -hagije
it's sufficient - birahagije

sugar - isukari

sum paid to witchdoctor - ingemu

sum up, to - guhina

summer - icyi (i.e. dry season, actually winter here)

sun - izuba

sun, to put out in - kwanika
sun, to bring in from - kwanura

Sunday - ku cyumweru

sunset - ikirengazuba
near sunset time - igicamunsi

superbness - ihōho, akataraboneka

supervise, to - kugenga

supplementary - umugereta

support - inkunga, ubwishingizi

support, to - gutera inkunga, gushyigikira

suppose, to - kugirango, gukeka

surface (e.g. of square) - ubuso

surpass, to - kurusha, kuruta, gusumba, kurenga, kurushaho, kurushiriza, gutambutsa

surplus, to be a - gusāga, gusaguka

surprise, to - gutangaza, kugwa gitumo

surround, to - gukikiza, kugota, gutangatanga, gushungera

survive (a calamity), to - guhonoka

suspect, to - gukeka

suspicion, to - gukenga

suspicions - amakenga

sustain, to - gutera inkunga

swallow, to - kumira

swamp - igishanga

swamp of reeds - urubingo

swear (sense of oath), to - kurahira

sweat (n.) - icyuya

sweat, to - kubira icyuya

sweater - umupira

sweet potato - ikijumba

swell, to - kubyimba

swim, to - koga

swing (as children play in) - urucundo

swing, to - kwicunda

sword - inkota

sycamore tree - umuvumu

system - gahunda

T

table - ameza, imeza

taboo, to be - kuzira

tail - umurizo

take, to - kwenda
take, go with, to - kujyana
take away, to - kuvana, gukura, gukuraho, gutwara
take away from, to - kwaka
take bribe, to - kurya ruswa, kwakira impongano
take by force, to - kunyaga
take clothes off another, to - kwambura
take from (certain place), to - kuvana
take hold of, to - gufata
take leave of, to - gusezera
take self off, to - kwigendera
take to someone, to - gushyīra

talk - ikiganiro

talk, to - kuvuga
talk against, to - guhinyura

tall - -re-re (muremure, kirekire, etc.)

tanner - umukannyi

tardy, to be - gutinda, gukererwa

task - umurimo

taste (i.e. to see if it's good), to - gusogongera, kuroreza
taste good, to make - guhumuza
taste bad, to - kubīha

taunt, to - gucyurira umuntu

tax - umusoro, ikoro

tax collector - umukoresha w'ikoro, umusoresha

tea - icyayi

teach, to - kwigisha

teacher - umwigisha, umwarimu

teaching (lesson) - icyigisho
(doctrine) - inyigisho
(manner of teaching) - imyigishirize

tear, to - gucika (int.), guca (tr.), gushanyuka (int.), gushanyura (tr.)
tear, to (strong word) - gushishimura (tr.)
tear (int.), to (long tear due to wear) - gutabuka
tear down, to - gusenya

tears - amarira, imyisozi

teaspoon - akayiko, akajyiko

technique (technical knowledge, skill) - impuguke

tell, to - kubwira, kuvuga
tell a lie, to - kubeshya

temple - urusengero

temporary - agateganyo

tempt, to - gushuka, gushāshuka, kugerageza, koshya

temptations - amoshya, ibigeragezo, ibishuko

ten - icumi

terrible, that's - ni ishano

terrified, to be - gukuka umutima

terror - impagarara

terror, to be seized with - gukangarana

test (n.) - ikizamini

test, to - kugerageza, gusuzuma, kugenzura

testament - isezerano

Old Testament - Isezerano rya Kera
New Testament - Isezerano Rishya

testify, to - guhamya

thank, to - gushima
thank for gift, to - gukura ubwatsi
thank you - (m)urakoze, nuko nuko, ndagushimye

that - ko, yuko
that (demonstrative) - uriya, uwo, wa, etc.

their - -abo (wabo, cyabo, etc.)

them - bo

then - nuko, rero, ubwo
and then - maze
then (remembered) - burya

there - aho, aha
here and there - hamwe na hamwe

therefore - none, niko, none rero, noneho

there is - hari

these - aba, iyi, izi, etc.

they - bo, ba- (as prefix)

thick - -nini

thief - umujura, umwambuzi, igisambo

thin - -to, -toya (muto, gitoya, etc.)

thin, to be - guhorota
(due to illness) - kunyunyuka

thing - ikintu

think, to - gutekereza, kugirango, kuzirikana, gukeka, kwibwira
think about (without speaking), to - kwiyumvira
I think that... - ubanza, ngira ngo, nibwira

thirst - inyota
thirsty, to be - kugira inyota

thirty - mirongwitatu

this - uyu, iki, etc.

thorn - ihwa

those - bariya, abo, ba, etc.

thought - igitekerezo
thought, to be in deep - kwiyumvira

thousand - igihumbi
ten thousand - inzovu
one hundred thousand - agahumbi

thrash around (as sick person), to - kwigaragura

thread - urudodo

threaten, to - kwihangiriza, gukangara, gukangisha

threatenings - ibikangisho

three - -tatu, eshatu (3rd & 6th cl.)

thrice - gatatu

throat - umuhogo

throw, to - gutera
throw at, to - gutērera
throw away, to - guta, kujugunya
throw behind one's back, to - kwirenza
throw down, to - gutura, kwesa
throw into water, to - kuroha

thumb - igikumwe

thunder - inkuba

thunder, to - guhinda

Thursday - ku wa kane

tie - umushumi

tie, to - kuboha, gupfundika
tie an animal, to - kuzirika
tie neck of sack, to - kuniga
tie up, to - guhambira
tie up boat, to - gutsīka

tick (insect) - ikirondwe

tile (floor) - isasa

tile (roof) - itegura

time - igihe, umwanya
as time goes on - uko ibihe biha ibindi
at another time - ubundi
at what time? - gihe ki?
long time ago (or future) - kera
on time - kare, ku gihe
time off - uruhushya

time, to set a - kugena igihe

times - inshuro
how many times? - kangahe?

tiny - -nzinya (with 7th cl. only)
tiny thing - akadomo

tire - umupira

tired, to be - kuruha, kunanirwa

to - ku, mu, i
to and fro - hirya no hino

tobacco - itabi

today - none, uyu munsi

toe - ino

toenail - urwara

together - hamwe, kumwe
a get-together - iteraniro

together, to come - guterana

toilet, to do one's (wash, comb, etc.) - kwirimbisha

tomato - inyanya

tomb - imva, igituro

tomorrow - ejo
day after tomorrow - ejo bundi

tongue - ururimi

tool (metal) - icyuma

tooth - iryinyo

top (on the top) - hejuru

torment -agashinyaguro

totally - rwose

touch, to - gukoraho
touch with, to - gukoza

tower - umunara

town - umudugudu, ikirorero, umujyi

trade, to - gucuruza

trader - umucuruzi, umuhanjuzi

tradition - akarande

train (child), to - kurera

trait - ingeso

trample on, to - kuribata

transmit from one to another, to - guhererekanya

trap - umutego, rwagakoco (small)

trap, to set - gutega

traveller - umugenzi

traverse, to - kumena

tread on, to - gukandagira

treasury - imari

treat (medical), to - kuvura
take someone to be treated, to - kuvuza
treat (behavior), to - kugenza, gufata
treat unjustly, to - kurenganya
treat very badly, to - guhemura
treat wounds, to - gukomora

treats illness, one who - umuvuzi

tree - igiti
tree, base of - igishitsi

tremble, to - guhinda umushitsi
(as earth) - kunyeganyega

trembling - umushitsi, igishitsi

trial - urubanza

tribe - ubwoko

tribunal - urukiko

trick, to - kuriganya

trickery - uburiganya

triumph, to - kunesha, gutsinda

trouble, to - kurushya, gutoba
trouble, to cause - gutera amahane, gutāta
troubled, to be - guhagarika umutima, kugwa mu kantu

troubles - amakuba, ibyago, amagorwa

true - koko

truly - bwite, by'ukuri, mu by'ukuri

trunk of banana tree - umutumba

trust - icyingiro, ibwiringiro

trust, to - kwiringira, kwizera

truth - ukuri

try, to - kugerageza

Tuesday - ku wa kabiri

turaco - inkorongo

turn around, to - guhindukira (int.), guhindukiza (tr.)
turn away one's eyes, to - guhunza amaso
turn someone over to authority, to - kugabiza
turn toward, to - kwerekera
turn upside down, to - kubika

twenty - makumyabiri

twice - kabiri

twins - impanga

twist cords, to - guhotora, kubohekanya

twist forcibly, to - gucumba

two - kabiri, -biri

type - ubwoko

U

ugly - -bi (mubi, kibi, etc.)

ulcer - igisebe

umbrella - umutaka

unable to do something, to be - kunanirwa

uncle, paternal - data wacu (wanyu, wabo)
uncle, my maternal - marume

unclean, to be - guhumana
unclean, to make - guhumanya

unconscious - intere

under - munsi ya

underneath - munsi

understand, to - kumva, gusobanukirwa

unexpected help - ingoboka

unexpectedly, to come (happen) - gutungura

unfairly, to treat - kurenganya

unfaithful to, to be - guhemuka, guhinyuka

unfortunate, to be - kugorwa

unite, to - kubumbira, kunga ubumwe
(implies previous separation) - kwiyunga

unjustly, to treat - kurenganya

unload, to - gupakurura

unlock, to - gukingura

unripe - -bisi, -toto

unsatisfactorily - nabi

unstop, to - kuzibura
unstopped, to become - kuzibuka

untie, to - kubohora, gupfundura, gufundura
untie animal (from stake), to - kuzitura
untied, to be - guhambuka

until - kugeza
(if followed by verb) - kugeza aho

unwed mother - ikinyandaro

uproot, to - kurandura

upside down, to turn - kubika, gucurika, guhirika

us - twebwe, twe

use - akamaro, umumaro

use, to - gukoresha
use up, to - kumara
use up for nothing, to - gupfusha ubusa

usually - ubusanzwe

V

vacation - uruhushya

vaccination - urukingo, indasago

vagabond, to be a - kubuyera, kuraruka

vain, in - ku busa, ubusa, amāra masa

valley - akabande

valuable - ingenzi

value - akamaro, igiciro

vegetable - imboga, uruboga

verb - inshinga

verse - umurongo

very - cyane
very much - rwose
very well - henga

vicinity, in this - ino

village - igiturage, icyaro
(hill with numerous homes) - umurenge

villagers - abaturage

vines - umuzabibu
vineyard - uruzabibu

violent, to become - kurubira

virtue - umuco

visible, to be - kugaragara, kuboneka
visible, to make - kugaragaza

visit, to go to - gusura, gutembera, gusuhuza
visit bereaved person, to - kuyaga
visit with, to - kuganira na

visitor - umushyitsi

voice - ijwi
voice, loud - ijwi rirenga

volcano - ikirunga

vomit, to - kuruka

vote to do, to - gushinga
vote (in election), to - gutora
vote, to take a - gucisha mu majwi

vow, to - kurahira

vulture - inkongoro

W

wage - igihembo, umushashara

wail, to - kuganya, kuboroga

wait, to - gutegereza, guhagarara
wait! - buretse
wait for, to - kurindira, gutegereza

waken, to - gukangura (tr.), gukanguka (int.)

walk, to - kugenda
walk, to go for a - gutembera, kugendagenda

walking stick - inkoni

wall - igisika
(interior) -urusika
(exterior) - ikibambazi

wander about, to - kuzerera, kubuyera, komongana
find the way after wandering about, to - guhabuka
wander about without hope of finding the way, to - guhaba

want, to - gushaka

warm oneself by fire, to - kota

warn, to - guhanura, guhugura, kwihangiriza, gukangara, kwiyama, kuburira

wash (clothes), to - kumesa
(body, self) - kwiyuhagira
(body, another) - kuhagira
(feet) - koga
(hands) - gukaraba
(vegetables) - kuronga
(most anything else) - koza

waste, to - gupfusha ubusa, kwangiza, gukerensa, gutagaguza

watch (clock) - isaha

watch, to - kuba maso, kurinda

watchman - umunyezamu, umurariri zi

water - amazi
water, to bring - kuvoma
water, to dip in (as finger) - kwibiza

water pot - ikibindi

waves - umuraba

way - inzira, uburyo
round-about-way - inzira y'uruboko
short-cut way - inzira y'ubusamu
way over there - hariya, -iriya

we - twebwe, twe
we alone - twenyine

weak, to be - kugira intege nke

weaken, to - gucogoza

weakness - intege nke

wealth - ubutunzi, ubukire, ubukungu

wealthy person - umutunzi, umukire

weapons - intwaro

wear, to - kwambara
wear ornaments, to - kurimba
wear out, to - gushira (int.)
wear sandals (shoes), to - gukweta

weary, to become - guhwema, kunanirwa, kuruha

weave, to - kuboha

wedding - ubukwe
wedding guest (groom's relative) - umusangwa

Wednesday - ku wa gatatu

weed, to - kubagara

weeds - ibyatsi bibi

week - icyumweru
last week - icyumweru gishize
next week - icyumweru gitaha
week days - iminsi y'imibyizi

weep, to - kurira

weigh, to - gupima, kugera

weighed down, to be - gushengurwa

welcome, to - kwakira

well (n.) - iriba

well, to get - gukira

well-being - imibereho

well up (water, blood), to - kududubiza

wet - -bisi

what - -ki, iki?
what it is - icy'ari cyo
what is more - byongeye kandi

wheat - ingano

wheel - ikigata

when - ubwo, igihe
when? - ryari?, gihe ki?

whenever - uko, iyo

where - he?, hehe?, aho

whereas - naho

whether - yuko, ari

which - -he? (ikihe?, uwuhe?, etc.)

whip (leather, rubber) - umukoba

whip, to - gukubita
(eggs, milk, etc.) -kuvuruga

whistle (n.) - urushyungute

whistle, to - gushyunguta

white - -era (cyera, etc.), igitare, umwere
white, exceedingly - -era de
white person - umuzungu

white, to be very - kwererana
white, to make - kweza

whiteness, dazzling - urwererane

who? - nde? (bande?, pl.)

whole - -ose (bose, cyose, etc.), -zima

wholeness - ubuzima

why? - ko, kuki?, n'iki gituma?
that's why - ni icyo gituma, bituma

wicked, to be - gukiranirwa

wide - -gari (hagari. etc.)

widow - umupfakazi

widow(er), to become a - gupfakara

width - ubwaguke, ubugari

wife - umugore, muka

wild animal - inyamaswa

wilderness - ubutayu

will (e.g. of God) - ubugenere, ubushake

willing, to be - kwemera

wilt, to - kuraba

win, to - gutsinda

wind - umuyaga

window - idirisha

windstorm - ishuheri

wine - vino

wing - ibaba

winnow, to - gushungura

wire - umukwege

wisdom - ubwenge

witch doctor - umupfumu

witchcraft - uburozi

with - na

withdraw quickly, to - kwikubura

withered (arm, leg), to be - kunyunyuka

withhold, to - kwima

withstand, to - guhangana

witness (male or female) - umugabo
witness (words) - ubuhamya

witness, to - guhamya, guhamiriza

woman (married) - umugore
(old) - umukecuru
(young) - umwār i

wonder at, to - gutangara

wonderful, to be - gutangaza
something wonderful - igitangaza

woo, to - kureshya

wood - inkwi (for fire)

word - ijambo
word, final - umwanzuro
words, idle; just talk - uburondogozi

work - akazi, umurimo

work, to - gukora

working, manner of - imikorere

workman - umukozi
workman, skilled - umufundi

workshop (sense of study) - ihuguriro

world - isi

worm - inzoka
worm, tiny - urunyo

worried, to be - guhangayika, kubunza umutima, kwiganyira

worries - amaganya

worry - inkeke

worship, to - gusenga, kuramya Imana

worth - igiciro

worthy, to be - -kwiriye

wound - uruguma, igikomere

wounded, to be - gukomereka

wrap, to - gupfuka, guhambira, gupfunya
wrap around oneself, to - kwifubika

wring out, to - gukamura
wring the neck, to - guhotora

wrinkle (in clothes, paper, face) - umunkanyari

write, to - kwandika
write poem (story), to - guhimba

Y

year - umwaka

yeast - umusemburo

yell (pain, sorrow), to - kuboroga

yellow - umuhondo

yes - yego, yee

yesterday - ejo
day before yesterday - ejo bundi

yet - nyamara

you - wowe, mwebwe, mwe
you alone - (s.) wenyine; (pl.) mwenyine

young - -to, -toya (muto, bitoya)

young lady (unmarried) - inkumi

young man (unmarried) - umusore

young person - ingaragu

young of animal - icyana

your - -anyu (pl.)
-awe (s.)

youth - ubusore, urubyiruko

Z

zeal - umwete, umuhati, ishyaka, ubwuzu

zealous, to be - kugira umwete

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